

What We Lost:

**Natural adults, and the world
they inhabited**

Howdie Mickoski

What We Lost: Natural adults and the world they inhabited
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*“The purpose of a writer is to keep civilization from destroying itself.”*¹ Albert Camus

1 Found at goodreads.com

NOTE

This book is written for everyone no matter where someone is on their life journey. This is different from my last books, *Exit* and *Empty the Cave*. This work does compliment Exiting work, by presenting the suggestion to first live life as “in tune” as possible to your core, and then to allow energy to be available for any next stages of the journey one might take.

This is not medical, psychological or therapeutic advice. In fact, I don’t see there being any advice in this book at all. It is a conglomerate of my opinions of the ancient tribal world, and my personal experiences of life that show where my opinions originated. It is presented as a philosophical thinking tool for the reader.

I have taken a long while to write this book, in order to get my presentation as clear as I could make it (within time constraints of not taking ten years). I feel the book is self explanatory to do the main purpose of getting people to think, and ask themselves questions about the ancient vs modern worldviews.

DEDICATION

I want to put out a big thanks to my two editors LW and RG who helped make this work readable.

Thank the website archive.org where many of the bibliographic materials were found. This book would not have been possible without access to the works that exist on their terrific site. Please support continued access, especially for older books that can no longer be found in libraries.

Lastly the book is dedicated to those who read it, I hope there is something of value in it for you.

INTRODUCTION

*“My barn having burned to the ground, I can now see the moon.”*² Mizuta Masahide

This is a book about the transformative process of becoming a *natural adult*, and the ancient coming-of-age ceremonies that assisted with it. While I did point towards the subject in my previous books, specifically *Falling For Truth*, I realized more depth was required. As long as someone is still in the child or adolescent state (which is perhaps 90% of everyone over the age of 20) *Exiting the Cave/Matrix* is almost impossible. It is also the first step to living a sane physical life.

Actually a book like this should never be needed. Imagine me going into a Blackfoot or Aboriginal village 5,000 years ago to discuss what an adult is, or what femininity and masculinity are. The whole village would be laughing at me. It would be like me trying to show them a tree. It's obvious. Now we are in a world where someone has to actually show people a tree. Eventually you will learn the story of how humans went from a natural way of life to what we have to endure now. I will get there. But there is a process to this explanation.

So rare has this natural transformation become in the last few thousand years a label, “Awakened,” was created to explain this change in someone. What should be natural,

2 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mizuta_Masahide

because it began to happen so infrequently, got placed on a pedestal in spiritual wrappings. But it is not something special, or only for gurus from Asia. *Natural adults* should be everywhere we look, but they are not.

A bear or cheetah has a mechanism to take it from child to adult, so too do humans. However, this inner process has mostly been shut down by civilization itself, for reasons I will get to in this book. Ancient tribal communities developed specific coming-of-age ceremonies to create the conditions for the smooth transition to adulthood. This was assisted by the knowledge and wisdom of elders of that community. The process can occur on its own spontaneously, as happened to me at age 15 which I describe in chapter 6, but even when the doorway appears, most will just stay stuck in the adolescent state for the rest of their life.

Today most teens are swimming in the water alone. The New Age and Self-Help multi-billion dollar industry have tried to fill this void of clear steps to adulthood. The problem is that they repackaged this as a place where all your wishes are fulfilled, have instant manifestation, and are happy all the time. That is a fairy tale, but fairy tales sell.

This work of turning inwards to transform oneself is part of a process Richard Rose called *Getting Your House In Order*. Said another way, to become a functioning adult that can handle day-to-day reality so that you have space available to do some heavy thinking. That includes the creation of a calm mind and the transformation of one's traumas.

We have a good way to live in this reality. It is called Hunter-Gatherer (HG) tribal life. We lost it. And don't mean lost in that it was misplaced, I mean lost in the sense of being taken away. In this case by force by a group that wanted control of the planet, and they did it by destroying one

natural tribal culture at a time.³ This began 12,000 years ago (in the standard historical narrative) thanks to a new invention, agriculture. However agriculture was not started by accident or necessity. There was a plan behind its formation. With agriculture came cities, which required government, police, and armies, which led to conquest, which led to ownership and economy, which needed religion, then science, technology, industry, and now Artificial Intelligence. There probably isn't a next step on that list in case you are wondering.

Have you asked why is everyone so focused on artificial robot intelligence? Why are they not focused on natural human intelligence? The potential for what a human can do and achieve is far greater than any AI machine, no matter what the scientists try to trick people into believing. It is just another way to cover over the great innate power at the human core. A stable harmonious community requires healthy adults, while modern civilization requires a world of "adolescent adults," with "child adults" in the key leadership roles. *Natural adults* do exist today, but they are not easy to locate as they often live very simple ordinary lives.

This understanding of how fast this reality can shift has been a driving force for me to write this book, for I know it could be one of the last written by a human. Over 50% of new content on the Internet in January 2026 seems AI created, and AI books are becoming more prevalent. Very soon a decree could come out to stipulate that humans are no longer considered smart enough to match the glorified machine god, thus only AI is allowed to create books and share information. So while I can, and especially on

3 Those who overtook the Indigenous way of life and brought civilization I am calling "colonialists." There have been White, Asian, Black, Semitic, and even Native (such as the Aztecs) colonialists. Thus the word refers to a mindset that became common all over the world with the end result of cities and control mechanisms.

something so important as the power of a *natural adult* , I have to write.

Many today claim to be experts on the subject of adulthood. But on reading their recommendations, it becomes quickly seen that they are not themselves in the state that they claim to be an expert in. Not that I am claiming to be an expert either, but I am stating an important fact: We lost the experts. Or better said, colonialists killed them off in order to steal their land and resources. This book is not a step-by-step process about how to be a *natural adult*. It has been created to show you that something vital to the human make up has been lost. To get you to think about the subject, contemplate what a *natural adult* is, and see if you can find one. If so, spend time with them and soak in what they can mirror for you. It encourages you to look within and see where you have reached such a state, and where you have not.

Yes this book is about *Exiting the Cave*. While Emptiness is one of the final steps on that journey, becoming a *natural adult* is a helpful foundation, that makes the final steps easier to take. The more the in-the-dream thing is rooted in what it was designed to be, the safer it gets for awareness to go looking beyond the material reality.

This is a book of opinions wholly my own, based on my own experiences, realizations and visions. I have had help in my life from four different Native American medicine men, as well as a Korean monk, a Traditional Chinese Doctor, and a Qi Gong teacher. Perhaps what I write will be useful to people right now. Perhaps this book will be useful in forty years to survivors should technological civilization destroys itself. Maybe it will only be useful to you.

You can't just place these ideas of the ancient mindset into our current world, which is too distorted and inverted. A great "shaking" of this world would be needed, to remove technological civilization and allow the return to a fully

natural way of living. Don't expect that to happen. Then again, who knows?

With that let us begin...

CHAPTER 1

NATURAL ADULTS

*“Then the day came when I swapped or sold the last of my livestock...now I no longer had any property to take care of, to tie me down. Now I could be what I wanted - a real Sioux, an Ikce Wicasa, a common, wild, natural human being.”*⁴ John Lame Deer

Our modern world is missing *natural adults*, and we may have been missing them for thousands of years. We are surrounded by a majority of people who might have a specific biological age (such as 55) but generally they are still a fifteen-year-old who has gone on to live another forty years. This is revealed as soon as they get a bit of stress placed on them and their real emotional and spiritual age appears. In my life I can say that I have maybe come across perhaps five hundred fully *natural adults*, and perhaps another 2,500 partial ones. I have met some 20,000 people in my life, so that is not a terrific percentage.

Thankfully, most people over the biological age of twenty will embody selected adult traits. Some might be responsible at work, but don't keep themselves healthy. Some might give useful advice, but they are never on time. Some are selfless with some things, and selfish with others. But a

4 Lame Deer pg 49

complete fully functional adult, those are tough to come across. John Taylor Gatto remarked, “*We have become a nation of children, happy to surrender our judgments and our wills to political exhortations and commercial blandishments that would insult actual adults.*”⁵

Just because someone can pay the rent, make sure the kids and dog get fed, and make it to work on time, does not make them a *natural adult*. It does put them in the functioning adolescent state. Adolescence starts the step into responsibility (where mom no longer needs to wake you up for school, and you get to and from your basketball practice on your own). Adolescence is not easy. It is a time of testing boundaries, trying to fit in, finding out who you really are, and risk taking to see what is possible. The adolescent wants to find their own personal guiding principle for the rest of life. Instead what usually happens is an odd re-wrapping of childhood ideas, in a package of manipulation and bargaining. Bargaining is key to the adolescent mind, the idea that if I want “a,” then I need to behave as “b,” in order to get it. Adolescent actions are usually designed only to obtain the desired result, not for whether they enjoy the actions themselves. If the result is not guaranteed, the action does not happen.

When wondering “do I know any *natural adults*?” there are a number of words one can use as a baseline of inquiry. These include integrity, honesty, responsibility, courage, warmth, humility and mental clarity. Granted a *natural adult* may not be at 100% in all of those areas, but you could see how they embody those words in their character and demeanor. You would think this realization of not finding *natural adults* around would bother people, but in a world of adolescents and children, adults would only spoil the party.

Western civilization is designed to make sure few go past the adolescent stage, because civilization depends on a

5 Gatto *Weapons* p xx1

lack of real adults. Too many adults could see the insanity of everything and refuse to let it continue. They would rapidly force civilization to become harmonious and natural, or they would end it quickly. The higher on the importance and power ladder someone is, the less likely you will find an emotionally balanced adult in that position. The system has set things up this way to foster corruption. Children naturally feel unsure and confused, constantly looking for an authority figure to tell them what to do. This world has set up governments to act like substitute parents to control a child-like population into servitude. Everything else is designed to keep the mental-adolescents focused on self-importance, fear of the next great threat, and the need to consume.

Kind-hearted people exist in this world. To find one you have to go searching for people who tend to go unnoticed. They likely don't have a 100,000 follower social media account, nor wear expensive designer clothes. They often live simple lives, because they have chosen a different focus from self-importance, riches, and finding others to exploit. You are more likely to find an actual adult as a bus driver, nurse, kids sports team coach, or farm worker.

Coming-of-age is supposed to mean a specific marker moment when an adolescent becomes an adult. While the basic principle of coming-of-age still exists today, these current teenage markers: a confirmation, sweet sixteen party, a driver's license, or even the strange hazing rituals of sports teams and university fraternities, are not the same thing as this ancient organized process. These modern markers are an event that the adolescent is told that by simply attending, they somehow instantly become an adult. They do not come with teaching from wise role model elders. Nor do these modern events demand a large amount of time away from the family (especially the parents). Nor are modern youth taught myths of the Origin of the world, the secrets of femininity and masculinity, and how their role as an adult has importance in

not only creating a functioning healthy community, but also a functioning healthy natural world. It is supposed to be a clear threshold, that when crossed over, creates a true transformation.

In ancient tribal times, the community assisted in this transformation from being a girl or boy of their parents, to BECOME an adult of the entire community. I've capitalized "become" because that was the point. It was not to learn about being an adult, it was to become one. Often this teaching process is labelled by anthropologists as an initiation. I don't like using that word because it comes with many connections around secret societies. Thus I prefer the following terms: rite of passage, puberty teachings, or coming-of-age process.

Most ancient coming-of-age rituals ended with a feast or party, that occurred when the now transformed young man or woman returned to the village. It was a celebration for the entire community that another new adult had made it through the process. This end part is all we are left with today, the party, without the elements that actually create the adult. And the result of that loss is one of the key factors that has created the insane world we currently inhabit. This needs to be clearly understood as we go forward in this work. Humans are not the underlying problem, the systems and belief structures that have been put in place upon everyone are. All we are left with today is a society of sweet sixteens and fraternity keg parties. Paul Shepard summed it up well by stating,

*"In such societies (without connection to nature or saneness), and I include ours, certain infantile qualities might work better: fear of separation, fantasies of omnipotence, oral preoccupation, tremors of helplessness, and bodily incompetence and dependence."*⁶

6 Shepard *Nature* pg 14

While many modern experts acknowledge this lack of adults, they do not see it as a problem but as part of the path of human evolution. They claim that humans were at the child stage during HG tribal times (because they had no technology, nor believed in a modern religious figure such as Jesus or Buddha). Then along came civilization which the experts claim raised everyone up to adolescent stage (where we are now). But soon, thanks to wonderful AI, we will move into adulthood where we can lounge around the pool while robots do all our work for us. But these ideas are backwards.

Yes we are in adolescence as a species, but we are not evolving. We're devolving. We used to be in the adult stage during the so called "primate" days. Only when agriculture, civilization, conquest, and technology came along did that those who remained (who were not exterminated) dropped into adolescence to survive this insane reality. Recall that the adolescent can do many chores, but still needs mom and dad to look after them. That is where we are today, a group of people that can work basic tasks, but still demand that the government (acting as mommy and daddy) make all the important decisions for them. Soon thanks to AI, the human species (what will be left of it), will be children, totally dependent on a machine to do everything for them, including thinking.

*

“Most people unlucky enough to be born within industrialized civilization will rarely, if ever, even have the opportunity to interact with a person who has made it to the fully-realized phase of self-development (an adult). Even fewer will have chance to experience this transformation for themselves. This is not a reflection of personal unworthiness or poor choices, but a result of the utter void of culture and deprivation of initiation... (as people live on as) a permanent psychic teenager, regardless of biological age.”⁷ Anonymous

The concept that I am labelling a *natural human adult* is the end result of a process that is innate. It is hardwired into the human form, the same way a baby deer has an innate program to help it grow into an adult deer. If nothing gets in the way, it will happen on its own. In humans however, it is the mindset of civilization which turns off (or at least down) the innate switch. Since the process is hardwired into our inner code, it can call itself forth spontaneously. The older one is when it does, will determine how difficult the transition process will be. For the majority, the process has never started, or if it did, they stopped it very quickly.

The transition gets more challenging without a healthy childhood, harder still when that childhood is filled with abuse. Some adolescents are forced to grow up very fast due to weak, abusive or absent parents. I have great respect for how young people in difficult circumstances managed to tap into a personal energy and find a functioning state. But becoming a *natural adult* is more than just doing what you have to do to get through another day. A core aspect to this is

7 Anonymous. “The Stories”

the transformation of the traumas of our past. It is one of the most valuable uses of time and energy that anyone can focus on during their life. But that transformation is step one, and once completed, the inner switch to adulthood becomes more reachable.

While books on becoming an adult do exist, they normally are not presenting what they claim to be presenting. These tend to have a foundational idea of making a new group of workers who can fit into the civilized system, and experience less psychological stress while doing it. If you read any of these books carefully, they are actually presenting ways to stay in the adolescent state, and not stepping into one's personal authority.

Bildungsroman is a German term from the 1800s for the coming-of-age novel. These include famous works such as *Catcher in the Rye*, *A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man*, and *To Kill a Mockingbird*. The most famous novel in this genre might be *The Razor's Edge*, where Larry Darrell makes the transition to an adult, unlike Benjamin Braddock in another famous novel *The Graduate* (who breaks out of his parents' world, but does not succeed in making it to an adult). One could even argue that the Grail Romances of the 12th and 13th centuries were early versions of this type of literature. This subject found its way into movies, especially during the turbulent 1960s-1980s such as: *The Graduate*, *American Graffiti*, *The Breakfast Club*, *Stand by Me*, and *Summer of 42*. I looked at several movies, hoping to find one that would be a good template to use as a foundation for this chapter. But I did not find one. Each had tiny parts of the whole, but none I found that was a good complete package about this process. So I have to continue in my normal writing style.

Defining Adults

I know the question you are asking is, how do I define a *natural adult*? While working on this chapter I looked at what other writers and researchers have said in order to see who could shed more light on this subject. Their definitions tended to be either overly simplistic, extremely complicated, or placed in a New Age spiritual package. Some tried to define adulthood in moralistic religious terms, while others compared it to Asian ideas of enlightenment. The most materialistic of the writers suggested an adult was one who knows what they want and goes and gets it. Some equated it with being married and having children, while others claimed it was remaining single and living a simple life. In other words, few really had a clue. I did notice that none of them did any examination of tribal HG cultures as a possible guide, only modern civilization. Few saw that civilization and adult do not fit together. It is obvious to me that if we want to understand what this term “adult” means, we have to go back to the source of natural knowledge, thousands of years ago.

The most easy trait to spot is kindness. An adult can sense challenges others are having and offer encouragement or help. They can empathize with the person. At the same time they have no need to create more discomfort in other beings’ lives. This includes both people and natural creatures as Arthur Schopenhauer pointed out, “*Compassion for animals is intimately associated with goodness of character, and it may be confidently asserted that he who is cruel to animals cannot be a good man.*”⁸ Granted, many people in our modern world have learned how to fake niceness in order to draw someone in, and once in, drain that person’s energy. Richard Rose described it as “using a smile to pull someone close so they could bite them.” I see this more often than you may think. But you don’t feel tired or distorted after spending time with

8 Schopenhauer *The Basis of Morality*

people who are genuinely kind. Not that you need to be uplifted, just having a pleasant calm encounter with no underlying manipulation is a treat in our distorted world.

To me the word that most defines a *natural adult* is “integrity,” normally defined as, “*the quality of being honest and having a consistent and uncompromising adherence to strong moral and ethical principles.*” There is a lot to unpack in that definition. The main element is that one with integrity is following a personal inner moral compass. It does not mean a “perfect” compass, nor classified as religious, but their inner compass is designed to go beyond what a corrupt world tells them how to think and act. They have found something deeper. But this does not mean just any inner guidance either. An adult inner moral compass is about finding ways to bring balance and harmony to the people and situations they are in. They not only behave in this type of ethical way when others are around to monitor them, they also continue this practice when they are alone. They have learned how to monitor themselves, and stay truthful to their principles, even when no one notices.

Part of integrity produces a person that others can trust. Such a person is not going to manipulate you, cheat you, or steal from you. If you give them your wallet to hold, you will get it back intact; if they watch your house, your plants get watered and everything will be fine.

Another element to integrity is honesty. This is a word that has become misunderstood over the last fifty years, even spawning distorted ideologies. Being honest does not mean someone is incapable of lying. Modern civilization requires lies in order to navigate it, because the systems are built on lies. Honesty means to be honest to yourself. A *natural adult* does not lie to themselves about who they are, what they feel, and what their life direction is.

The *natural adult* has learned when they should be brutally honest (usually with a close friend or spiritual companion) and to operate on a truth scale, based on the particular situation, with the rest of people. Try telling the truth of your conspiracy theory ideas to your friends in the knitting circle to see what sort of reaction total truth will get you. Around this subject some have asked me, “but if I am not honest all the time, then I feel like I am being an impostor.” Actually you have been an impostor since the moment of your birth, playing a role that has been built on someone else’s belief structures. The adult takes control of their inner world and creates their own landscape, then stays truthful with it. They then learn to navigate in a world where the majority are still adolescents (in manipulation and control mode), so brutal honesty is not going to get you far. However, should two *natural adults* meet up, then they are free to share the depth of themselves with each other.

The *natural adult* also has a strong sense of responsibility. But this is more than just an inner clock that makes sure they get to an appointment on time. Adults have lessened the “me first” attitude. They want to do well, but not if that comes at the obvious expense of others. Thus the needs of the self are not the driving force for the majority of their actions, and they begin to focus on long-term thinking over short-term gratification. They lessen the need to manage themselves or contain themselves. That really is what the billion dollar business of Self-Help and therapy is all about, managing a complex inner world, as opposed to owning it. And for a while managing is a useful step, but the *natural adult* will go past management of a problem to find their own inner power and remove the foundation of that problem. The goal is to learn how to live their inner clarity.⁹

*

9 See amarastrand.com for more information in this area of going past management of one’s inner world

Adults are educated, not in the modern school sense, but in life. They have learned from their experiences, and make clear decisions going forward. They have boundaries, for themselves, their family and community. They work to solve disputes rationally and calmly, but they will defend their boundaries when called upon. And while an adult will value friendships, spouses, and family, they also don't need any of them. They are as comfortable living a simple life alone as they are with people.

What this means is that the *natural adult* will act for the sake of acting. While there is a preferred outcome, it is not as essential as the current action being taken. While in adolescent-bargaining mode, no action will be taken if the risk is too high. You don't ask out the girl you really like if you think you will be rejected: you don't change a career you hate because you might not find any new employment. The *natural adult* is less focused on the end result, but how they feel about themselves in the moment. If they no longer like their career, they end it. Maybe they will find something better, but maybe not. They will ask out the person they like, and if they say no, it won't impact their life.

They are connected with their inner core. They have located something deeper and more personal than who and what they had been told they were. They dropped most of their old beliefs and persona, and replaced it with a new adult persona that they feel is honest and suits who they are. An adult would rather suffer from an honest inner choice, than to gain pleasure from lies, manipulation, and dishonesty.

This does not mean that such a person is perfect, always happy, or even that much fun to be around. They are human. They have emotions, they have likes, and specific things they focus on. It is just they do so from a place of following their own inner compass, and less from the forces without (be they other people, or society at large).

We should be surrounded by *natural adults*. It is what the Hero's Journey is about, one of the most presented styles of mythology over the last 12,000 years (even the plots of famous movies like *Star Wars*). It is the journey everyone should be taking in life. You don't learn to trust "the force," you learn to trust yourself. In many ways much of what can be called spiritual seeking, the New Age Movement, even Self-Help literature, exists because of this pressing need to reach a stage (natural adulthood) that no one seems to be reaching, and walking a Hero's Journey that no one is taking.

*

The Museum of Your Childhood

Too many writers on this subject have given the impression that for this transition to happen you have to kill your childhood. That is an incorrect metaphor. There is nothing wrong with the child or adolescent states, it is just they were meant to exist at a particular historical time of your life. That was a time prior to the adult state. Even though the force of death is involved in the transition, I prefer to see that you don't try to "eliminate" your past, you place it in a museum, the *Museum of Your Childhood*.

I created that term as it describes what has to be done to move to an adult state of living. Childhood has to be seen as an historical period that is no longer relevant. It existed, had its purpose, but does not get erased or denied. It gets put in glass cases and interesting displays that you have free tickets to for the rest of your life. Maybe you never visit, maybe once a year, maybe once a week. You can even take someone else on a guided tour if you feel like it. That is up to you. Imagine making a museum of your childhood and adolescence. Would there be a display of your former teachers, of old girl or boyfriends, maybe a famous football

game you played in, or the terrible embarrassment that happened one day? Would your favourite childhood toy be there, your first kiss, that injury that put you in the hospital for a week? Find a place for it all, and then you can walk through it anytime you want, but it is all there.

Without doing something like this, people keep dragging their childhood with them, and they constantly wear it like a shirt full of holes they never let go of. Place it in the *Museum of Your Childhood* and move on. This is not something symbolic. Really plan this out, even making diagrams or 3-D images of your museum space so that it helps to indicate that you are no longer that person any more. You are something else now.

I can describe it this way. Because of writing these books and talking with people, I sometimes will tell stories of my past. However when there is no direct need to use one of these as an example for someone else, they never come to mind. The past is the past, its back there. It didn't go away, but it's not really "here" either. Accessible when required, it is just that it is rarely required. Notice how often people you know want to keep telling stories of what happened 10 years ago, 25 years ago. And they may tell that same story to you many times. See what is going on, by keeping the past alive, so too is the adolescent state at the core being kept alive. But don't destroy it, place it in a museum. Then move on.

*

The Force of Death

That brings me to a key area that I have yet to cover around the adult transition. That is gaining a connection, even friendship, with death. To an adolescent, death is something that never relates to them personally, for them it seems one hundred years in the future. One of the first shakings of the adolescent self is when death becomes personal in some way.

It could be a brother dying, or the death of a teacher they liked at school. In my case, it was the sudden death of a hockey coach when I was 12. By the time I was 20 I also had a well-liked player on my junior hockey team die in a motorcycle accident, and a football player friend in university commit suicide. Events like this begin to shake the adolescent idea that death is a long way in the future, and starts to let us know that it can be in our lives at any moment. Thus a person stops waiting to live. But this is different living than adolescence, which is more of a “how much can I party” mentality, to a “what do I really want to be doing now, that may or may not, impact a future life.” How much fun something is in the moment becomes less important than what that action might be building.

The most important aspect of this force in relation to transition to the adult state, is the recognition that the child and adolescent states have to be removed. They must symbolically die. What is being removed is the self that was built out of a combination of the belief structures of the parents, what I called the egoic parasitic mind in *Falling For Truth*. If the parasitic mind is relieved of its control, the process of becoming of a *natural human adult* will start to occur. The dropping of this mind can also open the door to the realization of Emptiness and *Exiting the Cave*, and while similar in structure, the adult pathway is about redefining the relationship between the ego, mind and self, while Emptiness arises from the dissolving of the ego, mind and self. But, one step at a time.

To reach *natural adulthood*, the process of death has to be used on the links to the parents. Your parents of course go on living in the world. It is not about their physical forms, it is about the mental structures they have implanted in your mind. As long as you still believe what they told you, or that you have to please them, then they still control your life. You would be surprised how many people took a career or

married a particular person because they thought it would make their parents happy.

Most people spend their whole life trying to please their parents, even after the parents are dead. You don't need to heal your relationship to your parents, or even forgive them. Stop being their child and become your own boss. Your parents were likely not *natural adults* themselves (or they would have guided you through this process, and a book like this would not be needed). What that means is that adolescent parents tend to pass the adolescent condition on to their children. If you don't break that chain to become a *natural adult* yourself, and you have children, you will likely pass the same affliction on to them.

Are you really living your own life? I don't mean are you happy and fulfilled, but do you see your life is coming from your own inner direction? How much of what you do and why you do it is because of a voice of mommy and daddy still in your head? And you can include other relatives, school teachers, and authority figures in that mix. If they are running your inner world, then you definitely are not. It is not an easy transition, even with good caring parents. Yet so many are coming from difficult childhood conditions, that adds another layer of difficulty to the work. But no matter one's childhood, everyone has the inner tools to make the transition, because it is all inside of us. However, the complete process of *getting your house in order* to become a *natural adult* can take years or even a decade in some cases. But it is worth it. That is when a life you can finally call your "own" begins. Adults control their own life, not their parents.

To take a step to adulthood, not only do you have to leave your parents' house (that includes the basement), but more importantly, you also have to leave their view of the world. Or said another way, you are going to have to review the view of the world that they gave you, and decide for

yourself what of it you want to keep, and what of it you want to throw away.

Destroying this parental mindset does not mean to stop seeing or talking to your parents. This is about the examination of your inner world. You have to step into this process and begin to transform to a new adult self, then see if this new you can restart a new “adult” relationship with them. Sometimes the hardest part of this process is the aftermath, to re-connect in a completely new healthy way with your parents. And they may not be interested in that. Parents may not like that you no longer have a program running of “do whatever makes mommy and daddy happy,” and may try to force you to change back to being under their control. This is a great test, to stay rooted in the new *natural adult self*, and if the parents want to join you as fellow adults on that journey, wonderful. If not, then you tried and you can go on to live your own life the way you want to.

This challenge is shown in the novel/movie *The Graduate*. At the beginning, Benjamin is wanting to break from his parents and the world they have set up for him. Benjamin can see no better time to begin than rejecting the party they are giving to congratulate him on finishing university and soon taking a job to be just like them. When Ben’s mother asks him what is troubling him, he responds, “*The trouble is I’m trying to get out of this house.*” He does not mean away from the party, he means away from the scheduled life that is being pushed on him. Most adolescents at some point feel this urge one way or another, often called teenage rebellion, but then they are quickly “brought back in line” by the parents. Benjamin in the novel/movie, does not stop the process no matter how hard his parents try to force him. He does not take their jobs, runs around first with Mrs. Robinson then her daughter. He has no real idea what he is doing, just that it is not what his parents had planned for him. However

this process is not going to end well for Benjamin, as I will get to.

*

Later in Life

The next chapter presents the way ancient tribal cultures understood the coming-of-age process and built an entire series of ceremonies for that to occur. But given that those ceremonies have been gone for hundreds, or even thousands of years, humans have been left to the whims of the biological clock, and how that affects a person when the timer goes off unexpectedly.

If this internal turning of the switch occurs when it is biologically scheduled (between the ages of 16-20), there will be some emotional challenge, but it can go somewhat smoothly because you have not yet brought a lot of baggage into your life. If the process begins at age 25, there may be a spouse in the mix, probably someone you chose to have your parents' approval. If the process begins at age 35, you may add to the mix children, a career you hate, and a mortgage that you may no longer want to be a part of. The longer it takes, the more explosive it can be because of all the "fallout" big transformations could have on the connected layers of your life. Because to move into the *natural adult* you, the you that you have been to that point (adolescent or child you) has to be let go of. Maybe the wife, kids, home, and job will make the transition. Maybe they won't. That is why so many shut the process down if it begins after 20, because they see how many elements of their life will be possibly affected if they continue. This is why they just burrow in where they are, because the possible effects seem scary. But that of course is the old mindset talking, wanting to keep itself continuing. Because this process is not just about moving out of your

parents' basement and getting your own apartment. The main steps are mental, emotional, and spiritual. The more of your parents' ideas you keep manifesting as objects in your world, the thicker the wall will be that you have to burst through.

Part of the trigger that gets this started after the age of 20, is the inner feeling of not really living a life true to oneself. This is what the so-called Mid-life Crisis is all about. It happens to someone who has not come to terms with the real character within, then hits 40 and they wonder, what have they been doing the last 20 years? They get the sense they have been living someone else's life. There becomes a need to examine one's true desires and intentions, and redesign a life that suits them. That is why so many 40-year-old men run back to what they liked doing at age 18, and begin acting like a teen all over again. It is not that they are really trying to be 18 again, but they sense that that was the time when a life decision was needed, and somehow they missed it. They incorrectly feel that if they just mentally and physically become 18 again, they can redesign the adult life they should have created then.

In women this crisis can hit when the kids have left home and they wonder "who am I now that I am no longer a mother?" Of course they may have created a dynamic where they are also a mother to a little-boy husband (as described in chapter 5). But going back to an 18-year-old state will not solve the root of the problem. You don't need to go backwards, but forwards, into a totally new adult self.

The longer it takes for the coming-of-age process to begin, the more of a change is going to be demanded from within. That is because the outer world that has been created, spawned itself from an adolescent or child-self that is no longer required. Little of our current constructed reality would fit the adult self we were meant to be. When the old adolescent mindset leaves, so too must anything that was only linked to it. Some areas of our life may be naturally a part of

all states: child, adolescent and adult, but we have to find out which ones for ourselves. You have to walk ahead into something new. You may take some of the old things and friends with you, but just like when you move houses, before you box anything it needs to be looked at to decide “do I really want to take this, or should I give this away?” It’s a personal process. But if it begins, even though challenging, it is best to let it finish and become “who” you were meant to be.

Take a look at Benjamin at the end of *The Graduate* where he jumped without a landing place. He broke Elaine out of her wedding, and they escaped away onto a bus. At first when the bus pulls away they are sitting in the back seat laughing. Slowly the smile wipes from their faces and they wonder “what have we done?” They did attempt to break away from their parents’ world, but neither of them moved into a *natural adult* state. We saw Benjamin go through the breaking apart process, but there was no instruction, no role models, no preparation for a new life that would suit who he really is, or even if this girl Elaine really fits with that life.

So what are they going to do? Neither have jobs, or even a plan of what to do next. Are they going to slug it out in simplicity for a while hoping something works out, or will they cave and call mommy and daddy for help? If Benjamin had made the transition to *natural adulthood*, he would feel confident that he could figure things out. He would know his purpose at least, and the direction he was heading for the rest of his life. If the woman that was with him was also a *natural adult*, then almost surely they would figure out a pathway together, because at least they were starting with a foundation of clear seeing from their own inner being.¹⁰

10 If you want to read more about the challenge of breaking away from one’s parental mindset, and the great challenge it is to root through all of the garbage that means, and work to re-stabilize oneself, you can read about the character Lisa’s journey in Jed McKenna’s *Spiritual Warfare*.

*“The deficiency with most systems of ‘working on yourself,’ therapy, self help, and analysis is that they become tools with which to judge ourselves and at the same time tools to prop ourselves up by justifying the judging of others. Forget all that. Just be your Self. All just is.”*¹¹ David Carse

The end result of all of this will not be happiness, riches, or being placed on a pedestal by the world. In time it will create awareness and focus, and perhaps with more time even contentment and calmness. Without all the baggage, you now have a new possibility. A direction that seems “correct” for us.

Step one is to walk into the *natural adult state* that the physical form was meant to become. After that, the journey now becomes yours to walk, but that now clear-minded inner core will have a much better understanding of what that direction is, and will be able to hold the Intention to do so. That is when one’s life really begins.

*“To be sane in a world of madman, is in itself madness.”*¹² Jean Jacques Rousseau

11 Carse pg 248

12 Found at goodreads.com

CHAPTER 2

COMING-OF-AGE CEREMONIES

*“Human beings will be happier, not when they cure cancer, or get to Mars, or eliminate racial prejudice, but when they find ways to inhabit primitive communities again. That’s my Utopia.”*¹³ Kurt Vonnegut

The heart of tribal communities are their ceremonies. They still continue on most North American reservations today. Yet they are no longer fully embraced by the majority of the community who have come to believe that the world of civilization and money is the way to go.

This was revealed to me one summer day when I was walking through the Tsuu T’ina Reserve on the edge of Calgary. Bruce Starlight (a tribal medicine man) had called me that morning to say he wanted to have a Sweat¹⁴ with a few other medicine people and asked if I could come and help to run the fire. I was happy to do so. I didn’t have a car, so that meant a fairly long bus ride to the edge of the reserve, then perhaps a forty minute walk through the reservation itself to his house. I was walking, enjoying the sun and getting my mind ready for the upcoming ceremony. After about ten

13 <https://www.goodreads.com/quotes/78161-human-beings-will-be-happier---not-when-they-cure>

14 A Sweat Lodge is a Native ceremony that it compared to a modern sauna. Only the steam coming off the rocks is the same. Saunas are good for the body, Sweat Lodges are good for the soul.

minutes I came across three young Native men who were doing roadwork. They looked up to see me walking towards them, and they did not look pleased. I took off my ballcap so they could get a better look at me. I was getting ready to say hello, but they began the exchange.

“Hey,” one of them shouted, “You’re on a reserve. This is not walking trail, go to the mountains if you want to walk.” They all looked at me standoffishly to see if I would turn around.

“Oh, I’m just off to Bruce Starlight’s to have a Sweat, he asked me to come over,” I said, while casually replacing the ball cap on my head.

With that the three men, all at the same instant, turned their backs to me and got back to work. They were behaving in a manner of “please don’t tell Bruce you talked to us.” These young men would likely have no interest in going to a Sweat, seeing it as a type of old caveman superstition. But as my story reveals, most on the reservation knew medicine people could create amazing things, and they didn’t want to find out personally what that could be.

I kept walking past them, doing my best to ignore them as they were ignoring me. Of course Bruce does not hurt people, he uses his knowledge to help people. In 2002 he gave my mother a small bundle of herbs when she bought her first home. He told her to bury the bundle on the property by a tree and it would look after things for her. She lived in that rather old house for fifteen years without one major problem.

I am grateful for all the time I was allowed to spend with various medicine people on reserves in Canada. Because that first-hand experience was very different from the books and expert opinions on what Natives were like. Only by spending time with the “real deal” was I able to look at the

various books and see which ones might have had some honest understanding at their core.

*

A Self Sufficient World

*“Can we face the possibility that hunters (of the ancient world) were more fully human than their descendants?”*¹⁵ Paul Shepard

Imagine a time prior to agriculture, 15,000 years ago, where there are no cities, fences, land ownership, nor farms. Where massive trees exist in giant forests and jungles, where large animals (both carnivore and herbivore) abound, as do an incredible variety of plants. The air and water are clean, the rivers full of fish and the sky full of birds. Now imagine the early humans living there. Probably your first thought was hairy people in furs, grunting and shaking their clubs around a fire as they wonder where they can get some food because they are starving. What the movies and high school history textbooks show.

Early anthropologists set the standard that HG tribal people were savage animals, with limited intelligence, and were “incapable of long sustained labour.” They were presented as living in poverty because they had no modern goods, and always being near starvation. They were claimed to have no leisure time, thus could not create all the magnificent elements of modern civilized culture like temples, cathedrals, statues and music concertos.¹⁶ In writing this I watched a short video on Youtube of an un-contacted tribe being filmed by a passing adventurer. The comments

¹⁵ Shepard *Tender* pg.36

¹⁶ Shepard *Tender* pg. 27, originally from Graham Clark in 1946 *From Savagery to Civilization*, Sahlins chapter 1

below the video is a clear marker of what many modern people still think about HG people: *“backward stone agers who don’t know what metal forks are and don’t have Smartphones...the poor savages.”*

This view of HGs and tribal people was already in place during the 1500s as the European colonial wave was sweeping across the Earth. All of the groups they came across were presented to the population back home as savage and backward. They didn't have democracy, technology, Jesus, nor economic systems.¹⁷ These were the justifications for killing them and taking over their land so that it could be used “properly” (meaning in a way to make a few people rich). In the 1800s this view was strengthened via the theory of evolution, where everything in the present must be better than the past, and since the strong survive and these tribal people were primitive and child-like, they needed to be exterminated. Of course many of the on-the-ground colonists who met these tribal peoples had a very different view of them, but those views were treated as “romantic” and “unrealistic” and mostly ignored at the time.

It took until the mid-1950s for researchers to begin to realize that the ideas about so-called primitives were incorrect. A new set of researchers went to live with the HG tribal communities that still existed in the world, and they began and came to a unique conclusion: that HG life is better than modern technological living.

These cultures lived in a way that focused on balance, not only for themselves, but also for the natural world which they inhabited. The ancient tribal goal was for every member of the community to get to the enough point, not more for some and less for others. They came to understand that there was a set up at the origin of this creation, a type of code programmed in at the beginning. Bears, tigers, fish and birds

17 Found in the books of Mander, Sahlins, Clark

have all lived nearly the same life for tens of thousands of years without change. Run into a bear 3,000 years ago and it will probably behave like a bear now. But humans have changed from natural ways to something else we now call modern technological society. This change was not instantaneous, but gradual over some 12,000 years.

Granted, the ancient Africans or Native Americans did not have all of reality figured out. But they did live in a more sane way. Just about every anthropologist who has lived with tribal cultures over the last one hundred years presents that HG communities are happier, healthier and have more free time. Free time that they use to either to spend in quiet contemplation in a beautiful natural setting, or to be with others for dances, music and laughter. What have we really gained from adopting civilization?

Yes, we have washing machines, smartphones, trucks, and refrigerators. We also have potato chips, crack cocaine, cruise missiles, slave labour, animal torture (called “testing” by science), while almost all of the world’s water and air is polluted.

“The Cheyenne have a tradition of a Golden Age when war was unknown and universal peace prevailed. Where all strangers met in friendship and parted on good terms. Such a far off time, when hostile encounters were unknown, is told by many of the tribes of the Northern Plains. No doubt there was fighting long before the coming of the White Men, but these were probably the results of more or less temporary quarrels, and were not bloody. The only incentive likely to have caused such fighting was the desire for revenge, and this desire, unless promptly acted upon, was soon forgotten.”¹⁸ George Bird Grimwell

18 Grimwell pg 1

It has been clearly presented that HGs “work” 15-20 hours a week for things that are necessary for the entire group’s survival. In our modern world, the average person works 60 hours a week (when you factor in commuting time and work from home) to obtain pieces of paper (we call money) which is then used to focus only on themselves or their small family unit.¹⁹ Marshall Sahlins’ research revealed, *“primitive societies enjoyed a great amount of ‘leisure time,’ satisfied their material desires and survival needs with little difficulty, did not work very hard, there is a greater amount of sleep in the daytime, and consciously chose subsistence economics (meaning obtaining only what was required). Dancing, fishing, games, sleep, and ritual seem to occupy the greater part of one’s time.”*²⁰

And Richard Lee, who lived with African tribal cultures in the 1960s wrote,

*“A woman gathers in one day enough food to feed her family for three days, and spends the rest of her time resting in camp, doing embroidery, visiting other camps, or entertaining visitors from other camps. During each day at home, kitchen routines, such as cooking, nut cracking, collecting firewood, and fetching water, occupy one to three hours of her time. This rhythm of steady work and steady leisure is maintained throughout the year. The male hunters tend to work more frequently than the women, but their schedule is uneven. It is not unusual for a man to hunt avidly for a week and then do no hunting at all for two or three weeks. During these periods, visiting, entertaining and especially dancing are the primary activities of men.”*²¹

19 This is also presented in James Suzman’s *Financial Times* article “The 300,000 Year Case for the 15-Hour Week” based on his study of the Ju’Hoansi tribe of Africa.

20 Sahlins, also found in Jerry Mander *Sacred*

21 Sahlins

A HG did not work as we think of that word, nor did they put in toil so that only one or two people in their community benefited. Effort was to benefit everyone. That is not some sort of Communist idea, which is Capitalism repackaged. This was doing their chores for the survival and balance of everyone. What we call work today is us giving up our toil so those above us in the pyramid hierarchy can, mind the pun, live like kings and queens. Our current world is set up as a giant multi-marketing scam.

I am not romanticizing HG life. It can be challenging, but in a different way than our modern society. Nor do I romanticize nature. The natural world, beautiful as it is, is also a jungle where everything is trying to eat something else just to stay alive for another day. It has its beauty, but suffering is still at the core, which was the main discussion of my book *Exit the Cave*. But there are ways to live within such a system that reduces suffering for ourselves, others, and nature, while having the most available energy and free time. The tribal people seemed to have understood these basic principles.

I give an example presented by Jean Liedloff. During her first stay with the Yequana Tribe of the Upper Amazon (who had no equivalent word in their language for “work”), she noticed that several times a day the women and children would leave the campsite to go down a large hill to obtain water. To Liedloff it seemed like a long and challenging walk, and wondered why they did not either put the camp closer to the water, or find a system to pulley the water up the slope and save all the daily trips. Soon she found out that once per day on these water gathering excursions, the women and children would have a swim in the waterfalls. They turned a daily “chore” into an activity that Western people only do on a vacation.²²

22 Liedloff pg. 17-18

Ancient life was not about depleting the planet, but staying in balance with it. They lived in small groups where everyone had a role and responsibility for the good of the whole. There was no need for commerce or money. Sharing, not acquiring, was the key mode of day-to-day operation. Groups were in life together, no one needed to make a profit off someone they relied on. They knew that if they had no fresh water and air, or no plants or animals, it would not matter how much riches they had acquired. They were adults who had gone through the process of becoming, so they were free to act as long as those choices didn't get in the way of the overall balance of the group. To be mobile and free, they needed few possessions. Even the word "possession" is telling. The question is who possesses whom, the object or the person? Thus the fewer objects one had, the less you could be "possessed" and "controlled" by them. As George Carlin said, "*Houses are just places for our stuff. And we always have the best stuff, not like other people who have terrible stuff.*"²³

Of course HG had objects that they used. But if another member needed a bow for hunting, you would give them yours. Even if the bow got lost or damaged, you or they had the skills to make a new one. The objects were not personal belongings. The belonging idea was not about the control of a specific object, but about people being together as one unit.²⁴ Today modern people define themselves by the objects they refer to as their "belongings," indicating that the objects themselves are important for the definition of the thing labelled "me."

There was also an understanding of finding who fits best for a specific chore, similar to a sports team where a coach has to figure out the best roles for the players for the betterment of the team. The idea where everyone should be equal and all get to do everything is the way of assuring

23 Gray pg. 28-30, Shepard *Tender* pg 32, George Carlin "On Campus"

24 Shepard *Nature* pg. 33-34

nothing gets done. Everyone was equal from the standpoint of being part of the whole, but not equal from the standpoint of making good use of the various members' skills. The best canoe maker made the canoes, and everyone appreciated the quality of the finished product.

However, tribal communities found ways to be sure that no one felt superior because of the role they currently assumed.

*"HGs strongly disapprove of any flaunting of abilities or overt expressions of superiority. The weapons they most commonly use to combat boasting, or failure to share, or other tabooed actions, are ridicule and shunning...They might make up a song about how so-and-so thinks he is such a 'big man' and 'great hunter.' If the behavior persists, the next step is to act as if the violator does not exist. Such measures are highly effective in bringing around the transgressor. It is hard to act like a big shot if everyone ridicules you for it, and it is not worth boarding food if the price is being treated as if you don't exist."*²⁵ Peter Gray

Hunting²⁶ and gathering require intelligence and memory. You can't be stupid or ignorant and be successful in a constantly moving lifestyle. All the migratory patterns of the animals have to be remembered, where water can be found, and where safe places are to camp. A plethora of plants have to be quickly identified as to which are edible, medicinal (and for what purposes) and which are poisonous. One mistake in any of these areas can mean death.

25 Gray pg 31

26 A tribal hunter does not like to hunt or kill, especially animals to which they feel closeness. But they understand the "game of life," one thing must die for another to survive. Thus when they hunt, they use every part of that animal, and a prayer given for its sacrifice. The same occurs when a tree is cut down, to acknowledge it and its life before taking it. That is the way the native medicine men I knew taught me to interact with nature, as equal living and feeling creatures.

Furthermore, a hunter has an acute awareness. They have to be aware of their surroundings for when game comes by, and then to act quickly and swiftly. People today pay hundreds of dollars to be told about “mindfulness” in weekend workshops, which can be obtained for free from thirty minutes in the forest. As one Aboriginal Elder claimed, *“Anyone who does not know how to find food and feed himself is always frightened inside like a little child who has lost his mother and with that fear, the vision of the spirit world departs.”*²⁷

*

Coming-of-Age Process

*“It has often been said that one of the characteristics of the modern world is the disappearance of any meaningful rites of initiation.”*²⁸ Mircea Eliade

The coming-of-age process was important for these tribes to create a society of healthy adults. Adults who understand their place in the world, and do their best to maintain balance, harmony and clear thinking. These tribal communities focused on making the transition as smooth as possible, by working with it when it was biologically scheduled to occur.

One of the earliest books on these ceremonies was *Rites of Passage* in 1909 by Arnold van Gennep. He presented that there were three stages involved in the puberty coming-of-age process. However Van Gennep, and countless researchers who have used his work as a guide, missed the actual first step. That was presented by Mircea Eliade in his 1958 book *Rites and Symbols of Initiation*. The true first step which was the creation of a sacred ground for the

27 Told to Robert Lawlor in 1988, in *Voices* pg 373

28 Eliade Introduction

ceremony.²⁹ The location of this space was often laid out to mirror the believed conditions at the Origin of the world. Thus the young participant would not just be learning about their tribe's origin myth, they would be personally experiencing it, which would generate an inner power to understand the conditions of the First Time.

From my own personal realizations regarding reality, it seems that when this Matrix was created it came with a particular set of operating principles, a type of original computer program code. The HG tribes wanted to live in a way that worked with these original principles (or codes), not against them. For example, the HGs did not want to switch to agriculture because that was not the way things were at the First Time. Doing so would only set into motion elements (government, commerce, conquest for example) that would oppose the Origin.

Van Gennep's three stages, thus become the second to fourth of the overall process. The second stage was the young person to be separated from the world of childhood and their parents. The third stage included teachings from a group of elders (usually all of the same sex) who along with tests, help to transition the youngster into the adult mindset. The final stage was a reincorporation phase (that included a type of welcome ceremony) back into the overall community.³⁰ What our modern world has done is kept the final part of this process, the return back to the world, but left out the important first three stages. It is these which create the adult, not the gathering of friends for a final party.

For modern civilization to succeed, meaning conquer and take the ownership of the Earth's resources, all of the operating principles that come from this Origin time had to be erased from human memory. New ideas about how to live had to be implanted to keep the ever increasing population

29 Eliade pg 4-5

30 Van Gennep, *Rites of Passage* pg 67

stunted, needy and self-important. Eliade remarked that while Ancient Greece and Rome had a type of puberty rite, the rites had already “lost the religious aura which they possessed during the prehistorical period.”³¹ Meaning the knowledge of the Origin’s principle codes, and why the human world needed to mirror them, was already gone 3000 years ago. Likely gone even by Sumerian and Egyptian times. Once the glue that can keep the human world in a type of balance is gone, the demonic infiltration of this reality happens quickly. And this seems to have happened with the tribes who avoided civilization. They also became distorted and corrupted, though not as much as the rest of the world who chose the new gods of agriculture and cities. This distortion of these tribal communities I believe became reflected in their ceremonies as well. Thus we need to examine everything with clear eyes, to find out what there is in these old tribal ideas that has the least distortion.

*

Lost powers

Over the last 12,000 years we have not only lost forests, salmon, buffalo, tribal peoples, we have also lost the wisdom and ceremonies that kept the human and natural world in a stable sustainable way of life. I began to understand some of the depth of this loss from a conversation one afternoon in 2002 while I was in a sweat lodge with Bruce. He told me that the songs and ceremonies that they currently have are just a fraction of what they used to have before the colonists came and killed off most of the tribe and destroyed their traditions. He said he could only imagine the great power that existed when his ancestors still had access to all of these ceremonies. I saw personally what

31 Eliade chapter 6

Bruce, and his fellow medicine men, could miraculously do to help the people that came to him. So I wondered what more there could be.

This got exemplified to me one Saturday afternoon. Bruce had asked me to come out to his house as he wanted to have a sweat that day, but none of his other medicine friends were available. So I came out, ran the fire, got the rocks ready, and began to get my mind in place for a private sweat. Just the two of us. I was excited when these occurred, as these were the days Bruce tended to share the most information with me.

I was in a calm place, just sitting on an old lawn chair that was the place where the fire watcher sat, keeping an eye that the fire was burning in the way it was supposed to. I was just about ready to go and get the pitchfork to take in the rocks, as we were about to start, when a car drove up. It was a very old man in his 70s (though still in very good shape) and what turned out to be his 25-year-old granddaughter. They spoke with Bruce while I watched the fire.

Bruce came over to let me know, *“My friends are going to join us in the sweat. They are from the north, near Edmonton. He is a very old medicine man. I knew him when I was much younger. He taught me many things. So you can take the rocks in now.”*

“Great,” I replied. Though I was slightly conflicted. One part of me knew that while more people in a sweat was good for the power of the songs and prayers, another side of me was disappointed not to have Bruce all to myself. I nodded and began to take in the rocks, thinking my special day of power might have been altered. Nothing could have been further from the truth.

Bruce went into the sweat first, as he always did, but this time did not sit in his usual place at the far end of the lodge, which was where the leader sat. He sat one seat to the

left (where you might call the second in command would sit). I moved and sat beside him on the men's side, while the young woman went to sit on the woman's side. Then the old man came in and took Bruce's normal seat. I closed up the sweat lodge tarps to get the darkness full. Then the old medicine man began the ceremony.

Almost at once, even though the songs were the same as Bruce, and followed the same order, it was a completely different sweat lodge. I can say that figuratively, and literally, the lodge was shaking. The power and experiences that were happening are impossible to place into words. I was there, and one thousand other places at the same time.

An hour and a half later, after all of the rounds³² had been completed and we were standing back outside in the sunlight and fresh air I went over to this man, to whom so far I had not spoken to. I just said, "*thank you.*" I learned from this experience that the power of a sweat partially comes from the ceremony itself, but also comes from the power of the person who leads it.

And this power was not about light shows or sounds that can happen in some sweats. "Shiny things" as Clayton (another medicine man I knew) referred to them. These shiny lights make people think something is happening, putting on a show which some medicine people know how to do. But Clayton was clear that the most powerful experiences had no shiny things, they just created a feeling, a power. And until one has had several experiences, from several different medicine men, only then could one start to tell the difference.

I mention this in regard to all the fake people out there, running sweat lodges (and often charging large sums of money to do so). This is not how ceremony is seen in the

32 Sweat Lodge ceremonies follow a certain number of "rounds," each of which includes certain songs and prayers, then the door is opened to let the steam out and fresh air, until a new round begins.

Indigenous tradition. It takes years to learn the process and the energies one is dealing with. Bruce suggested his own son might need ten more years of being an assistant like myself before he was ready. Never once did he charge me even one dollar to be there. I brought gifts, but they had to come from me, not from him asking. But the more I generously gave, the more the sweat seemed to speak to me.

Today some of the North American tribal communities are trying to bring back these coming-of-age ceremonies on the reservations. Mostly it is the girls' puberty rites (as the boys were claimed to be lost). Yet even these girls' ceremonies (examined in an upcoming chapter) clearly seem to be missing something. Modern civilization has corrupted everything.

*

What It's Not

An internet search for "ancient coming-of-age ceremony," tends to reveal websites that are looking to shock the viewer by presenting some of the most extreme boy's tests from around the world, such as needing to be stung by ants or getting hit repeatedly by a stick. These are presented with no explanation, only to generate attention. One example that appears often in these searches is described as the *Cherokee Ritual*. The premise of it is that a father takes his young son out into the woods, then places a mask on the child and tells him he will have to stay in the woods blindfolded for the entire evening. Then the father tells the boy that he will return the next morning. The premise to evoke some sort of terror in the child, of what might happen to him alone in the wilderness. The idea being that the boy needs to learn to overcome his fear, steady his inner awareness, and then be able to monitor his environment.

When morning comes, the boy takes off the blindfold to see that the father had been sitting close to him the entire night. They hug and return home, and now the child is supposedly an adult.

I did such a personal exercise by myself in 1998, but did not go blindfolded, and stayed seated on a rock in the woods for the night. At first the experience was terrifying, as I wondered what every noise might be. But as I began to acclimatize to nature, I became more calm. That is when the real strangeness started. I began to notice what I can only call “beings” poke their heads out from behind a tree and look at me. When I turned my head to try to see the being full on, they were gone. This happened again and again. So I learned I had to see them from the sides of my eyes, to see them without looking directly so they remained in my view. At first there was a terror at coming face-to-face with beings I had been told don’t exist, but soon I got the understanding that these beings were just checking me out. Because of course, I was in their home. Hence they wondered, who is this person and why is he here just sitting in “our” forest? I saw them as protector-like beings of the area, and once I talked a bit to them about why I was there and what I was doing, they left me alone. I never saw them again for the remaining six or seven hours I was there.

I can say that I did not feel like some sort of adult after my experience. I don’t doubt that this challenge might have been one of several tests that were a part of the old Cherokee one-year isolation from the parents. But this on its own as the only ceremony would do very little, other than bond the young boy more closely to his father. But that is not what we are talking about in this book. The girl or boy has to stop being the child of the mother and father, has to physically leave them for a time, and become an adult man or

woman of the entire tribe.³³ At that point they are ready to start to make their own, ones that the parents may or may not agree with.

*

A little known modern example of this period is the Amish Rumspringa, when sometime after age 16 the young person is free to leave the Amish community and interact with the modern world. They can wear modern clothes, go to bars and whatnot. Then if they choose to come back and be a member of the community and fully accept the views and rules, it can be said they have joined the Amish from their own choice based on a testing phase in the outside world.

I know about this personally because when I was in university I became good friends with an older student. He was in his mid-20s, and he and his wife were members of the local Mennonite Community. We had similar life outlooks, laughed at similar jokes, and liked the same music. He often brought me over to visit with him and his wife, and have (of course) a spectacular Mennonite dinner. During much of this time I enjoyed hearing the views of his community, and we had lots of discussions about it.

One day he mentioned that a 19-year-old relative of his wife (that I had met once), was ready for this going out to test the world phase. He asked if I would be willing to show her around the big city. I said sure, happy to help. It did not take long after meeting her, and taking her to experience her first bar, that I realized she was different from all the university girls I knew. I could not put my finger on it at the time, but now can say, she was very feminine. Of course, I

33 I know that some will say that certain rituals from India or Judaism is this coming-of-age process. But I will be describing an ancient process, which can include up to a one year segregation from parents and all childhood activities, in order to become a member of the tribe as a whole, who is no longer linked to the parents at all.

was there to show her around as a friend, but the more of her feminine energy I experienced, the more attractive she became to me. I considered that maybe I should date this girl.

Once while sitting on a bench in a busy park I half-jokingly said to her that maybe we had this backwards, and that she should be taking me into the Mennonite world for a month.

“A reverse Rumspringa you mean?”

“Yes exactly. Do they have that?” I wondered.

“I don't think so. But even if they did I am not sure you would want to spend all day with a butter churn.”

“I would spend all day churning butter?” I asked.

She laughed, *“No, just kidding. You're easy to joke with.”* She leaned in, placed her head on my shoulder, and we just sat there for an hour watching the “world,” and all its activity, pass by.

That was some 35 years ago, and we lost touch after I graduated. I am fairly sure she chose the colony, but of course I was curious over the years as to which path she chose and how things turned out for her.

*

The Process

*“The life of an individual in any society is a series of passages from one age to another, and one occupation to another.”*³⁴ Arnold van Gennep

34 Van Gennep pg 2-3

Many books in the last fifty years have been written around the subject of ancient puberty rites. Most tended to be written by psychologists, and focus on the ideas of Freud, Jung and the mind. And while this is an aspect of what was occurring with these rites, it is but a fraction. In the last twenty years, a new group of books on the subject, often written by either Indigenous peoples or those who have lived with Indigenous communities, have been published and they offer a better examination of what this process was meant to do.

For girls, this teaching process began via a physical sign, her first menstruation. At this point the girl was taken away from her dwelling to have a specific ceremony, led by an elder woman of the tribe. The ceremony, such as the Apache Sunrise or Lakota Isnati, was designed for the girl to not just meet the main goddess of the tribe, but to become her. While the ceremony is the doorway, the girl has to intend to do the work herself to move into becoming a young woman, one who would become an expert in relationships (both with humans and with nature).

The boys' process was more involved. It did not occur with one specific physical marker, nor was the ceremony individual. Usually a group of boys, who were all deemed to be ready, were taken from the village to live with elder males for up to one year. The famous French caves with painted walls are likely some of the earliest surviving places where boys were initiated into men.³⁵ This was much more than them becoming hunters, as is the standard research explanation. There would have been some sort of work for the boy to find his purpose. In most Native American societies, this happened through the Vision Quest, where the boy would sit in a sacred space for days without food or water until the spirit gifted him the vision of his purpose, which

35 <https://www.france24.com/en/live-news/20250319-rarely-seen-cave-art-holds-prehistoric-secrets-in-france>

would guide the rest of his the life. A young man must not only have a purpose, but it must be HIS purpose. Following someone else's purpose (or life goal) will make every subsequent action on some level be flawed. Some elements of the process for boys were brutal, involving great pain and suffering. In the boys chapter I will explain more of this issue.

Martin Prechtel in his book *Long Life: Honey in the Heart*, described the process of Mayan initiation in the village he was a part of in Guatemala. He discusses what happened to the village as the young men and women became infatuated with the money and goods of the colonial world, forgetting the understandings of the initiatory process. The key of the ceremonies was to not stay stuck in adolescence, but move past that as he explained, "*Making love or babies without the maturation of initiation was too dangerous for the young, and unhealthy for the village. Families whose children didn't go through initiation would feel they had failed their children, or worse yet, their children would be held suspended in eternal childhood (our modern world).*" ³⁶ The only way an adult relationship should occur, was for the adolescents to stop being an adolescents and to become adults.

After reading a book like this, many may wonder how they can bring these ceremonies back to help make our world better. The problem is that you can't bring these ceremonies back as they were, because they are not meant for this civilized world. They were about keeping the natural and human world in balance, not to create more of a resource-demanding, self-important, me-first society. Prechtel wrote a wonderful appendix in his book which discussed this problem, "*Perhaps they (modern parents) think that by simply obtaining a tribal initiation for their children, the same way one buys medicine, that the children will achieve that look of wholeness and belonging into their eyes (that tribal people have), thus avoiding the whole*

36 Prechtel pg 87-88

*frightening landscape of the alienated synthetic existence of modern life.*³⁷

More simply said, you cannot bring back an Indigenous mindset without also bringing back the natural world that it inter-connects with. As long as a lion is in a cage in a zoo, it is not really a lion. It will behave differently. “Lion” and “living freely on a Savannah” go together. Get rid of the Savannah and you also get rid of the lion. In a zoo you are left with a lion-like thing. A human in a modern city (or village or town) is the same as that lion in a zoo. The thing walking around looks like a human, but because it is not in its natural habitat (nature), it won’t function as it was built to. To get the human back, you also have to get its “natural habitat” back.

Civilization has made everyone dependent on it. All land now has owners, so no one can live freely in a forest to hunt, fish, and gather. Even to own land and think you can have personal self-sufficiency on it, fails to see the trap set by property taxes, water taxes, school taxes, and license fees. Soon there will be a pooping and breathing tax. Thus even if you can be self-sufficient on the land you “own,” you still have to exist in the system to make money to pay these fees, or someone from the government will come and take the land from you. On a more basic level, almost everyone is dependent on grocery stores for food, the tap for water, and trucks to bring in supplies to malls. Because of the dependence, even if people don’t like the system, they will fight to keep it in place because it is the thing keeping them alive. People only want to change “who” is running the system..

*“Call it a clan, network, a tribe or family., Whatever you want to call it, whoever you are, you need one.”*³⁸

Jane Howard

37 Prechtel pg 354

38 Howard “All Happy Clans”

Another reason that it is impossible to bring this back into the world is because we lack real communities. Today we have social groups of work colleagues, soccer parents, or selected neighbours on our street. But they are groups we spend time with, not a community where each is dependent on each other for survival. In case you are wondering, *natural adults* make the best community members. If you had enough of them, it would force the others to either rise themselves up to a similar level, or be forced to find a “less aware” community to be a part of. This lack of real communities is one of the problems with modern relationships as Esther Perel presented, “*Today we turn to one person to provide what an entire village once did, a sense of grounding, meaning and continuity. At the same time we expect our committed relationships to be romantic and emotionally and sexually fulfilling. Is it any wonder that so many relationships crumble under the weight of it all?*”³⁹

I also want to briefly mention *Lord of the Flies*, the William Golding masterpiece. Almost everyone has misinterpreted the symbolism of this novel. It is not about a bunch of children who get stranded on an island, and then become savage and destructive to each other, claiming that without modern civilization humans would become like this. The standard belief is that civilization (as represented by the navy captain) comes to the island at the end of the novel to rescue the children. When you understand the children on the island represent our current civilization, they are the “adults” of our modern world, it begins to become clear what Golding is presenting. The captain is not coming to save them, just move them from their insane island back to the insane world of colonial civilization. He follows a similar theme in his next novel *The Inheritors*. I will examine Golding’s work in more detail in a future article on my website.

This thing we call modern civilization will either a) crash and burn down, or b) will find a way to hook the brains

39 Perel *Mating in Captivity*

and energy of humans into the machine and create a new artificial reality that everyone believes to be real. Civilization cannot be transformed, improved, nor become sane sustainable living, because it is dependent on exploitation and growth. As with all things, growth ends. It will deplete and destroy everything, including itself. Ancient teachings do not fit in civilization, for it is civilization which caused the teachings to become lost.

But perhaps by some people holding on to these old understandings, they may become useful at the “correct” time in the future when a gap appears. If civilization does break down completely, it would be challenging for a while, but a sustainable world containing *natural human adults* is possible. I don’t believe it is likely, but I do have to admit that in theory is possible. So the basis of this book is not to change the world, but to find and embrace what *natural adulthood* means and be a good role model of it. Then should the conditions for it reappear on a global scale, there are enough to lead the way.

While modern society may not be able to make this shift, each individual person can move into the *natural adult* state if they have that intention. These old ceremonies are not really “lost” somewhere in the past. They are lost within each of us. This process is part of our natural human heritage, and only when the shackles of the civilized mindset can be shaken off, will it reappear within.

You do not need to copy an ancient ceremony for this to occur. They are simply guides. One woman I know created such a ceremony when her daughter turned 18, which turned out to be a powerful and emotional event for both of them. They looked to the past and then to the future, so mother and daughter could show their love for each other, and at the same time reveal that the daughter was capable enough to take the next step and move on with her own life without the mother’s direction anymore. She was wished well, thanked,

and a new relationship between the two could get redefined where they could now spend time as two adult women, no longer as mother and child.

If this transformation happened for you while in your adolescent teen years, consider yourself lucky. If not, then there is no better time to finish the transition than right now.

CHAPTER 3

THE CIVILIZATION DECEPTION

*“Civilization originates in conquest abroad, and oppression at home.”*⁴⁰ Stanley Diamond

It was 8:30 am, Thursday August 24, 1995. I was standing at the Bay-Yonge subway station in downtown Toronto. What I was doing in the morning at the main subway stop where all the banking firms had their main offices baffles me. Likely coming home from some late night out. At the time I was a struggling comedian, living in a room in my cousin's townhouse, and getting rejected every time I tried to take a step up in any career direction. I was trying to find ways to fit in with the world, but it kept seeming like the world didn't want me.

The subway car arrived, the doors opened, and the suit-wearing, briefcase carrying commuters exited. For some reason I looked closely at their faces as they walked past me to start their new work day. Each one had the exact same stare. They looked like cattle going to get slaughtered. I recall being almost frozen as I caught the full implication of this glimpse their faces were revealing to me. They have their “face” for their family, friends and colleagues, pretending their life was great. Yet that was not what I was seeing this

40 Stanley Diamond, *In Search* chpt. 1

moment. At 8:30 am they were honest with themselves and the world. They hated their lives. They were slaves, and they knew it. Sure they covered it all over with booze, pills, or a monthly fling with the new secretary, but the truth of their suffering was there. And they were completely transparent. They were going to the slaughterhouse, just dying a tiny piece at a time.

I said to myself that anything else must be better than what these people were going through. No money, houses, families, or titles could be worth that. I made a promise at that moment to “never be like them.” I would take my chances to find a better way for me to live. My life didn’t get any easier as I no longer even tried to find a career in the “real world,” but it did drastically change where I put my energy. I had to get my *House in Order* and my feet firmly planted on the ground. I had to heal the traumas I had suffered, and deal with the depressed state I was encapsulating.

I didn’t know it at the time, but I was taking my first step out of civilization.

*

*“Those in power have made it so we have to pay simply to exist on the planet. We have to pay for a place to sleep, we have to pay for food. If we don’t, people with guns come and force us to pay.”*⁴¹ Derrick Jensen

Civilization sucks. It is a giant cesspool of lies, deceit and suffering designed to draw us away from the *natural human adults* we are meant to be. While there are many definitions of civilization, perhaps the most clear is that it is the creation of large congregations of people (cities), that require the bulk of their survival resources from land beyond the city, and a transport system to bring these resources to

41 Jensen *Endgame*

where the people reside. As cities grew, there came a need to take more land and resources. A need for a form of slavery developed to supply the high amounts of labour required, and a police force to control whatever is conquered.

Modern society, when compared to what is needed for life and sustenance is insane. It set up around an economic-religious hierarchy that claims the needs of those at the top are more important than the needs of those at the bottom, and the needs of the natural world do not even merit. This system would have collapsed long ago if not held in place by the threat of violence. Do what the system says or you will be in big trouble.⁴²

I can appreciate chainsaws, washing machines, stoves, ballpoint pens and telephones. But if the trade could be leaving all of those behind to regain a life of total freedom, to me the trade would be easy. Yet I know I am in a minority. To the masses, the message is that no matter our current problems, technology will save us. Of course it is not the population or nature that leaders are looking to save, but civilization itself. Without being “propped up” from the inside, civilization would have collapsed a long time ago. It will collapse eventually, as at some point it will eat up all the available resources until none exist, or are too polluted to be of any use. Civilization’s main result, if you look at it closely, will destroy most life on the planet, or turn it into a trans-humanist AI dystopia machine.

How exactly did we get here?

*

Agriculture

42 In tribal cultures, a small permanent village who gets all their food from a river or from a small semi-managed garden would not be a civilization; while groups like the Aztecs or Mound Builders were (from high levels of agriculture, hierarchy and land use).

*“Most of humanity struck a bitter bargain over the past 10,000 years, trading in a large amount of our sensual lives for the bit of security that comes with agriculture.”*⁴³ Richard Manning

Around 12,000 years ago, a shift happened in the behaviour of a few groups of humans in the Middle East, which was the start of agriculture. Normally presented as the great jump ahead in the human evolutionary ladder, more researchers are seeing it as Jared Diamond presented in 1987, *“Recent discoveries suggest that the adoption of agriculture, supposedly our most decisive step toward a better life, was in many ways a catastrophe from which we have never recovered.”*⁴⁴

This one change started a pathway that led to the ravaging of landscapes, the loss of forests and animals, as well as human freedom. Agriculture led to cities, hierarchy, government, police, armies, commerce, money, writing, religion, industry, and technology. Agriculture needed a system of slaves, later called peasants, serfs, workers, or employees, so that a few oligarch masters at the top could reap the benefits from all the toil of the peon peasants below. It is the basis of the world we have known since our birth.

Agriculture also destroyed the natural forest environments of the world, cut down for either agricultural land, or wood to build houses and ships. Lierre Keith presented that, *“The hills of Israel, Lebanon, Greece, Cyprus, Crete, Italy, Sicily, Tunisia and Eastern Spain were dense with trees and topsoil a meter deep. Stripped of its protective trees, the soil washed into the sea. All that’s left now is scrubby brush clinging to dry rocks browsed by goats, desiccating in the sun.”*⁴⁵

43 Manning pg.8

44 Jared Diamond “The Worst Mistake in the History of the Human Race” *Discover Magazine* 1987

45 Keith pg 38, and Daniel Hillel *Out of the Earth* pg 4

No expert has a decent answer as to how or why agriculture started. Different theories are provided such as The Ice Age killed all the animals, or humans hunted all the animals, or some accident created overpopulation. These are but stabs in the dark, trying to answer a question that seems to have no rational answer.

We do know that humans changed after the adaptation. Archaeological digs have revealed that ancient humans ate a wide variety of foods. This is not because they were starving so ate whatever they found. The evidence clearly shows that they chose a varied diet so as to take full advantage of all the various health properties that different foods offer. By contrast the new agricultural communities obtained the majority of their calories from one or two starch centered grain crops that provide low nutrition. That the new agriculturists put all their faith into one or two types of crops, meant life was fragile, and if anything happened to that crop they risked starvation.⁴⁶ This is opposed to the HG, who if one food source is no longer available, they just move to one of a hundred others that exist.

Archaeologists examined 10,000 year-old skeletons, and compared them to those found in 3000BC. The analysis revealed that the average height in the pre agricultural period was 5' 9" for men, 5' 5" for women. By 3000 BC, those heights had become 5' 3" for men, 5' for women. Granted we have grown taller since that time, but it took many thousands of years to even equal where the HGs were prior to agriculture. Other researchers who studied skeletons of the Mound Building farming culture in the Central US around 1100 AD found their skeletons showed clear signs of *"malnutrition, a fourfold increase in iron-deficiency anemia (evidenced by a bone condition called porotic hyperostosis), a threefold rise in bone lesions reflecting infectious disease in general, and an increase in degenerative conditions of the spine, probably reflecting a lot of hard*

46 J. Diamond

physical labor.” I put focus on the term “iron-deficiency” as it is important. We will come back to it. The rich ate meat and fruits, the diet of the HG. A grain diet was the food of the poor. “*It kept them able to do the work, but left them malnourished and stunted.*”⁴⁷

The change to a more sedentary lifestyle was not good for health. Ancient people did not need to partake in jogging, aerobics or swimming. They were naturally active, not only in hunting and gathering, but through various dances and other activities. A HG life creates physical fitness automatically. That the modern world requires fitness centers and swimming pools is already saying how far we are from living a natural life. Added to this fact is that the change to agriculture is the main reason for the destruction of natural habitats, and the extinction of many species over the last 10,000 years. It is surprising there is almost anything natural left.⁴⁸ How could this have happened?

Russian researcher Andrey Sklyarov⁴⁹ may have come up with what is most likely the answer to how agriculture began. This was not due to a flash of intuition or the need to feed a growing population. It may have been the greatest trick ever played on us. Agriculture began almost 12,000 years ago in a small number of unique places on the Earth. Each of those places used one of three main farming crops which continue worldwide to this day: wheat (Middle East), rice (Asia and Middle East), and corn (Americas).⁵⁰ A problem

47 Allen Johnson and Timothy Earle, *The Evolution of Human Societies from Foraging Group to Agrarian State* pg 277, Neel “The Advent of,” Shepard *Pleistocene* pg 89, J. Diamond, Manning pg. 35-36

48 Shepard *Pleistocene*, Keith Lierre, *The Vegetarian Myth* is a good source to see the damage to the Earth’s natural environments due to agriculture

49 I consider Sklyarov’s articles on agriculture are found in the bibliography.

50 One could also add Potatoes from South America into this mix, but they are not a grain.

Sklyarov found with these original grains is that they were not wild plants. They had been genetically modified. Thus the first agriculturalists did not choose wild plants growing in their area; instead they “created” an entirely new strain of plant. Today you need genetic laboratories to do that effectively. And while there are methods such as cross breeding or mutation breeding, even those are a massive amount of work for HGs, when wild plants could have been chosen.⁵¹

The second problem is how these new crops got used. While grains can be eaten directly off the plant, or boiled and eaten, most of these crops added a very complex process of milling and refining (to make flour, and then foods out of the flour). This is a very time and energy consuming process, for no increase in calories or food value. It seems like a giant waste of time, but this became the expected process.

Even more confusing is that these crops are not overly healthy for humans. They were genetically modified to become a copper-based food (a metal we don't really need) away from iron-based (which is found in meat, nuts, fruit, most wild vegetables, even many wild grasses) which humans do require. Why create a new main food source that is not what humans need to be healthy?

A big oddity to all of this is that most cereal grains like wheat, maize and barley are high in a type of opioid, that has a similar effect on the brain as drugs. Not as much as pure opium of course, but there is an effect. Wadley and Martin revealed that both cereals and cow milk create addictive responses, as opposed to the foods that humans ate prior to agriculture. They wrote, “*No one binges on steak or eggs or pork chops, they always binge on cookies, candies and other carbohydrate junk foods....cereal grains and products made from them have an allure that transcends the mere taste bud stimulation they provoke.*” Thus

51 Sklyarov and Manning pg. 26-27

humans after the change to agriculture turned to a food source that was far less nutritious, yet more like a drug to create an addictive-like effect, “*even cravings or withdrawal, (that) can be confused with hunger.*”⁵²

Skylarov’s theory is that none of this was by accident. The new food was modified to nourish copper-based non-human entities. Such entities were looking to make humans more “like them” thus easier to let’s say “attach themselves.” This was the first step in creating the linking point for the parasitic egoic mind. This idea can be found in the earliest religious texts of Egypt, Sumeria, the Maya and India. The system of civilization is the “in world” reflection of this new mind. I will discuss it further in the final chapter.

When HG cultures were given the open choice to join agriculture and civilization, they refused. So the colonialists pointed guns at them. A few made the switch, but most were killed by those guns. Hundreds of millions of tribal humans were killed during the 12,000 year period in the most obvious genocide in human history. Few people realize how many animals, trees, birds and fish have also been slaughtered, all so a slave system could be implemented. Everything natural, and sane, had to be destroyed for the new agriculture based civilizations to expand their power and control. I used to hold civilizations like Ancient Egypt in high regard. I am currently reviewing these ideas to see how their obvious building and metaphysical knowledge relate to an agricultural city-state society. Maybe it wasn’t as positive as I had thought 25 years ago. Today these slaves are bought off with a few comforts like hot showers, Sunday football, and espresso machines.

Yet all of us are in modern civilization one way or another. We might be living on the fringes, hanging out by the civilization fence line, but no one is living totally apart from it. I have heard about a couple of tribes in the Amazon Jungle

52 Wadley and Martin “The Origin of Agriculture”

or on a Pacific Island, but they get outside visitors once a year, so they are likely also being corrupted by the civilization virus as I write this.

*

City States

*“Overpopulation is more likely to be a result of agriculture, and the social and religious attitudes that arose with it....human propagation became a means of conquering nature and acquiring land to establish secure, powerful agricultural settlements. Women became breeding tools (which) took away from women their innate ability to monitor conception and childbirth and avoid the burdens of unnecessary birth.”*⁵³ Robert Lawlor

Agriculture forced people to live in permanent dwellings near their crops, and this caused two things to occur. Firstly, a great number of people are needed for the hard work of farming. Much of it could be done by children. Since farming needs labour, women needed to go into more “labour” to produce the workers. Females were turned away from being the in-world representative of the Divine Feminine, to become first and foremost a baby machine to produce more workers for the farms, then later for the armies, merchant shops and factories.⁵⁴ Children were no longer able to live the free life of the HG, they now had to be thinking about work from a very young age.

Due to larger populations, and large tracts of land under a new ideology (ownership), the areas required defence.

⁵³ Lawlor pg 163

⁵⁴ Shepard *Tender* pg 25. Women did get a different benefit from the agricultural switch that has mostly stayed hidden until recently. I will discuss that in the next book.

Villages, then cities, formed. Cities rely on taking resources from the surrounding countryside, meaning that no city has ever been sustainable on its own. Secondly, in order to continue their ceaseless expansion, cities must continually take over more natural areas to exploit. I'm sure you can see the problem. Eventually you run out of needed land and resources. That is a major reason why wars begin.

Entire hierarchical class structures were created to determine who were the lower class workers, who were the defenders, and who got to be the overseers (controllers) who owned the land. Once you own land, you own the people. Overseers did little but tell others what to do, but they could not afford to have others come in and collect the harvest, or the peasants would kick them out. The controllers needed to make people feel their safety was dependent on the newly formed hierarchy. To do that it needed to keep the population in a child-mind state. This kept people feeling they did not have the knowledge or power to be in control of their environment (both outer and inner) so they looked for an authority to tell them what to do. At various times government, religion and science have filled this void as chief authority.

Civilization requires slaves in some form. Almost everyone today is dependent on someone else for their food, housing, fuel, and clothes. We always need more to pay off what is owed to someone else (the ruling elite, banks and governments). Work for money is the way of keeping the slaves alive (barely), and give them just enough comforts to not want to revolt. The 0.1% at the top can only live in their amazing luxury because the 99.9% below them let it happen. Modern slaves have no way to escape the system, all they can do is try to distract themselves from their plight. As slavery rises, so too does addiction and a focus on entertainment. People want to be distracted and watch someone else live an

interesting life, because deep down they feel so little possibility for their own.

*“Corporate executives are anonymous warriors, and in the end they are just as faceless as soldiers. They are given meaningless medals and promotions, to reward them for some soon to be forgotten struggle for having gained the top of some imaginary corporate hill for their company and their superiors (feudal lords) who care nothing about them personally.”*⁵⁵ Martin Prechtel

Paul Shepard, in his book *Return to the Pleistocene*, discussed the loss of tribes small enough to converse around one central fire, what he labelled a “fire circle.” These were gatherings where the entire community could make plans and solve disputes. No government is needed, because everyone can represent themselves and thus have a direct input on any decision made. *“The leadership in small groups has proved to be keyed to integrity rather than imposed or inherited authority.”* Once a tribal population got too large to sit together around one fire (maybe 120 people), is when problems arose. Leaders and hierarchy took shape to speak on behalf of the community. *“Centralized power is the great curse of history.”*⁵⁶

In the Western World, there is no such thing as real democracy. It is just a word that gets thrown around, so that the peasants do not notice that they have no say in all of the big decisions that will happen in their lives. A small group of will make those decisions for them. The masses only get to choose which group screws them over. The choice of a liberated and powerful life is never provided.⁵⁷

55 Prechtel pg 358

56 Shepard *Pleistocene* pg 155-56

57 An interesting statement about our world was an article written in 1999 by a Papuan Tribesman, who had been living in England, titled “Just Leave us Alone.”

Civilization has war and conquest at its core. Paul Shepard reminded in the ancient past, “*All of the tools of the Paleolithic, there is not one single weapon designed for war. There is no state of war in Pleistocene tribal groups...the warrior came into existence when hunting stopped and pastoral agriculture came in. He moved from hunting animals, to learning how to steal other’s cattle, or protect their own cattle from thieves.*”⁵⁸ This is an amazing statement, that the early HGs had no weapons for war, the most likely reason being that they did not need them as there were no wars. There may have been some disputes perhaps as two groups came across a similar hunting area, but these would have been solved diplomatically or perhaps via some type of competition, as many North American tribal disputes were solved by the playing of a ball game such as lacrosse.

The switch to agriculture changed humans. We became domesticated, just like we did to plants and animals. Domestication is defined as the genetic changing of a plant or animal to make it more “farmable.” Paul Shepard in *The Tender Carnivore* insinuated that the traits found in domesticated animals are the same as found in modern humans. In domesticated animals Paul Shepard wrote, “*Natural tenancies get weeded out, from the amount of symbolic fighting, to mating patterns, with hormonal changes to become more submissive, and the differences between male and female are diluted...so the animal ceases to be an adequate representation of a natural life form.*”⁵⁹ Once a line of animals is domesticated, they have more and more difficulty existing in the wild, they need the human farmer or caretaker for food and most other needs. Another key point of animal domestication is that they are genetically bred to be more social and accept human control. I am sure you are noting the similarities to modern humans.

As soon as the first group of humans thought it was ok to farm plants and animals, by “proxy” humans are stating

58 Shepard *Pleistocene*

59 Shepard *Tender* pg 11-14

that it is ok for other beings to farm us. Thus modern cities could be thought of as zoos and barnyards to keep the human animals close to their “herders.” A recent theory is that the Great Wall of China was not built to keep the peasants safe from the Barbarians of the West, it was built to keep the peasants in so they did not try to escape their rice paddy life and join the more free-to-move Westerners.⁶⁰

Animals do not like being caged in a zoo, humans deep down feel the same about the zoo of the modern world (called cities). Just as animals in zoos develop all sorts of conditions (anxiety, high blood pressure, heart trouble)⁶¹ that do not occur in the wild, so too for humans in city zoos. We are built to thrive in a natural world. The last 12,000 years has conditioned humans that natural living is backwards and insane. By giving that up for “comforts,” yet forced to “earn a living” just to have shelter, food and clothing (which are almost instantaneously generated in the wild for FREE) one has traded in natural life for veiled slavery.

*

Choices

Everyone has a longing for something more, even if they don't know what that is. But the system pushes people to fill this inner longing with any form of distraction. The longing never gets filled, so the cycle of seeking continues. Our current society is shaped by loneliness. That is why so many today are actually using ChatGPT for everything. It tells them what to wear, what to eat, and what text message to send. It's frightening actually to see people not only turn over every decision of their life to an AI machine, but they don't see they are turning over their souls.

60 Manning pg.44

61 Shepard *Tender* chapter 1

*“Civilization is a hopeless race to discover remedies for the evils it produces.”*⁶² Jean Jacques Rousseau

Civilization needed to attack the building blocks of human communities, the feminine and masculine. The feminine was relabeled as soft and subservient. The masculine was relabeled as a strong worker and obedient to authority. It told both sexes that your number one role was to be a “nice person” and to always “have a nice day.” Full domestication. But the core feminine and masculine can be nice, but they have other modes and requirements. Freedom is one of those requirements, and you can’t have freedom and be an obedient slave at the same time. One has to be given up for the other, and it is obvious from the last 2,000 years which was given up by the majority of humans.

Look at the average human today. How many can make a fire in the woods without matches? Even with matches? Who could make a shelter, find wild plants to eat, or any other basic nature skill that should not be learned but literally instinctual messages from our DNA? How many today would perish without the grocery store to get food and a government to tell them what to think? Yes, we are now a domesticated species. That is why the study of HG tribal culture is so important, for it indicates behaviours that are not domesticated, but wild, natural and free. That is why I am writing this book. We have to see what we have lost, what has been done to us to lose it, so that we can then take a key step back up the ladder to our *natural adult* awake state.

“We (Lakota) make lousy farmers, because deep down within us lingers a feeling that land, water, air, the earth and what lies beneath its surface cannot be owned as someone’s private property. That belongs to everybody, and if man wants to survive, he had better come around to this Indian point of view, the sooner the better,

62 Found at goodreads.com

*because there isn't much time left to think it over."*⁶³

John Fire Lane Deer

Farming, during any historical period, is not really fun. Daphne Prior presents that farming was a "*state of surrender, and the farmer was a defeated captive.*"⁶⁴ Once agriculture began, farmers got locked to their land, while a new group called merchants dealt in all the goods that the farm food surplus allowed to be produced. Everyone was locked into someone and some system, which took away the freedom of living the old ways in a natural world. Remember that one of the reasons people love to have a car, is so they can drive to the wilderness to be somewhere where there are no cars.

There is no need for the HGs to store large amounts of food, because their food is stored in the landscape itself. They trust their natural abilities to go and hunt and gather what they need, when they need it. It is the surplus that created the non-producing d-elite class, who made itself the managers of this surplus for their own benefit. The modern idea that you have to earn a living is insane. Does a falcon, trout, or deer have to "earn" its right to be alive? Sure, they have to learn how to navigate and function within their born nature, but only humans have the demands to work for someone else so they can be "allowed" to exist on a particular spot on the Earth.

*"You can't change the world, but you can change the world for one animal."*⁶⁵ Anonymous

Real communities are also lacking today. In ancient tribes everyone had a role, and each person was valued and needed. That is the exact opposite of the modern world

63 Lane Deer pg 49

64 Shepard *Tender* pg 27, 29, Daphne Prior "State of Surrender,"

65 Heard mentioned in several animal protection groups

where no one feels valued. In most cases no one knows who specifically made the shoes they wear, the car they drive, or baked the bread they ate. Intentional communities are groups that share a common interest, people who have come together to share resources for the betterment of the whole community, but most of these are just control and suppression repackaged. But to have real communities again, it requires having a real world to be a community in.

I will make one last point in this short overview of the loss to the entire world from the development of civilization. That is that in the HG world, no temples or palaces were needed to be built. That is because there was no hierarchy, no special priests that needed giant monuments to awe the population and make them important. The natural world itself was the temple, and the awe was in every lake, mountain, or tree.

We lost that too.

CHAPTER 4

ANCIENT vs MODERN CHILDHOOD

*“ A child grows not by learning or preparing for life, but by actually participating in the life of the community.”*⁶⁶ Robert Lawlor

I consciously chose not to have children. There were two factors that went into my choice. The first was the understanding that generally one's parenting skills (at least with a first child) is very mirrored by the parenting one received themselves. And while there were some valuable elements of my child upbringing, the other 50% was not healthy. I did not want to risk bringing any of those poor parenting techniques to another young person. The second reason, and what became my entire *Exit the Cave* presentation, was my realization in the early 1990s that civilization is crazy. We already had millions of children in the world that were being abused, neglected or starving, so I decided that the world's focus should be making sure that all of the children currently here could be properly looked after before adding more to the mix. I just wanted to share that background before examining this subject of childhood.

Granted, there are modern parents who take an intelligent look at their current situation and decide if adding children is a good idea for them. They will ask if they can really provide the time and care required to raise a healthy

⁶⁶ Lawlor pg 168

child. However, the majority tend to treat having children like picking up a new plant or kitchen table. Another consumer product to add to their home. Only in this case they don't have to go to a store to purchase one, though many today probably would if they could.

Even growing up in the 1970s, long before smart phones and the internet, childhood was a challenge. As a seven or eight year-old I was often beat up for simply being “too smart for my age.” This only stopped when I took on the persona of a comedian, and no one any longer wanted to beat up the kid who made them laugh. While things are likely worse today, even in the 1970s I should have realized just how many girls in my school were getting raped at home in the evening, or how many boys and girls were being beaten, neglected, or forced to care for younger siblings because their parents were incapable. Looking back, I wish I could have seen this in my classmates, and been more empathetic with them and truly wished them well.

Now in 2026, childhood is much more challenging due to the influx of technology. Johnathon Haidt in *The Anxious Generation*, discusses how much more anxiety, depression and mental disorders exist in young people, strongly linked to the smartphone. Peter Gray discusses what the loss of free play has been doing to children's mental states and growth. Then we have the problem of schools themselves, which are semi-prisons where children who naturally want to explore and experience, are forced to sit on their butts learning things that is mostly not relevant for normal life.

Tribal culture had a different system of child raising that had been the model for thousands of years, while the way things are currently today done is less than 300 years old. Given the overall mess of this society, and the lack of clear functioning adults, maybe these “backward savages” had some understanding? That is exactly what many researchers found who lived with these tribes. One was Jean Liedloff,

who after living with the Yequana people of South America, developed a way to raise young children she called the *Continuum Concept*. David Lancy presented similar ideas in *Raising Children*, of how children are raised in tribal and HG societies.⁶⁷

I want to be clear that this chapter is not one about the raising of children, nor giving guidelines or directions for parents. It is simply about making comparisons of how things used to be done, compared to how they are today, and why the ancient way would make more sense in preparing an adolescent to take the next step to adulthood.

Robert Lawlor and Kim Anderson presented that Native communities were careful as to how many children were being born. They believed that there was an optimal number of people in a tribe where it functioned best. Too many would create problems. Unlike the views of the modern world, more is not better. Because HG communities did not suffer from overpopulation, they did not get drawn into class, money, or slave systems. These would all be bad for living a sustainable life from the land. Maria Campbell shared with Kim Anderson that, “*The old women I have known said that long ago we never had more children than we could grab and run with if there was a battle.*” They had various practices of birth control in order to be sure the tribe stayed at an optimal level. Another informant explained that tribal women even set up their pregnancies so as the majority of children would be born between May and July, when bitter cold winter did not have to be handled with infants.⁶⁸ That is the level of depth that life was considered and organized

Aboriginals had even a more otherworldly aspect with the belief that children were actually “dreamed” into

67 Additional sources comes from Kim Anderson *Life Stages and Native Women*, Robert Lawlor’s *Voices of the First Day*; and Michaelleen Doucleff’s *Hunt, Gather, Parent*.

68 Anderson pg 13, 40, Lawlor chpt. 11

existence, and unless the father moved into a type of dreaming phase with the pre-birth child, a birth would not occur.⁶⁹ This might seem fanciful on first reading, but such a concept continues as a modern expression where a man living before he had children is claimed to be living before they were as man living his life before they were even a “glimmer in his eye.” Notice this expression only relates to the father, it is never the mother who has the glimmer. This links back to the tribal view that the father was like the magnet or connection point that in some way “agreed” that there was space for a child in the community, so welcomed it long before the actual physical sex process ever occurred.

*

Child Stage

*“Indian children are never alone. They are always surrounded by grandparents, uncles, cousins, relatives of all kinds, who play with the kids, sing to them, tell them stories. If the parents go some place, the kids go along.”*⁷⁰ Lame Deer

In an Indigenous community, children were not looked upon as a personal possession. Everything belongs to the entire tribe, just currently looked after by a particular person. Children are no exception. Much of the work of teaching and helping children fell to the direct relatives: parents, grandparents, aunts or uncles, yet, the tribe as a whole was available to assist if needed. This loss of extended family in the upbringing of children is one of the great losses of modern society.⁷¹

69 See more on those ideas in Lawlor pg 162-163

70 Lame Deer pg 11

71 Liedloff, Lame Deer, Doucette

Agricultural societies use agriculture words to describe childhood. Just as an agriculturalist is trying to control nature, similarly they also want to control childhood. Peter Gray presented that our modern world uses the term “raising” children, which is an agriculture term for how to grow a crop. Or that children need to be “trained” as we do with animals, so they will act in ways to “please us.” They also need to be “nurtured,” the same way we do with plants. When discussing HG communities Gray describes that they “*did not have agricultural metaphors. In their world all plants and animals were wild and free. Young plants and animals in nature grow on their own, guided by internal forces, making their own decisions...And that is the general approach that hunter-gatherers took toward child care and education. They provided part of the substrate, not the directing force, for their children’s development.*”⁷²

Jean Liedloff, after living with the Amazon Yequana Tribe for several years, presented in her book *The Continuum Concept* the tribal understanding that the more a baby is held, the calmer it will be. For the first few years of its life, the infant is never away from the mother (or a substitute), no matter the activity being performed. The women continued their day to day activities, but the child was slung with them. Interestingly, Liedloff noted that while the child was presented with physical closeness, the mother also acted in what she described as “emotional aloofness.” This is not a disinterest, or a lack of caring, or an addiction that makes the parent incapable of being present. It was a choice to create a bit of energetic space. Simplified, the physical closeness provides safety in the child's world, while the aloofness creates space for the child to get curious and start learning things on their own and not believe the world revolves around them. Part of this method was also to be sure the mother stayed healthy and did not lose all of her energy focusing on children. If the mother got sick, that meant the children could not be properly looked after. Too many today

⁷² Gray pg 85-87

forget that the health of the mother is equally important as the health of the child.⁷³

A modern response comes from those who claim, “I need daycare and baby sitters because I can not take my baby to work, shopping, to the movies, and to my Saturday night party.” Such ideas are not compatible to the ancient mind. The child is with the mother almost all of the time, and as such, the mother would not choose to live a life where the child had to be excluded. Life would have to be modified to fit the child, not the other way around. Most every part of modern society is an inversion of the HG view of how life should be lived.

The mothers of the ancient world “worked.” Women had chores, just as men had chores. They were not “stay at home” moms. There was no such idea until the Industrial Age. Having a young child did not stop these requirements, such as gathering water or obtaining plants. The child was brought with the mother and held while very young, then joining in the activity when older.

Liedloff presented a complete system of this ancient tribal way of raising children up to the age of three or four as: a natural birth⁷⁴, breastfeeding, co-sleeping with parents at night for the first few years, an in-arms phase (lasting the first six months or so), responsive care, great expectations (which I could shorten to mean trusting that as children grow they can figure many things out for themselves), and unconditional love.⁷⁵ Consult the footnoted sources if you are interested to learn more about these ideas.

73 Liedloff, Lancey pg 30

74 In chapter one of Kim Anderson’s book, she gives information on how Cree and Objiwa (Chippewa) women handled pregnancy to maximize their and the child’s health, how they handled the placenta and umbilical cords, each of which they saw as having spirit power and thus needed to be dealt with in a matter honoring that power.

75 Liedloff website <https://continuumconcept.org/summary>

One last element I want to remind of here, is this innate drive at the core of woman is to look for a man that can “protect” her (sadly distorted by fairy tales as the woman becomes a “damsel in distress” needing a man to save her). In a wild tribal state living in nature, she needs to know she would be protected if required, not currently saved. The reason is that when a woman gets pregnant, during much of those nine months she is very vulnerable, as during the first few years when the child is very young. Thus she needs to be able to focus on her daily chores and the children, without having to also be concerned about wild animals and bandits. This is something the male wishes to be appreciated for, not only when he actually does the protecting, but to be thanked for being in position to do it should it be required.

*

Free Play

Once a child gets past the age of four or five, they change to become a very curious creature. They want to explore, and ask questions about everything. Peter Gray became an advocate for a return to a play based style of childhood (the type of life that existed prior to smartphones and video games) which is the core of a HG village. Gray is clear that in order to learn a multitude of various skills, children need unsupervised play time where they can figure things out on their own, as opposed to the massive over protection and over scheduling that began in the 1990s.⁷⁶ And before the reader says it, I am well aware that a tribal community is different than downtown New York. In a tribal community there may be one hundred members, and everyone has known everyone since the moment of their birth. They are in a sense a family, and there is a familiarity

⁷⁶ This section comes from various interviews and articles with Peter Gray (see bibliography)

with each other. Such is not the same in a city of millions where just about everyone is a stranger. That is why I say that so much of what I am writing about in this book does not fully apply to the modern world. I am writing to show the elements of natural human life that have been lost. How much any of them can be placed back into anyone's individual life is all up to everyone individually, what they feel comfortable and safe with.

Gray presented the work of researcher Elizabeth Thomas (author of *The Harmless People* and *The Old Way*) who studied the African Ju/'hoansi tribe. Thomas presented the daily life of a typical eleven-year old. He gets up and starts his day when he feels like it, he is not forced to go to a school, nor has much on his day structured. He gets together with his friends, and they go out in the bush to play and explore. They play on their own accord, and learn to do many of the things they see the adults doing (learning to make arrows, track prey, or build huts). They of course at times join adults for various chores, activities and dances, but they mostly have their days to explore and play as they wish.⁷⁷

Free Play is vital for learning many social skills. These are games which are chosen and officiated by the children themselves. They become places where children learn how to organize, come to agreements, find ways how not to get hurt (as my tackle football games and full contact road hockey at age 10-14 taught me), and how to solve disputes in a way to let the game continue with the least amount of bad feelings. It was very common back when I was young that if one team was outmatched after starting a game, we would just “trade” a couple of the guys (Rod you go to the them, and Robbie come over here). No one got to play any more or less, but now the game was more balanced out given that star player Rod was moved to the weaker team, while Robbie took his place on the better squad. Everyone was fine with that. Even Robbie actually. He knows he is not the best baseball player,

⁷⁷ Gray chapter 2

but now, he is part of a more equal playing field, and every hit he gets is a well thanked bonus by his squad. A key too was no matter who won or lost those games, they were forgotten five minutes later, as we all headed back home together. The winning only mattered while being in the activity, not after it.

We set up the rules and everyone was expected to respect them. We shared our equipment with those who didn't have any. There was no problem giving my glove to another kid when it was his turn to be in the field. It was all about the game itself. We did not need some parent to give everyone a lecture about what to do or how to do it. We would take care of things ourselves when required. Generally, it would only require a reminder such as, "hey no slashing," and it would stop. Very rarely would a real message need to be sent to some idiot. After getting sent that message (a stick in the throat), the one who "wouldn't listen" tended not to return to our games.

One of my most enjoyable teenage moments was just playing catch with my friend Dave. We just threw a ball back and forth, and talked a bit about our day and what was going on in our lives. It was a terrific way to spend 40 or 50 minutes. I wish it was something that was still a part of my day now.

More and more our society is taking this away from children, while they become more and more socially inept.⁷⁸ When looking at this ancient way of raising children Elizabeth Thomas wrote, "*We are sometimes told that children who are treated kindly become spoiled, but this is because those who hold that opinion have no idea how successful such measures can be. Free from frustration or anxiety, sunny and cooperative...the Ju/'hoan children*

78 Add now the continuous use of a screen, and then the insanity of locking up people (especially children) from seeing each other between 2020-2022, and there is no surprise that young people today are pretty much totally socially unadjusted.

*were every parent's dream. No culture can ever have raised better, more intelligent, more likable, more confident children.”*⁷⁹

But flash forward to today. Now if there are outdoor activities, they are all structured by adults. It happened because more and more parents got conditioned that it was unsafe for children to be outside without an adult watching and controlling everything. It is one thing to protect kids from possible predators, it is another to step in and dictate how kids should play. They know how to play and look after disputes, just leave them alone to do that.

One odd belief is that if kids play on their own they get hurt more. In my games around my house there were many “small injuries” (where you might need a band aid, or give someone a minute or two to walk something off) but few large ones. When you are not a part of a team with a coach and have parents yelling from the stands that their child has to win, that structure forces the child to “push themselves to please their parents.” Nothing is worse for referees than insane parents at children’s sporting. Some hockey organizations in Canada had to ban all parents from the arena to stop the abuse the referees (and children) were receiving. The greatest safety element about free play is that you could stop anytime and just go home. We were not “required” to be there, and need to push ourself to absolute breaking points so a coach or parent can pat themselves on the back. Lancy mirrored this loss of play by writing, *“We are no longer protecting; we are preventing them from taking advantage of a plethora of opportunities to learn through experience.”*⁸⁰

In a HG society, the children were learning as they lived. Hunting and gathering may not seem as important a use

⁷⁹ Gray pg 38

⁸⁰ Lancy pg 65, <https://www.thendobetter.com/arts/2024/11/1/peter-gray-transforming-education-play-self-directed-learning-parenting-podcast>

of time as being stuck in a seat at school staring at a blackboard (or now some sort of screen). The learning process to hunt and gather requires a lot of knowledge, understanding, skills, and fitness. All sorts of things get learned from hunting such as making and repairing weapons, tracking animals, and having good communication skills to work as a unit. For gathering, one needs to learn all of the edible and medicinal properties of thousands of plants, the various ways to use them, what ailments they treat, and where they can be found. Because when on the move, plants have to be found in a new location. You have to know what you are looking for, and the signs of where they may when you need them.

Sharing is something that was built into the entire framework of the HG society, so everyone was exposed to the idea at a very early age, and presented as the expected behavior. Peter Gray discussed, *“For us today, sharing is a praiseworthy act of generosity, for which a thank-you is due and some form of repayment may be expected in the future. For hunter-gatherers, sharing is neither a generous act nor an implicit bargain, but a duty. It is taken for granted that you will share if you have more than others; failure to do so would invite ridicule and scorn.”*⁸¹

Children in many tribal societies have things that we would call chores. It could be as simple as helping gather water, or keep a close eye on a village fire so that it did not go out. These small responsibilities were testing grounds where they could prove that they were getting ready to handle bigger responsibilities.

Early anthropologists indicated that children were often praised when they did things the community valued, but the parents *“never beat, scold, or behave aggressively with them, physically or verbally,”* for doing something that was deemed inappropriate by the tribe.⁸² One of the best discussions of this subject was Kim Anderson’s interviews with Cree and

81 Gray chapter 2

Chippewa elders. To the Protestant and Catholic missionaries, such kind treatment of children was deemed horrible as Amelia Paget (1867–1902) wrote of settlers reaction to the child rearing practices of the Plains Cree, “*the love of their [the Cree’s] children was a particularly pathetic trait in their natures. The youngsters were actually adored, and consequently would impress a stranger as being very badly brought up. They were never corrected for any faults, but, up to a certain age, did as they pleased, when, of their own accord, they seemed to realize the respect due to their parents.*”⁸³

Instead of an angry response from elders, the child on breaking a tribal rule might be held for shame or ridicule from the group at a night dance or gathering. They were showing how easy their standing in the community could be “hurt” by not behaving in ways that was good for all. Anderson also recounts people who recalled their parents had told them stories or myths after they had misbehaved, to gain a better understanding of what they had done, which the man claimed taught him about community and responsibility.⁸⁴ Sadly, these tribal natural ways began to end once reservation life, depression and alcohol became the norm. As tribal life became more Westernized, so too did the way children were treated.

Liedloff mentioned She mentioned in her time with the Yequana that there was almost no sense of competition. They compete, but for the sake of the activity, not to find out who is a winner.⁸⁵ She provides a great instance of just how this loss of tribal knowledge has negatively shaped all of Western understanding. Sigmund Freud’s ideas of “sibling rivalry” need for siblings to fight each other for their mother’s attention, and develop hatred toward those who seemed

82 See Lawlor, Gray, Anderson and Wikipedia “Child Development of the Indigenous Peoples of the Americas”

83 Anderson chapter 4

84 Anderson chapter 4, Lawlor pg 166, Gray pg 31

85 Leidloff pg 114, This was something that I found during my study of early Native ball sports for my book on the origin of hockey.

avored, could only happen from a study of Western elites in Austria (who were the only clients Freud had). He never went to African or Australia to study how siblings were in tribal cultures. What would he have come up with when he found siblings did not have rivalries, fight each other for “attention,” or feel the need to position themselves in a way to be sure they were the one that would get the biggest inheritance after their parents died?

Another issue is that there was no need for the parents to overly praise children, what we term today the self-esteem movement. George Carlin destroyed this concept in a 20 minute segment during his 2008 special. To make “every child feel special” actually does the opposite of that. Instead of creating harmony and sharing, it generally creates ways for children to manipulate getting praise while really doing nothing worthy of it at all. Tribal people offer little praise to children, and they turn out fine.⁸⁶

HGs combined with all the time outside and the various work required, meant they stayed in good shape. Added that the food they would eat would be natural from the surrounding environment, they actually needed to eat far less than a modern human to gain the same required nutrients and calories. Added as well was that many of night ceremonies involved dancing, it is no surprise that the average adult in an Arapaho or Zulu village was in good shape. They were not gorging on frozen pizza and watching Netflix all day. They were active, and a healthy body generally translates into a healthier mind. As I have mentioned many times, a HG (while not an easy life) did “work” far less than the modern human, thus had more “free” time for their own activities, to play, sing, or just sit by the river watching the water rush by.

In Aboriginal society, girls do not play with dolls, as they are not raised to think that childbirth and raising children

86 Doucliffe pg 38-39, Anderson chapter 4

is their main role (what in a sense a doll is subconsciously teaching). “Rather girls spend their time drawing in the sand and learning about spiritual symbols. They use these to spin yarns about family life, the exploits of people they observe in the camp, or stories modeled on those given to them by the elders.”⁸⁷ Their attention is thus put towards human relationships. Boys meanwhile learn to make toy shields, spears and boomerangs, and they will begin to get a sense of their connection to worlds and states of awareness beyond the material realm. The only element of Aboriginal society that children were forbidden to see or know about, was men’s and women’s sacred ceremonies. They could only learn about these via their own personal experience through their own puberty rites.

As an aside about the loss of time children now have. I was hearing now about how much homework even younger children are given today. Prior to high school (say grade 5-8), homework was rather infrequent. It averaged less than thirty minutes an evening. If we are already forcing children to be in a school seven hours a day, and if you give homework on top of that, when exactly do they get to be children?

For all the faults I give to my parents, I can’t in this area of freedom. I pretty much had no rules. Even at age seven if I wanted to stay up and watch Johnny Carson or a Western Movie, that was fine. I just had to get up on time for school. I could pretty much go anywhere, as long as I was home when they asked me to. As long as I followed the basic rules, I could manage the rest of my life myself. Part of the person that I have become is definitely one that can look after my time, and tend never to be late. That came from giving me space and seeing what I would do with it. I could have lost those privileges, but I worked within the boundaries (appreciating having them) and used the space wisely.

87 Lawlor pg 174

My mother wanted me to become a school teacher. I think she was disappointed that I never did. Many who know me have always insisted that I would have made an excellent high school history teacher. But by the time I completed university, I had enough of the whole school concept. And I mostly enjoyed my school life, I was very lucky and given a lot of freedom by the principals and teachers that I had to be “as creative as I wanted to”...within reason of course. But I wanted something else. I wanted to walk my own path, not what my parents, school, or any authority figure wanted me to be.

I guess this element of walking my own way is a part of my make up. When I had become the student council vice president in high school, one of my chores was to plan the theme for school dances. Needless to say that I listened to what the fellow students seemed to want, and tried to place that with my own ideas. It did not really matter to me what the “teacher advisors” suggested, as the dances were not for them. I learned how to navigate being told “no, you are not allowed,” what the edge of the limits were, and to know that one step would be fine, but not two. Things tended to work out in the end, so the teacher’s tended to let me go that one more step because the “track record” indicated it would tend to be all right.

A few years after I graduated, I had a conversation with a younger player on my hockey team, who I found out used me as his hockey model (and as we went to the same high school). He became the student council president after I left, and had to have discussions with the same teacher-advisor I had to deal with. He told me that the previous day he had mentioned to this advisor that he wanted to have a toga dance. The teacher outright refused.

“But I went to one when Howdie was here,” my friend countered.

“That was a long time ago. We don't do those anymore. Well, we didn't do them then, but...” and he trailed off. “So you have to choose another theme. Ok?” the teacher responded.

Seeing he had no real recourse my friend said he replied to the advisor, *“Ok....But Howdie would have done it.”*

My friend told me the teacher got an odd smirk on his face, a smirk of partial respect and partial memories of years of annoyance from me and simply replied, *“I know.”*

*

The Screen

*“Anyone under the age of 25 has lived their whole life with a smartphone and constant access to the internet and social media.”*⁸⁸ Jonathan Haidt

Young people today are under siege, but not by any invading army. At first we were all invaded by this thing called school, which is a modern invention that was not created to serve the creation of learning for children, but a type of prison-like environment to mold children into becoming meek to authority. I have an additional material section on the origin of the modern schools system and what its main goals really are. I recommend you read it if you have not read the books of someone like John Gatto. But today we have added a second prison for modern children, a screen.

Just last night, my wife and I went out to dinner, and at the table beside us was a 30-something couple with a young child of about four or five years old. As soon as their meal ended, the mother gave the child an I pad, so the kid could

88 Haidt pg 5

stare at a screen for the next twenty minutes, and thus not bother the parents with, you know, conversation. The parents had no idea what else to do with their child but shove a screen in front of them. Of course, just two minutes later the two parents picked up their phones and stared at their screens for the next 18 minutes as well. I mean they wouldn't want to, you know, talk to each other. I see this everywhere. If I get on a train car of fifty people, there might only be four or five others not looking at screens. Its rather terrifying, how fast this has happened, and how all pervasive it is.

A great majority of modern children no longer play with friends out in a park, on the street, or even in the back yard. They are looking at a screen. As Jacques Ellul described almost forty years ago, "*The media era is the era of loneliness.*" A child needs to be face to face with peers to learn body cues, facial expressions, and social interactions. The covid era destroyed young children's development more than anyone could imagine. People turn to the screen, trying to find a cure for loneliness, because almost no one it seems can remember how to spend time with other people. One primary school in Northern Ireland, when giving the children blocks to play with, found out they used them to make make-believe iPads or phones.⁸⁹ That is how far it has gotten.

Nicholas Carr in his book *The Big Switch* summed up the problem of this technology very well, "*Computer systems are not, at their core, technologies of emancipation. They are technologies of control. They were designed as tools of monitoring and influencing human behavior, for controlling what people do and how they do it.*"⁹⁰ The screen itself is only part of the problem, what is on the screen is the bigger one.

The changes on the minds and behavior patterns of people from television was presented in Jerry Mander's excellent 1977 book *The Four Arguments for the Elimination of*

⁸⁹ Anonymous "Caught"

⁹⁰ Carr *The Big Switch*

Television. But then came home computers, then laptops, and now smartphones. There have been serious effects on the brains of young people from all of them. Many young people, if away from their phone (and screens) for even a few hours, can start to cause anxiety, dizziness, sweating, abdominal pain, some of the standard attributes of withdrawal symptoms. Even today when the average person tries to read a book, they get his with anxiety because they are not checking their email or social media posts. Besides who wants to read a book because there is no way to make that post to one of your feeds pretending that you are having the greatest moment of your life.⁹¹

So great has been the way that the brain has been reconstituted by screens that Dr. Manfred Spitzer came with a new term, “digital dementia,” which he describes as a loss of memory, concentration, and reasoning power due to the overuse of digital technology. Many young people can not remember simple things such as their phone number. What many tend to forget is that, if you are focused on a screen, then you are not doing something else, something natural or human. The brain is only learning reliance and time with technology. Some, without an answer from chatGPT, don’t even know what shoes to wear or breakfast to have. I am not exaggerating. They don’t eat breakfast if the power is down and they can not access chatGPT to tell them what to have.

There are many reasons why screens are so dangerous for childhood development. One is that the belief that the screen will give them an instantaneous correct answer about everything. There is no need look for oneself, and no need to question what the screen says. The black scrying mirror of the Middle Ages is now our screens, and the information that they provide is considered God-like and unquestionable. Twenty-five years ago the Internet was mostly open, and if

91 Information from Haidt, Mander, Bland “Driven to,” Annoymous “Caught”

you wanted to find an opinion on just about anything, you could. Today the Internet is getting very centralized, censored and controlled. To rely on a search tends to only bring “safe” web pages that offer no thinking challenges. *The Dead Internet* is more than just a theory, it is becoming reality.⁹²

Another problem is that the screen brings so many seemingly interesting experiences in rapid succession (hits of dopamine), that the regular normal world comes to be seen as boring with its much slower succession of events. Added that social media has conditioned young people that every action they take (since it will be posted online) should be judged to see how much attention they might be able to generate from doing it.⁹³

Long ago there were role models, and these were people that tended to have done something valuable in a community, city or even country, to have earned this. Today those who seem to have the most prestige are called “an influencer” because so many corporate firms want to pay him or her to advertise their product. However all they have done for this perceived special status is, if a girl, to show her body in a bikini enough times, or a guy rap a hammer on his balls enough times. Flashing your tits or bashing one’s balls is not how sane society determines the status of a role model.⁹⁴ All this is doing is setting our modern world on an trajectory for a world similar to the 2006 movie *Idiocracy*. Some might argue that we are already there.

I will leave the overview of a subject that would be a book project in itself. But perhaps it may make clearer as to

92 Dead Internet refers to searches that show 2.5 million results, but then only turn up 20 pages (around 400 when you go scrolling). What happened the other 2.4+ million? It seems like they have vanished. There are many old websites that I recall, that no matter the search words I can never find unless I have the exact name of the website.

93 Haidt pg 99

94 Haidt pg 60

why we are seeing so few *natural adults* in our current world, for we are not generating natural childhoods. It is more than the coming-of-age process that is missing, so too is the *natural childhood* to prepare the adolescent for it.

CHAPTER 5

BEING ROOTED⁹⁵

One of the losses the modern world has gone through for the previous 12,000 years is the distortion of the feminine and masculine principles. I wanted to share a short overview because this subject directly impacts the lack of modern coming-of-age ceremonies. On examining the so-called experts on these subjects today, it seems those on masculinity only know how to work out at the gym and find new ways to lie to women; while those on femininity only seem to know how to fix their hair and put on make up. That is about the level of information that is currently out there. So what can we learn from a deeper examination?

Firstly, one must understand what exactly has been distorted. Since femininity and masculinity are Divine Principles, they can't be distorted. They just are. The same way that Yin and Yang can never be distorted. But their mirror expression in the world, what we call feminine and masculine, can be. The more distorted they became, the less these two principles can interact well together for the purposes of balance and manifestation. That is what almost no one understands. Feminine and masculine on their own are not the issue, but whether they are true to their foundation and then, like the Yin-Yang symbol, can blend together into one harmonious whole.

95 I know my Australian readers may look at this chapter title a bit differently. It wasn't my intention for the double entendre, but once I saw it, I got a laugh and decided to leave the title as is, as it sort of applies as well.

It is important to understand that everyone has an aspect of Divine femininity and masculinity within. One is meant to be dominant, and the other secondary. Certain moments of action in day-to-day life require access to one principle or the other. Many Western languages, such as French and Spanish, still have masculine and feminine within them. Few ask why. Martin Prechtel in *Secrets of the Talking Jaguar* discussed that the Mayan language expressed what part of yourself was needed for an activity in the word. He gave the example of collecting water, which is a feminine word, so the task had to be done in a feminine way. That does not mean only women could collect water. Men or boys could collect water, but they had to do it in a feminine way. That is why women usually did the activity, as they should have more direct access to a feminine core so they just had to be in their natural state, while a male would have to “shift his focus” to be slightly feminine in the moment of the collection.⁹⁶

This is not about alternative lifestyles. They are one’s personal choice about looking for happiness within the material realm, and it is equal to any other choice of options in a search for happiness. This book is about discovering the ancient mindset for keeping the natural world in balance. Tribal decisions were about the survival of the tribe, and the world they depended on for that survival. Certain foundations made this balancing principle easier to maintain.⁹⁷

If you went out on the street and asked twenty random people to define femininity and masculinity, most

96 English has now become the most connecting language in the world, and it is interesting that it is one without gender placed into it. That to me is a telling insight in the direction that the modern technological world wants to move towards.

97 Many ancient cultures had a term for certain people who were neither overly masculine or feminine, Native Americans used the term “two-spirits.” They were accepted within the tribe, seen as prophetic, yet at the same time they never fully fit in with the structure of standard village life.

would either just stare at you with no idea on the matter, or if they do answer it would be similar ideas that women are soft and emotional, while men are logical and aggressive. Something along those lines.

Over the last fifty years, most of the world's problems have been blamed on men, or more specifically, what is labelled “toxic masculinity.” Many women have come to believe that if you just got rid of all men, or made them act like women, the world would be perfect. And sadly, a world without coming-of-age ceremonies has left 10% of the male population that can be qualified as dangerous or seriously confused. Then there are the mass of over-50 men with beer guts who know more about the Dallas Cowboys than their own family. But if you look closely, the majority of men out there are decent, but they are no longer sure how to fit into a world that seems to not want them around.

The problem is not men or masculinity. The problem is the loss of Divine Masculinity. Few today understand what this principle is, or why it is so important to the balance of the world. Things could not get this crazy if a *natural masculine* force was present and accepted, which is why it has been purposefully inverted. What does exist in men is mostly kept private for families and small communities, thus is seen rarely in the larger day-to-day world, so much so that no one can even define it, and it gets focused on the concept of having big arms and making decisions. The few that get to experience *natural masculinity* in person should consider themselves incredibly fortunate. The only way it can grow once again is for this principle (at a Divine Core) be valued and appreciated, by both men and women.

On the flip side, there are also many men who believe that all the problems of the world are due to women. And in the West one has to ask where have all the feminine women over 25 gone? They seem to have been replaced by women who are unhealthy and have a constant scowl on their face.

They seem to have forgotten how to create a playful and fun environment for those around them. It is not the appearance of anyone that is most important, but the underlying feminine principle that is no longer getting mirrored into the form, so the form begins to appear more masculine. Femininity can still often be found in young women under the age of 25, but it seems as soon as a woman hits that magic age, their femininity immediately drains from them. It gets drained because young women are taught that femininity is not valuable in modern society, only that she can beat the boys at everything.

Men are told masculinity is of no value, and women are told femininity is of no value. It is no surprise that young people are having trouble.

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Confused 20s

Since the 1960, girls have become the societal focus. There was a recognition in the 1950s that girls tended to fall behind in most schooling areas (especially math and sciences), so changes were made to the system. So too began a push to get as many women as possible into the workforce (which I will discuss in detail in the next book). Twenty years later it was young women who were climbing up the job ladders, and who became the higher percentage of those in university. Since then girls continue to rise, while boys continue to fall off a cliff faster than Wile E. Coyote.

Women are ahead in almost every area. Young women make up 58% of American university students, are more likely to own a home, and tend to out earn young men at these ages. They have better opportunities for work, and now almost completely dominate the very influential fields of publishing, media, and university administration. More young

men live with their parents than a partner.⁹⁸ On the over all pay scale men do out earn women on a national basis, but that is only skewed because of professional athletes and CEOs (who are mostly men). That is because men tend to be the only ones self centered enough to basically give up their life to put in the 80-hour work weeks that it requires to rise to the be a ten million dollar a year executive. No feminine woman would think that to never see their family is a good idea, so few women have decided to claw their way to the top, and lose their family in the process. But more women in their 30s today are beginning to recognize that for all of the steps up the success ladder they have taken, they are not any happier or living with less stress.

The stress on girls begins early now thanks to social media. Modern people tend to have two key motivations, one is to stand out, and the other is to connect. Early on boys choose more games to try and stand out among others, while girls choose more communion games. Social media seems to be about connecting, but actually does just as much of creating problems and conflict. Since 2010, the need to post specifically controlled and manipulated photos of oneself has been an explosion. All so that the poster can be judged and either given a ton of attention to increase their self importance, or potentially be shamed by others and wind up emotionally hurt. Boys use aggression as their violence tool, girls use shaming and exclusion to cause problems in social relationships, and with reputations.⁹⁹

Upcoming is definitely a story I am not proud of. Some of you thought I might seem like a perfect guy. Well, read on.

In grade 13 I had a lot of “power” at my high school. I was very well liked, and if I said that something was good or bad, a large percentage of the student population would be

98 Neitzel “Women Continue,” Farrell, Haidt

99 Haidt pg 6, 170-72

persuaded to agree with me. As such I had a great challenge of handling power. I mostly used it for very positive things, but one time in particular, due to the fact that I felt hurt at that moment, I used this power in a poor way. I had gone on a few dates with Jennifer, a girl I had genuine feelings for. I had met her the year before in a singing contest that I was MC-ing, and in the rehearsals one of her dance moves accidentally caught me on the nose, bloodying it. Maybe how things went she might have wanted to hit me harder.

I was in the midst of recovery from a serious shoulder injury, and had to limit the amount of physical activity I could partake in. Even though not able to be my normal self, the time I spent with Jen was really helpful for my healing process. Then one day I found she had been on a date with someone else. I was crushed, for this had also happened with my first girlfriend many years earlier. All of those painful feelings from the past came to the surface, and mixed together. Instead of using this experience to go deeper to locate inner knowledge, or see that at that moment with a shoulder that couldn't function, I wasn't really in the best state to date anybody. I chose to blame Jennifer for how I felt about myself and the frustration around my injury. Still my mind came up with those fateful words, "she can't do that to me."

At school next Monday I told a few people what a rotten person she was for dating someone else. Those ten people told their friends, and within a day, the whole school knew. I was so trusted at the time that people just took my view of reality as the correct one, and began to ignore a girl they previously did not even know existed.

I only saw Jennifer once after high school ended, three or four years later for coffee. It was then that she told me the truth of how the final year of high school had been for her. How she cried nightly and hated coming to school in the morning. All because of what I had said about her to a

few friends, but the backlash was intense. I felt her pain completely as she was sharing what a year of everyone hating her was like. While it was difficult to hear, and I was disappointed in myself, I was grateful that she told me. I gained a new resolve before saying goodbye that I needed to make some serious changes to an ego of superiority to be sure something like that never happened with someone else again.

Jen at least you did give me a bloody nose, albeit a year in advance...

*

Young men have been confused in our current world for some time. The book *Boy Crisis* by Warren Farrell reveals just how desperate the situation is today for boys (and I share more in the chapter on boys' ceremonies). Today in the girl-centric schooling system, boys are seen as messy, disruptive, and bossy: defective girls. Boys can see that life ahead is getting challenging for them. At one time males were needed as labour, or as soldiers to protect the village from animals or bandits. Physical jobs are being lost to robots, while personal care and health are the fastest growing fields. An uneducated male in the past could have guaranteed that he could have supported himself and his family with muscle. That is no longer the case today.

Added on top of that is the message very early on that "men are expendable." When a ship is about to sink what was the call? "Women and children first." Why? You might say that a child has a longer potential future, hence the need to be saved, but why is the woman valued over the man? Should it not be the "most valuable to society, or most intelligent, no matter if they are male or female?" But it is not. For most of history, it was the young men who went to get slaughtered in wars, were horribly injured in coal mines, or went down with the ship. The message to men is that you are expendable, we

can find more like you. Hence the wedding joke of why all men are wearing tuxedos, because if the groom says no, all the men just take one step over and she marries the next guy because all men are the same.

Yet boys are still taught to pursue girls, and the main teaching tools (TV and movies) show that the only ways a woman will ever think a guy is desirable is if he has money, or if he can save her from some danger. Without either of those, quite simply he is a loser. Women expect men to pay for dates and buy them gifts (even when they probably out earn him). If he is cheap or poor, then he is unwanted. A guy must fork out the dough if he wants to fork her. Young men know this and thus there is massive pressure on them as they realize the value of masculine traits are dropping in the market. Because of this (and several other issues), many young men are just turning away from dating altogether.

Millions of young boys are also dropping out of society due to lack of purpose. Japan has a phenomena called the Hikikomori (pulling inward), where starting in the 1990s many young men retreated to their childhood bedrooms and never came out. The internet helped them create an entire seemingly lived world, though almost never going outside at all, even having parents leave food outside of their door. The reasons given for this was the intense competition standards set on young men in education and the workplace in Japan, that many felt they had no real chance anyway, so why try. That is how millions of young men in the West feel about the current dating and job situation. Things are so bad for them in those areas, so why put in the effort.

Today, a young male video gamer who plays 8+ hours a day would also fit this description of someone “caving in.” That is millions of young men in the United States. You would think this seems like a prison environment, but Haidt presented one young man who explained that his room, “*is the opposite of prison, it is freedom. There is no one here but me. I can*

do whatever, whenever. Going outside is a prison. But his room is clarity.”¹⁰⁰

This lack of purpose is a reason many young men get addicted to video games. They simulate responsibility by giving the player a goal, and making the player solely responsible for realizing that goal. Video games are about heroism and success, which young men absolutely crave and can't find in their real lives. In the past a stable functioning society was dependent on men's heroism. Who needs a heroic male today, when nothing needs to be lifted, defended from and now with appalling apathy of comfort? This is such an insane reality that for a young boy, superhero is a real career choice. Comic books are tapping into something in the young male psyche, the need to create a safe world for those around them (male, female or children). A seven-year-old realizes that the systems and governments are incapable of creating a sane world, thus what is needed are masculine superhero types. But the system makes sure it squeezes out this masculinity early, so that there are no threats to these very systems. The last five years of people giving up their freedoms could only happen without nations of strong masculine men to be sure it didn't happen.

Both sides are trying to blame the other for the modern predicament of the world, rather than see that everyone has been equally tricked by the system. If both men and women could both regain a natural understanding of this area, and then build harmonious co-operation between each other, things could change. But that will not happen until the masses see that you do not go looking for answers in how people lived in 1950 or even 1850, but in 10,000 BC.

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While both principles exist within, but before a man can deal with his inner feminine, or a woman her inner

100 Haidt pg 179-180, <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hikikomori>

masculine, each must focus on what is likely their natural core. This is where much of the Movements of the last 70 years have gotten things distorted. They wanted women to ignore their feminine and start acting like men, and for men to stop expressing the masculine and act more emotional. All this has done is distort the core foundations, which means there is no co-operation with one's inner or outer mirrors, and the world spinning out of balance because of it.

That is what the coming-of-age ceremonies were meant to do, awaken the inner adult versions of these Divine Principles, and through the learning from role models, to deepen and strengthen those attributes. A *natural adult* is rooted in their natural core, and thus can access other principles within when required.

That is the value in external mirror work. For example, once a man has embraced his masculine core, located his purpose and begins to live his direction, he can start to examine the feminine in his life. The females he knows will give him an indication of the health of his inner female. Back in 1995, I had gone on four dates in a row with four strange women. After the fourth I began to complain about "what was wrong with the women of Toronto?" But after really contemplating the subject, I realized that I was the common denominator in the equation. Terrific women existed out there, but I wasn't meeting them. That had to indicate that something was "off" within me. I was meeting mirrors. So I stopped dating to go looking at who exactly this inner female within me was, and what was the state of her health. The more I focused on harmonizing that, different women began to appear in my outer world.

Actually, the best relationship partner a person could choose would be a perfect mirror of their inner counterpart. Then if the person you are with is growing and transforming, your inner world must be as well. Thus you have a personal vested interest in the development of said partner, because

your inner side will be transforming along with them. This mirror work does not need to be any type of marriage or even a romantic relationship. This can all be done with a close friend, or even a work colleague that you spend a lot of time with. But the more your core state is in health, then this mirror work can have value. If your core state is not healthy and rooted as a good mirror of a Divine Principle, all mirror work for your other half will become frustratingly slow.

I don't want to suggest that either men or women need to be in a relationship or be married. A *natural adult* has built the only relationship they need to cultivate, the one with themselves. Once you get comfortable with who you really are, there is no need to break that peaceful harmony unless you feel another person will bring something more. Being single and simple is just as good a choice as a relationship. Each will have to decide if the positives of adding another person to their life story out way the challenges. In most cases it won't. But the main work is always within, and the more calm one becomes within, the less the outer world is seen as something that we "need" rather something that can be lived.

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Ancient World

This book is about how the ancient tribal world saw these principles in action. A great pointer came from Robert Lawlor in his book *Voices of the First Day*. He suggested that for Aboriginal women, "*Childbearing is an incidental rather than primary function of an Aboriginal woman. Her primary function is maintaining harmonious relationships between human and psychic energies within society, as well as the harmony of the human society with the Earth. Women are the hidden force behind the sacred attitudes that allow the Earth to remain a generative field that nourishes and sustains life.*"¹⁰¹ Does that not sound like an existence that most women today would love to live and embody, as opposed to

101 Lawlor pg. 163

following the ideas of modern civilization which has simply worn them out? For me one of the key pointers is that the female was in charge of “maintaining harmonious relationships,” and not just between people, but between people and nature as well. Hence the focus is not just to have relationships, but harmonious relationships. To accomplish that task actually requires great knowledge and skill, both of people’s psychological make-ups, as well as the foundations of nature. They have to become very intuitive to know how to smoothly navigate problems with others before they can even begin.

Lawlor presented that for the Aboriginal male, life was less about acting upon the material world but “*to participate in the balance of natural creative forces on the metaphysical plane. To act on that which has already entered the physical world is too late (once the spirit energy has materialized)...deep states of consciousness to enter these beyond material worlds are required.*” Modern men would enjoy a life where they are more seen as spiritual beings and protectors, and less of workhorses. Lawlor was clear to mention that for Aboriginals the material world was the domain of the female, while Aboriginal men focused on the worlds beyond (of death and the pre-born). The women to keep the Earth in balance, while men keep the spirit world in balance.¹⁰²

Keeping the spirit world in balance means dealing directly with the demonic beings (archons) that reside in the astral, that try to impact, control, and create suffering in the material realm. Women are supposed to keep close watch on what is going on in the material, so the men see if any cracks in the astral have occurred that need to be mended. Remember, that protection for a feminine woman creates the space for playfulness to arise, and a calm space where the man can find a place to rest. That is an example of how these two dynamics are meant to interplay for each other’s benefit.

102 Lawlor pg 179-181

Modern relationships tend to be about only “what’s in it for me?” It should be about, “what’s in it for everyone?”

The masculine and feminine are designed to bring these two seemingly separate realms (material and spirit) together into a lived whole. The female teaches the male of the material and life, the male teaches the female of the other realms and the Void. There is meant to be a dance between these two Universal Powers. Few seem to understand this core of co-operative principles. Neither femininity or masculinity are or can be superior to the other. They are two sides of a coin, two halves of the yin-yang. As soon as one goes out of balance, so will the other.

The loss of a natural HG world, has meant the destruction of the Earth’s habitats, wildlife, and has led to the poisoning of everything, including the basic connections between humans. It also means, as Robert Lawlor said so well, that when civilization came, “*men no longer had the roles of ecstatic trance dancer, the wandering highly sensitized and perceptive hunter, and the mystic absorbed in the power of animal dreaming. A man became instead the guardian of the tedious cycles of controlled cultivation, the builder of complex stagnant settlements, the soldier/defender of fixed boundaries and territories, the deceitful profiteer of material possessions and exchanges, and the ruler of subjugated flocks, both human and animal.*” While for women, “*the change was equally radical. No longer could she embody all the forms of the Universal Female: the ravished virgin, the ritual prostitute, the all loving mother, the healing and nurturing wife, the laughing storyteller, the wandering, silent, old, wise woman. (Now) the Universal Feminine primarily took the form of the Earth-mother hag who men tormented and exploited to maintain their authority over her natural power and propensity to give life and nourish.*”¹⁰³

To me these quotations explain much of the mess we find ourselves in.

103 Lawlor pg. 373

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Power of Encouragement

I want to make a point here about what someone really rooted in their masculinity or femininity can do for someone else. I was going to save this story for the next book, but I feel that it is so important as an example so I am going to share it here.

I have met a few truly feminine women in my life, and I can say just sitting across the table was a genuine uplifting and calming experience. There is a magnetic quality to it, and the rewards just sitting with such a woman can be surprising. This is a bit of a story of how I became the person who could write these books. But first some background.

I had a vision to be a writer in the summer of 1992, but not from a standard Vision Quest. I was back in university after one year away, and had gathered “just enough” money to get started on my final year. Classes had yet to start, but I already felt anxiety about the entire process. All of my key friends had graduated, the hockey team had moved on to better left wingers than me, and I felt out of place back at school. So I decided to go to a church that was just down the street. I had never been to a church for advice, but decided to see what the local priest would tell me.

It was around two o'clock in the afternoon that I walked up the steps to the main church door. It was locked. I pulled on the door a second time to be sure. I walked around to see if there was a side door that was open. No. Why was such a place not even open during what would be thought of as “normal business hours.” I realized there was nothing for me there. As I walked home I decided that the best way to get a handle on things was to write it out.

That night I began to write my first novel. I wrote for a week before realizing that it was poorly written, with no real plot or characters. So I threw it in the garbage. But it did what it needed to do, I got what was going on inside of me down on paper to see it more clearly. I finished the school year, completed my thesis, graduated, and looked ahead. Even though the novel went nowhere, the process of writing had begun to speak to me as a life direction.

The next summer I was with what I can only describe as a “high maintenance” woman. One night she asked about my plans for the future. I told her that I thought I wanted to be an author, that I had a few book ideas that interested me to write in the upcoming years.

She looked at me horrified. *“What? Writing. Are you crazy? You can't make money being a writer. That's a stupid profession. You have to have a career that makes money. How can we travel if you are just a poor writer? Really.”*

Needless to say within two weeks she had kicked me to the curb for a guy that she felt was more focused on dollar signs than I was. The lack of encouragement on something important to me really hurt. That is one of women's great gifts for a man, to encourage him to fulfill his vision or purpose. When a man does not get encouragement from the women in his life, he can feel like he is in a boat alone at sea. Her words were so crushing that my writing hopes stayed just floating until I saw the *Nova* documentary in 1997,¹⁰⁴ and my vision of writing was rekindled. But it took someone to take my writing to the next level.

In 1999 I met a different woman. She was the most feminine woman I had ever encountered. In some ways much of what I learned about femininity, I learned from her. I met her prior to a comedy show I was performing at. The show

104 Story discussed in my book *Falling For Truth*

was about thirty minutes from starting in a local bar of a small Western Canadian town. There were about fifty people currently there, about forty of them guys. I was standing watching a game of pool that was taking place, when my head automatically began to turn towards the door. As it was happening, I noticed that just about every guy's head was also turning. There was no cue, no sound, just something innately made every guy's head turn at the exact same time.

Just walking in were two women of around 24-years old. They were both attractive, but neither would be described as "beautiful." One of them, a woman I will call C, had her long blonde hair in a ponytail, and was wearing tight jean shorts that revealed her very in-shape legs. I realized later that "what she looked like" did not make our heads turn, but how feminine she was. She was like a magnet for anything masculine in the room.

I noticed that the girls were having a discussion at the ticket table, likely about whether they should pay the five dollars to come in for the show. The thought came that these girls had to stay. Normally at this time prior to a show, I would go outside and just take some deep breaths and go over my starting ten minutes. So I walked towards the door to do that, and interact with the girls. They were still discussing with the ticket person about the show, and I leaned over and said to them as I walked past, "*If I were you I wouldn't stay, I hear the comedians are ugly.*" Then I smiled, and C gave me a smile back, and I saw them dig into their purses. They were staying.

I focused that night on doing a great show. While there is more to this story, I will move ahead to when we had wound up back in my hotel room several hours later. The night had gone wonderfully, our conversation was terrific and our connection was getting quite strong. On a table in the hotel room I had forgotten that I had left a "what would I like to do in my life" list. It was an exercise from some Self-

Help book that I read, where you place on paper all the things you want do and experience in the future. I had everything from the books I wanted to write, to the places to travel, to the kind of day-to-day life I wanted.

C saw the paper and picked it up. At first I tried to take it out of her hands, embarrassed about how she would see my goofy wishes. She read it. Line by line, slowly. When she was done she carefully placed the paper back on the table, looked at me and said, *“That was amazing.”* She placed her hand on my shoulder and added, *“I think you are going to accomplish almost all of this. I see great things out of you.”*

It was one of the sweetest things ever said to me. It had such impact because she was giving this compliment honestly, not as something she thought I might want to hear or trying to get something from it. The honesty is what made it so powerful to me. Because of her encouragement, I changed my focus to take being an author seriously. I started to learn how to write, how to craft sentences. Because of her I changed from being a guy trying to write a book, to a writer with a soon to be completed book. The change seems small on the surface, but it was massive within.

Some may ask, why did I not marry this woman? Fair question. This goes back to the mirrors. She was attractive, intelligent, and feminine. That put her at the top of just about any guy’s “list.” She had options. And being around someone so feminine, tested the state of my inner masculine, which was nowhere as healthy and complete as her feminine. It only took a few more dates for my inner cracks to appear to her. When she let me know that we couldn’t go on any more dates, as she was seeing a guy who owned a restaurant, she still wound up encouraging me. While she said that I wasn’t the guy she was looking for in her life, I did have an important job ahead of me, to write the subjects I wanted to write. She sensed there was power in where I was headed, and

she reminded me to make writing my number one life priority. Things would work out for me if I did.

I haven't seen her in 27 years, but in case she reads this, I say thank you. If those of you who feel my books have had value to you, then you might want to say thanks to her as well. That is the power that a few small sentences of honest encouragement from a well-meaning feminine woman can have on a man who has found, or is searching for, his vision.¹⁰⁵ I have also heard similar stories from female friends of mine on the impact some encouragement from a masculine man had on their lives. Slightly different presentation, but similar result.

As an aside, in 2009, ten years after meeting C, I looked over that list. Over half of the items on it had been "experienced."

*

Modern Relationships

"Peter," she asked, trying to speak firmly, 'what are your exact feelings for me?'

'Those of a devoted son, Wendy.'

'I thought so,' she said, and went and sat by herself at the extreme end of the room.

'You are so queer,' he said, frankly puzzled, 'and Tiger Lily is just the same. There is something she wants to be to me, but she says it is not my mother.'

*'No, indeed, it is not,' Wendy replied with frightful emphasis"*¹⁰⁶ J.M. Barrie (Peter Pan)

105 I also thank my wife for elements, more on the material world side, that contributed to me being able to write these books. That story is for a future volume.

106 J.M. Barrie, *Peter Pan* chapter 10 "The Happy Home"

I am not going to speak in detail in this book about relationships today, except in one specific area because it seems to impact so many. That is how in the majority of long-term male-female relationships, we don't have two adults, but symbolically a little boy with his mother. The relationship often did not start out that way, but in time, the male fell into little boy mode and the women responded by stepping into mommy role. I have told this idea to perhaps 400 people over the last decade, and just about everyone (especially the women) agree with it completely.

The male has three, let's call them templates. One is the little boy (that is meant to encompass his child and adolescent years), the second is the adult male (to be activated and stepped into past the age of 18). The younger the boy, the more "feminine" he is in relation to the world around him. As the boy grows and reaches puberty, masculine energy will begin to appear, with the idea that it starts to strengthen at the point when the coming-of-age process should occur. The third template would be husband, a role where the adult male needs to make some adjustments to combine his life with another person.

Women have four templates. One is the little girl stage (similar to that of the boy), which is feminine. The second is the adult woman stage, again feminine. The third template is the wife stage, where she also moves to a new role and makes adjustments to combine her life with another. The fourth stage for women is the mother. If you notice there was no fourth stage for the male (father) because in most cases there is little difference energetically in the non-father and the father. In women this is not the case. The mother is a completely different entity to the feminine woman or wife. The difference is, the mother's operation mode is both feminine and masculine.

Mother energy has two sides, and each have their place. If both are used properly, it will lead to healthy children. The mother has a nurturing and caring side, which is the depth of the feminine directed solely for her children. But the other half is the “in control” side represented by mothers telling children what to do, “Sit up straight, eat your peas, take your jacket, don’t play in the mud, don’t look at your sister like that, be home at four.” It is this energy that organizes lunches, the time to pick up the kids, how to get both to a soccer practice, when to pick up dinner, and get everyone home and eating by seven. It’s a skill, and something mothers are built to do, but for their children. They are not meant to be in this mode with their husband, or anyone else.¹⁰⁷

But if we flash forward to today, what we have in a majority of pairings is that the male has taken the role of the little boy, and the woman the mother.¹⁰⁸ The mother is constantly telling the little boy what needs to be done, because he is not showing himself capable of doing these things on his own. Or has been shamed not to. For some it began this way right from day one. The woman was in a demanding mode, and the man became meek and did not attempt to change the behaviour or end the relationship. The second way the dynamic occurs is that a relationship began stable, but the male was unable to claim their masculinity. Men are supposed to get things completed in this realm, and the women in their lives expect they can manage this. When they behave like a little boy and get nothing accomplished, the woman has to switch to the mom role and start telling him what to do, or even worse, do all of these chores herself. If a man claims, “my wife nags me to fix the fence,” he should be asking, “why have I not fixed the fence?” and “am I being

107 I learned this idea of twin mother energy from Theun Mares’ work.

108 This dynamic also often occurs with gay couples as well, as one moves to a mother role and the other the child.

masculine in my life?” If not, she will naturally fall into a mother role and start telling him what to do.

The third way this dynamic can happen comes after the woman takes on the mother role after having her first child, but she never stops playing it until she dies. She forgets that the mother role is only for the children, while the female role is for the rest of the world (including her husband). One woman I mentioned this to, who was in her 50s with two grown children responded to me, *“I now see that I have been in mother mode for 35 years. I never stopped once the kids were grown. I am not sure I shifted out of it any time while the kids were here. I used to be a woman, and a wife. I forgot all about that side. Where did it go? How do I get it back?”*

Needless to say the little boy-mommy dynamic in relationships is at the core of the sexual issues of our time, as well as the lack of real connection in modern relationships. Men do not want to be married to their mother, and women do not want to have to spend all of their time looking after a little boy. But then again, without proper coming-of-age ceremonies and walking into *natural adulthood*, is this result such a surprise?

Recall from the Aboriginal understanding, women have the role of keeping the material realm in balance. So if the male is not doing his job with what needs to be done from his side, she has to “take it upon herself” to do what he is not. That means taking the mother role with him. If a woman does not have to be concerned that various chores promised will get done, that if a problem arises he can handle and solve it, she can stop being in a monitoring mode (mother) and move into a more relaxed and playful mode (the feminine).

The same can be said of a female. If you claim, “my husband does not notice me or want to listen to me,” ask yourself “am I being feminine with him” or are you acting like his mommy? As in the story with C above, the masculine gets drawn out by the feminine, like being around a magnet. If there is no feminine, the masculine can stay dormant. Both magnets are required to create the charge. The center point of the two magnetic charges where a piece of metal can be suspended indefinitely. That is where the power in a relationship lies. Not in one or the other, but the balanced space between them. But first each has to take the hold of their own adult inner power. As I mentioned we have both principles within, and all of this is also happening inside of us. Connecting fully with another adult outer partner can make the connection to our own between-ness within an easier process.

Men marry a woman for who she is now, and wants to be with that woman for the rest of his life. Women date men for who they think they might become, and then spend all of their time trying to fix him. She never marries a guy based on what he is now, but what her fantasy says the future will be. Men decide that what they have now is their fantasy and want to make that permanent. You can see the disconnect. It takes a clear adult to see how to go beyond the set up and create depth and common base in a relationship. This can only occur when both have seen the distorted views that civilization has put on this subject, unpacked many of them, so as to go forward in ways that suits their inner core, and not the stories of a sick society. To be cured of any illness, one first has to see the illness clearly, then one will know the steps needed to go past it.

Mating

*“We don’t see (current mating behaviors) as elements of human nature so much as adaptations to social conditions, many of which were introduced with the advent of agriculture no more than ten thousand years ago.”*¹⁰⁹ Christopher Ryan and Cacilda Jetha

The next presentation is likely going to challenge a few readers. That being the entire idea we know of as marriage likely only exists because of the switch to agriculture. I had been contemplating this concept since I began working on this project, but it was only until I came upon the book *Sex at Dawn: The prehistoric origins of modern sexuality* that I found there was someone who had researched this very idea.

Ryan and Jetha suggest that the ancient world had a more compartmentalized larger family, which often had multiple sexual partners. The premise is that if everything in a HG society is considered an equal part of the community, then sex and relationships should be seen the same way. You can’t split out one thing as being “ownership like,” and not all the rest.

Firstly, let’s look at what we have now. Agriculture created farming and land ownership. Both required large families. “Go forth and multiply,” was the foundation of the main religious text of the day, and it did not take long for anyone to not be married and have a brood of children to be deemed as having “something wrong with them.” Even ostracized from the village. There also became the need, for differing reasons, to know who specifically your offspring were, from the standpoint of ownership of property and inheritance. Within this context the Cinderella dynamic was formed, where in a perfect marriage the girl had to be the

109 Ryan and Jetha pg 10

“fairest in the land” and the man had to be a “wealthy prince.” From the standpoint of *natural adulthood* all of this is ludicrous.

For a man, running a farm without a dedicated wife and children was difficult. So he needed a lot of farm hands, and the most cost effective was to “birth” your own personal labour force. So you needed a woman partially as a shared partner, and partially as a baby factory. The life of farming, as later was industry, meant a hard life. So in those conditions it helped for two people to bind themselves to “grind through” life together, with the hope of making it a bit easier on the other. It rarely worked out that way, but that too was an underlying goal to the idea of one man locking themselves to one woman for life.

When it came to the upper classes, this idea of one man coupling with one woman for life had nothing to do with making life easier, but was to “intermingle” rich families to make them combined more important. This was the basis of arranged marriages, taking two already important families, and doubling their wealth and prestige. The wants of the people getting married were of little importance. Remember, in the HG world all elements of life were shared equally by the community. There were no land owners, no rich people, no special chiefs. Everyone had a role that fit the survival of the entire tribe, so coupling with one person could not raise the riches of any individual, as there was no stockpile of riches for the taking.

It became within this context of the upper classes that the standard principle became for men to look for attractiveness in a woman, which standard researchers claim meant that she is young and healthy, thus best to have and raise children. But how good looking someone might be is no indication of what sort of mother or friend they will be. So where did this idea originate? For the man in the marriage scenario, part of the contract is that both only have sex with

each other for the rest of their lives, yet there was the expectation of producing eight to ten children. The male had to find how to keep his sexual interest up in one person for the next 40 years to keep producing the children required, which was eventually placed within fairy tales to implant these ideas into children as early as possible.

For the young woman things were slightly different. Given that this new idea of land ownership all went through the male side, she went looking for wealth and social status to prove that he will likely be able to provide for her and her soon-to-be large brood of children. The woman believed that if the man had money and status, her life as a baby factory would be worth it. I think this bizarre dynamic was put into play at the very early stages of the start of agriculture, and as I will discuss in a future book, a trick was played on both men and women to get them to agree to this odd scenario, with each believing “they” were getting the better end of the bargain.

Given that ownership went through the male line, the male had to know who his children were so that his property would descend to his actual children. Thus two things began to happen, one to lock a woman sexually to one man (so he knew any children were his) thus you had to find ways to artificially weaken the women’s sex drive. I know it sounds counter to the base idea that men want to have lots of sex, but because of the whole “I need to sure the baby is mine” mindset, his wife can’t be too sexual or she will be sleeping with other men (who are probably more masculine).

Women had a different focus, finding protection. And the best protection was wealth. So she made a trade of her sexual activity only for this one man (which was also a loss for her) but in this case she gained (supposedly) wealth and protection. If possible, exceptional wealth in order to have “trinkets and toys” to alleviate the boredom that was to become her life. Of course this also tied her in, because to

leave, she would also lose her money and protection. A locked in dynamic was being formed.

It is only recently that there was a shift to a romantic idea of marriage, that you should find a soul mate and live happily ever after. Two hundred years in the future, historians might look back on this period as a strange outlier of history. Cinderella and the prince end the tale living happily every after because the story does not continue after the wedding. It presents the fallacy that if beauty marries money, every one is happy forever. Go look at any celebrity couple to see how fast that idea blows up in everyone's face. These tales also never present what happens when average marries normal. But average and normal are not the ways to draw in the fantasy of the masses.

Most people today have been conditioned to believe that marriage will solve all their problems, and take away a stark loneliness at the heart of most people (due to the loss of deep bonded tribal communities). And while it can solve a few problems, it also brings a whole new set of problems. Until one has solved their own original problems while still single, thus become a *natural adult*, adding a partner is not really going to do much. But religion has done a good job to shame people who like each other, and would like to share sexual experiences together, that if they do not sign a contract with the government/church they can not be allowed to have sex. We really exist in a strange reality.

I remind you that a marriage certificate is a type of contract with the government, not any sort of love union between two people. A real love union would be two people going into the forest and making their own life rules and direction together. If people are being honest, you have to see that modern marriages are really (at the contractual level) meant to be about the sharing of resources. Two single people who come together and live under the same roof double their resources. That gives more comforts: bigger

house, nicer car, more vacations, more gadgets. It helps poor people to make life a bit easier by doubling the resources and work power, and those above that level to be able to consume more products.

The consumer economy loves marriage, because if everyone lived alone, the consumption level of “non essential” items would drop dramatically. The whole contract gets symbolized by both putting on rings. The ring either represents Saturn (the planet considered the dark controlling ruler of this realm) or the moment of a solar eclipse when the moon (feminine) covers the sun (masculine). When light becomes darkness. Either way, darkness is at the heart of the ring symbol. The whole process of human relationships does not have to be this way, or have this sort of symbolism at its core, but that has been the underlying system of confusion for 12,000 years.

Getting married is one of the easiest things to do in our society. To get a driver’s license one often needs hundreds of hours of course and driving practice. But to get a marriage license, two people just have to sign their names on a piece of paper. That is amazing in itself. It would make sense if the soon to be married couple had to take a one month course together where all sorts of subjects related to married life could be presented and discussed. This would help the couple either learn key elements of how to have a better partnership right from the first moment, or even see that real life will not meet the fairy tale they had in mind, and then either make changes to their expectations, or end the marriage before it began. Getting into a modern marriage is rather easy, getting out of one, not so much.

The authors of *Sex at Dawn* saw the ancient world through very different eyes. Their presentation is that the current ideas of marriage, relationships, and sex is often an inversion to ancient HG tribal thinking. To the authors, sex and connection was no different of a shared resource than

food or water. They would have found ways to share that equally in the community as well. The book of course was roundly criticized, from being a fantasy thesis, to an impossible idea because it wouldn't produce enough babies. But again we can't use the modern mindset to understand the HG past. We have to go in with a clear mind.

There could even have been ideas such as five men and five women being together in a type of group marriage. What would be interesting about this, is that once a woman became pregnant, she would have no idea which of the five men was the actual father. Thus all five would become the father. Each would then support the raising of the child $1/5$ of the time, and each having differing skills, would provide different elements of teaching. That in itself is an interesting concept, where one man did not have to be the total package for the child. Or even for one woman. He only had to be part of a whole. Also if the actual father died, now there are four others who are still there and continuing their role. The woman and the children are not dependent on just one male and have their world collapse if he dies. Actually such a concept makes sense in a tribal concept.

The birth mother would take the majority of the focus on the raising of "her" specific child, but even then there is much evidence that many of the other women of the tribe were much included in the raising and looking after of children, even if they themselves did not have any. Women shared the role of motherhood of all children in the tribe.

Yes it is nice to have a romantic partner that you are physically attracted to. But their personality, intelligence, playfulness, and sensuality rank right up there in importance. It would be far more enjoyable to date an intelligent and playful woman than a stupid and selfish, albeit stunningly beautiful woman. And if one was in a situation where you were with five or six members of the opposite sex, all of these "attraction" points could be found in different people.

You may be able to be attracted to one because she is playful, another provides intelligent conversation, another physical beauty, another her sensual nature. The same for the women, where one man might be her intellectual match, another a physical match, another an adventure match. You did not have to worry about finding “one in a million” of perfection to fit a giant list of criteria, you just had to find something in that other person to draw you close to them without needing them to be perfect.

I hear the response. But everyone will just get jealous, and it would all spill over into arguments and fights. And in our modern world that is what would happen. One just has to look at the various hippie communes of the 1970s for examples. This type of situation could not work in a modern world designed around self-importance, consumerism and hierarchy. This concept was for the mindset of the ancient tribal HG communities. In an egalitarian world with no ownership, no property, no hierarchy, and where each depends on the other for survival and well being, everything is approached differently. My point of this book is not could you do it today, but could you do “today” then. The ancient world and the modern world are two completely different mindsets that really don’t mix well.

Ideas around the sexual dynamics of many Aboriginal tribes were presented by Robert Lawlor in chapter 12 of his *Voices of the First Day*. Simplified, Aboriginal communities did have a system of marriage. But this system was more about upkeep of tribal responsibilities and kinship connections. There were various ways for people to have sexual liaisons apart from their marriage partner, as there were days during the year where ritual ecstatic sexuality was expected, usually with someone other than their marriage partner.

The woman I mentioned earlier, C, also had a unique observation that she shared for me. She told me that she felt that within our modern world people should get married

three times in their life. She suggested that there should be one partner in our early years, say until our late 20s, who is more of a sexual and fun partner. Then a second partner starting around age 30 who would be the person we would have and raise children with. The third would be someone after the age of 50, when the children are gone and moving on to their own lives, that we in a sense “grow old with.” Her premise was that each stage of life demanded a different type of partnership. While she agreed that it was possible to find one person who was able to fulfill these three stages well, her belief that the likelihood of finding such a person was low. Thus her premise of three different partners, to fulfill three different stages of life. While on the surface it seemed very revolutionary, I have to admit that the more I thought of the conversation as I went through life, the more I wondered if she might in fact be on to something.

I am just lightly touching this entire subject here because it is vast and detailed. The point is that how we see these terms, relationships, sexuality and even personal responsibility are nothing like how these areas were looked at in the ancient tribal world. It was built to foster community and survival. And the coming-of-age ceremonies were a part of that entire package.

*

Going Forward

In a fully healthy society there would not be an elevation of one side or another. There would not be a father figure on a pedestal (God to religions) nor the Earth being a mother. To have a functioning society, these two principles would be in balance. That does not mean things need to be equal in terms of how that word is thought of today, but equal in their importance for the whole. The first stage would

be to incorporate the Earth Mother with the Divine Father, until there is no separation between Earth and sky.

Each has a power, but it is not about using one side independently or separately. The feminine has a talent for organizing, the masculine for delegating. The feminine for playfulness, the masculine for competition. The feminine for options, the masculine for solutions. Part of the reason they come together, even just as good friends, is for example the women to learn healthy competition from the men, and men to learn playfulness from the women. Relationships are supposed to be about deepening what is excellent about both, not digging into which side as being correct.

The problems between men and women (and men and men, and women and women) are not organic, nor have they evolved over time. Many have been artificially created and fostered. By the use of distortion, the forces behind the scenes that run the world's systems, make true co-operation among people almost impossible. It keeps everyone fighting against each other, rather than coming together harmoniously and intelligently. The underlying problem is not men, or women, or anyone else within reality. It is the reality and its systems itself.

I have met many wonderful women and terrific men in my life. What is interesting is that rarely are they ever matched up together in relationships. The archons manipulate and interfere more than anyone believes. Again it is for the future book, but it needs to be kept in mind as you go forward with your life. Is the "magical" meeting with someone really meeting a soul mate, or is it an attempted archon manipulation? It is why I suggest people look at situations carefully before getting into any modern dating relationships. That is not to discourage them, but not encourage them either. Clear seeing of everything is always the best way forward.

Most people, no matter men or women, just want to be kind, helpful, sane and safe. They would like to find friends and partners who think likewise. Yet it is the highly confused minority of people that get all the attention and focus, which make acting simple and natural seem like a problem. So make being a *natural adult* the norm, let the world's interactions flow from there.

I would like to remind the sex vs celibacy debate that I presented in *Falling For Truth*. Neither side of that coin is better than the other. Both have value if you understand the nature of the subject, and have the correct timing for it in your life. Then each can be used with power and clarity. Sadly most have no understanding of either side of that debate, so they entrench in on one side as the only side, and create as much distortion as they think they are lifting. Like everything within reality, there is a between-ness, a mid-point that operates as the power of both sides, and at the same time of neither.

These puberty ceremonies were meant to produce *natural human adults*, who could understand their roles as mirrors and as actors in the drama of Earth-life. That includes understanding the various elements of what it means to be a human in the Earth-realm story. We can say this reality got infected several thousand years ago, and that infection has pretty much taken over most of this world. A few people have managed to see through this, and are doing what they can in small ways to be a medicine to the infection. But with an infection this strong and this destructive, it will take a lot of people with such medicine to make a lasting change. We begin with ourselves, and see what takes place on a greater scale from there.

*“Men are from Earth. Women are from Earth. Deal with it”*¹¹⁰ George Carlin

¹¹⁰ Found at goodreads.com

CHAPTER 6

PROVIDING A MODEL

It was a simple gesture. Two boxes of pizza given to me by an National Hockey League defenseman on a February morning in 1985 with the words, “*Here take this, you earned it.*” It happened when I was fifteen years old on a three day trip to a NHL city. He gave me the pizza as I was being thrown out of the team's dressing room by their head coach. That gesture, along with a kiss on the cheek that I would receive later that afternoon from a wonderful women is the reason I can write this book. Those three days transformed everything in my life going forward, but it took me a long time to realize that.

Before sharing the experience proper, I feel that I need to provide some background. This occurred in the middle of February 1985, one month away before my 16th birthday. The photo above is of me with the Ottawa West Golden Knights either a few weeks before or after this trip.

At that time in my life I had a confidence problem. Since the age of eight I had begun taking on a comedy persona, in order to cover years of bullying and beatings due to my high intelligence level. Most of the years since then, while no longer being singled out, I was still seen as more like a clown to laugh at, rather than someone to laugh with. That changed after a joke I made in September 1984 on a *Reach for the Top* (High School televised quiz show). That joke allowed

my entrance to spending time with the more popular members of my high school one grade above me. I didn't lose my connection to all of the other groups I belonged to, for I acted somewhat like a social chameleon during this period.

At the same time my hockey career was failing. I had been a very good player for a few years, but now at 15 I had been switched to a new position (where I was more needed) but just did not play well. My name had been on many scouting watch lists, but this year I was getting watched less and less.

I was also nervous around girls. I could talk or joke with them, but I was unable to tell a girl I liked her, or ask her on a date. The fear of expected rejection was too high. I had kissed a couple of girls up to this point in my life, but nothing like a girlfriend ever came out of these experiences.

My parents and I had moved three times since 1981, and even though my specific school had stayed steady, my home base was unclear. High school, and the friends I had there, were my only constant.

*

My Story

I will tell this story as simply as possible. Specific cities and people's names are omitted as the emphasis here is on the experience itself.

In February 1985 I was asked by a friend I had known since elementary school if I wanted to join him and visit an NHL hockey player. The player was a friend of his father, and now played for one of my favourite teams growing up. I was the only hockey player my friend had, so it made sense to ask me to go with him. I checked my schedule and amazingly I had no games scheduled during that period. My parents

bought my plane ticket, and a week later my friend and I were on a direct flight to a city that became very special to me.

We arrived at our host's condominium, left our luggage, and took a cab to the arena. We made it just in time to see the start of the game. After the game we went down to the dressing room area to wait for our host to shower and finish any talks he had with the media. As I was standing in the hallway I noticed my hockey idol, who had retired a few years previously, standing just a few steps away from me. He was standing by himself. I couldn't believe that no one was talking to him, so I walked over and asked for his autograph, which he gave. Already the trip had been a success, watching an NHL game and meeting a hockey idol. But everything was just getting started.

My host came out of the dressing room, greeted us, and we crammed into his small sports car for the ride to his condo. This was a short stop for a clothing change, because we were going out to a nightclub. I had never been to a bar or nightclub before. During this period many drinking establishments (such as the one we were headed) would let you in if you were underage, as long as you wore a bracelet that indicated you were not allowed to consume alcohol.

In the course of the car rides I had a chance to talk a bit about my current hockey career, where I was playing and what was next in my hockey future. I also did my hockey announcer impressions, of about ten different announcers from various cities across North America. Our host thought these were terrific.

Arriving at the nightclub, we sat at a long rectangular table with seven other players who were already there. After simple introductions of the "kids from out of town," I could see a sort of disinterested look on the faces of the NHL players. But then our host asked me to do the impressions. So I did them once again, to great applause. Every time a few

new players arrived, I would have to do the impressions for them. This happened three or four times in the space of about 45 minutes. In between I began to get more interaction as the players asked more my hockey career and whatnot. The impressions had opened a connection.

At some point I had to go to the bathroom. On my way back to the table I saw that two of the younger players were standing off to one side. I went over to say hi, and let them know I had watched them play several times during their junior years. They made suggestions of what OHL cities and coaches would be good for me to get drafted, as I was also contemplating an American university scholarship.

After about thirty minutes, I got the sense that these guys probably wanted to talk to some girls now, so I said thanks for the time and recommendations. I wished them good luck in the next game, and walked back to the table. I can recall on that walk feeling much more confident. I had just had a thirty minute conversation with NHL players, and no longer felt like an outsider.

When I arrived at the table I saw that my friend was still sitting in his seat, and my seat was still free, so I sat back down. As soon as my butt hit the chair I realized that someone new was sitting in the chair to my left. She was magnetic. After a quick hello I found out that she was a National Football League cheerleader, and she realized I must be the guy doing all the impressions she had been hearing about.

We began talking. She was maybe five or six years older than me, and even though she was sitting down I could see she was short, in great shape, and with what only can be called “dancer’s legs.” Her brunette hair looked more from the 1970s than the new 80s style sported by most everyone else in the bar. I was instantly attracted to her. Only partially this was from her physical appearance (she looked great),

moreso it was her energy. She was nothing like the stereotype of a cheerleader, she was intelligent, warm, funny, and feminine. We had a great conversation, on a series of subjects, and I remember us both laughing several times.

After about thirty minutes I had the same feeling that I had earlier talking with the players so said, *“I guess you probably want to talk to some guys a bit more your age, but I want to say how much I appreciated meeting you and having this conversation. This has been terrific.”*

All of a sudden the joyous happy look was gone from her face, replaced by a stern look as she stared directly at me saying very slowly, *“If I want to talk to someone else, I will go talk to someone else. Do you want to keep talking to me?”*

I had been put in my place! I responded with an honest but simple, *“yes.”*

Her smile returned with a response of, *“good.”* And the conversation resumed. Soon after she asked, knowing that I was a history guy, if I was going to see the historical sites downtown the next day. I told her that my host was busy the next day, with practice in the morning, commitments in the afternoon, and then we were going to a basketball game at night. I told her that I didn't think I would see the sites that I had hoped to see.

My cheerleader friend replied, *“You have to see them.”* Then she got a smile on her face and added, *“You know what, my younger sister would love to show you around.”*

And my mind got a “there it is” moment. This was obviously the good looking older sister looking for a date for her ugly younger sister. Before I could really find a way out of this predicament, she opened up her purse. This was of course the 1980s when women carried a picture of every person they had ever met. She pulled out a photo of her younger sister. Incredibly, the sister was even better looking.

She asked, “*So, can the two of us show you around tomorrow afternoon?*”

When you are 15 years old, and an NFL cheerleader asks you if she and her great looking sister can spend an afternoon together, the only correct answer is, “*of course.*”

Arrangements were made as to where and when to pick us up the next day, then me and my friend piled back into our host's sports car and called it a night.

*

The next day was the most unique day in my life up until my death experience of falling in the river canyon in 2005. In some ways they were mirrors of each other exactly twenty years apart. This day in 1985 might be called my “life experience.”

After getting up I had breakfast with our host, and it gave me the chance to ask him a few questions about his time playing with other teams, how different coaches were to play for, how practices ran. Hockey stuff. I recall it being a very interesting conversation.

We went to practice, our host went into the dressing room to get ready, while my travel friend and I wandered around the practice facility for a bit. When we walked back to ice level to watch the practice, one of the injured players was standing by the gate to the rink. He was from Sweden and had been in the NHL a few years. I nodded to him, and he smiled and said, “*Hey Howdie, how are ya?*” I had been remembered from the previous night. Good sign.

I inquired if it would be ok to ask him a couple of questions about hockey development in Sweden. He was happy to answer my questions and we spoke for twenty or

thirty minutes on how Sweden develops its players, practice style and the like. I found it very useful information. I watched the practice closely, especially the intensity of it. It was certainly something very different than what I was used to at West Ottawa.

When the practice and the players were exiting the ice, a few of them noticed me standing next to the gate. They grabbed me by the arm informing me that I had to come into the dressing room with them. There had been a few married guys who didn't go out the previous night, so I needed to do the impressions for them. I sat in an open stall opposite two of the older stars. Now, unlike the bar, there was no music playing so I could focus on the impressions. I made sure that with each impression I targeted something specific about one of the players, so the routine became very personalized.

The laughter started from the first impression, and built to the final one of Don Cherry. By this time the laughter in the room was extremely loud, and that is when the door burst open. The head coach had been hearing the laughter and needed to know what was going on, the day before a big showdown game. He looked around and it was obvious I was the reason for all the laughter, so he just pointed at me hollering, *"Who's this guy?"*

"A friend of mine from Canada," my host responded

"Get him the fuck out of here," the coach screamed, now pointing at the door.

I stood up, ready to quietly walk out of the dressing room. There was a stack of about twenty pizzas that had been ordered for the guys, and the defenseman sitting across from me picked up two of the boxes and handed them to me with the words, *"Here take these, you earned it."*

As I walked my way out of the room with the pizzas, some players laughed, a few clapped, while the coach just

kept staring at me like he wanted to rip my head off. In my later years of being a comedian I got to perform as a guest speaker at banquets with several NHL stars, some of which I had personal funny stories to share. I had always hoped I was going to be at a banquet with this particular coach to share this story, but we never were scheduled together.

After walking out, I felt energized. Even then I could sense that the pizzas were a type of acceptance. Not only had I made the room laugh, personalized the comedy, but then wound up having the coach they felt hated them now hated me as well. I had become “one of them.” It was the most enjoyable lunch experience of my life.

We made it back to the apartment around noon, but had only about thirty minutes to prepare for the next part of my day. The girls arrived on time at 12.30. The younger sister, who was a year older than me, was quite different from her cheerleader sister. In contrast to having blonde hair in a very 1980s style, she also wore clothing that was the fashion trend of the day. Most importantly, she had a different personality. She was good looking, and she knew it, and built a wall of coldness around herself.

My cheerleader hugged me immediately, while her sister sort of waved, got a bit of a scowl on her face, and got back in the car. I think she wished she could have flash forwarded forty years to have a smartphone in her hand to not have to acknowledge me the rest of the afternoon. I got into the back seat with my school friend, and began our trip to downtown. I did my best to talk with the scowling sister, but it was not not going well. I thought maybe it was my being in the back seat, and things would improve when we got into the city. I was wrong.

I engaged in conversation, made some terrific jokes, but my date was obviously not interested in me. But I was seeing the historical sites and enjoying being around one

wonderful woman who was a terrific energetic match for me. As we went into the final museum of the day, the cheerleader pulled me aside and said, *"I'm sorry about my sister, she just doesn't understand what a great guy you are."*

I replied, *"Thanks. It's ok, stuff happens, but I am enjoying seeing the historical sites, and enjoying that I get to spend more time with you."*

She smiled warmly. I could have stood there for hours just looking into her eyes. It was like I was standing in front of a goddess. Again not because of how she looked, but in who she was.

At the last museum of the afternoon, the younger sister rushed off ahead of us (hoping to have her day of hell over as quickly as possible), while my friend went to get something to eat. I now had time alone in the museum with my cheerleader. At one spot, while looking over the a bed of a famous historical figure, the situation allowed me to make a sexual joke about the bed.

She slapped my arm, *"You're terrible, how can you say that? We're in a museum. You are so bad."* Then she placed her hand in mine as we walked to the next room as a couple. I was in both joy and fear at the same time. When we would get close to her sister, she would release my hand, then grab it again when we had some distance.

When the museum tour was complete, we drove back to the apartment. My travel friend said thanks and went inside. The sister kind of half waved, but it was more like shooing away a pesky insect. My cheerleader stood in front of me and we both wished each other well. I told her how much the day had meant to me, and that was no problem that it didn't work out with her sister. She made it clear that if I was a few years older, the day would have gone differently.

She then leaned over to give me a good-bye kiss on my cheek. It was a sensation that I had never felt before or since. I can feel it now as I write this, like electricity moving through my body centered on that cheek. She placed all of the feelings she had for me, into the last small moment we would share in our life, and I felt her Totality. It was indescribable. She got back in her car, smiled once more at me before driving away. I think I knew a little at that moment of what Francesca Johnson felt in *Bridges of Madison County*. I went into the apartment, being a combination of happy and sad at the same time.

The rest of the trip was more like a whirlwind. I don't remember much of it. There was an NBA basketball game seen from court seats, and immediately after was a concert my host didn't know about, so we stayed for that as well. It was by a group who was soon to become one of the 1980s most popular bands.

The next day was another practice in the morning, and another NHL game to watch in the evening. There was another meeting in the dressing room hallway with an NHL legend, and telling more jokes to the players at the same nightclub. My cheerleader was there again, but beyond a warm hi and a hug, she focused on a guy more in her "age bracket." On one hand I felt terribly jealous and rejected, yet on the other I knew this is exactly how it should be. My time was her was the previous afternoon, and she was back to living "her life."

When I made it back to bed that evening I was energetically spent. The entire experience had been so explosive that I desperately needed time to process all that had happened. I got up early the next morning, and my friend and I took the flight back home to Ottawa.

Analysis

One of the most interesting things looking back on this experience was that I never took a camera with me. That seems so strange now. So I got no photographs of anyone I met, the places I went to, or anything I did. On returning home all I had was a memory, similar to the morning after a dream. The only tangible evidence I had the trip had really happened was the notepad of autographs I took with me. Without that kit would have been easy to think that I just just dreamed the experience. Of course, I have sort of always felt that on one level, I did “dream” them.

Even more odd is that until I decided to write this book, no one had ever asked me to tell them this story. I think I told the story in brief detail to my parents, but not one of my friends or any of the girls I dated. No one wanted to hear it. I wished at the time I had someone like Mr. Park or Bruce had been around for me to share this experience with. I am sure such a talk would have helped to more clearly shape my life going forward.

So now I will look at the experience from the standpoint of ancient coming of age ceremonies. As presented in chapter 2, the first step was the creation of a sacred ground. This was symbolized in my experience by the NHL arena (one that I had always wanted to visit), and on the first night meeting my hockey idol (symbolizing a god in mythology). The second step was the separation of the young boy or girl from their parents. This also occurred, as I left Ottawa and went to a completely new environment where the only people I could count on for three days were myself and the friend who joined me. Interestingly most boys ceremonies around the world (except Native American Vision Quests) were not done individually but in a group.

The third stage is the teachings, tests and interactions with older male mentors. Well I didn't really get teachings per se, I interacted with NHL players as an equal and found I could hold my own in conversation with them. The main entrance for this was not my hockey background (as I had believed at the time), but my comedy and impressions. The trip was showing that actually it was being an entertainer was a key gift or skill that I should focus on.

This stage includes many tests that must be overcome, and often a death experience that solidifies the leaving behind of the child-adolescent world, so that one can step into the new adult world. Being placed in a nightclub for the first time can have a small semblance of a journey to the Underworld in Hero Mythology. I was thrust into this location with little warning and had to figure things out for myself. I had to learn to fit in, in a hurry, if I didn't want to just be a spectator watching everything from the outside. While the gift from the players in the dressing room was a type of "acknowledgment," it was not the same as coming back from a death experience. That type of test experience happened nine years later around my grad date's murder (discussed in *Falling For Truth*).

Another part of this third stage of the process is learning about dating and sex, often from an older female. And while the cheerleader and I did not have a sexual encounter, she taught me not to be nervous around women, which still took me several years to embody. But more than that, she gave me a model. That is the best way I can describe it. She showed me exactly what I should be looking for in a partner. The universe somehow moulded for me the characteristics of what would be an excellent match. Anytime in my future that I dated someone "following the model" the experience went well. If I deviated (dating someone more like her sister) the results of that choice became chaotic. Her sister was also a model, of what not to look for. I wish I

could have understood this part of the experience more quickly, it would have saved me a lot of dating challenges in the decades to follow.

The final stage is a return to the community, often including a type of party or celebration. That was the basketball game (where I enjoyed court seats for the first and only time in my life) watching the concert which almost had the feeling of being put on “just for me.” I think there were only two concerts given after games that year, so it was odd that one of them was on the only night of the year I came to a game. Again making every small element of the entire experience seem part of a giant universal interaction.

Much changed on my return. My friendships improved as I got more confident and comfortable around people. And yes, at times I could still be a bit of an idiot (as anyone from my high school would tell you if you asked them), but I became comfortable with it.

Just three months after returning home I became vice-president of my High School. When it looked like the school might possibly be shut down, I give a speech to the Board of Education on the school's behalf. Two years later when I was 17, I became an assistant coach for the school's hockey team (as I played junior myself and thus was not allowed to play). But when the gym teacher / head coach wound up becoming the head football coach at Carleton University, he no longer had time for the hockey team. The principle decided we didn't need to get an adult coach. I would take over. So for the rest of the year a team made up of 18 and 19 year-olds had a 17 year old head coach. It worked out fine. We wound up in the city championship, losing only because our starting goalie injured his foot a few days prior. Something similar happened with a baseball team during the summer. There are more examples from this two year period.

There is no logical reason for the sudden acceptance and being given responsibilities other than it was a result of what happened during that three day experience. I was different. I could say that while not yet an adult, I had taken a real first step (that few my age seemed to be taking) and thus something energetically was being noticed by those who were older around me. Even though I may be 16 or 17, I was being treated as if I were 26 or 27.

My hockey life changed as well. I got more confident as a player. I played much better going forward the rest of the year. I was selected to Team Canada's under-17 training camp, and it seemed like the coming of age process from my trip was continuing there. I did not make the final roster but what was interesting at that camp was: a) getting all sorts of extra responsibilities from the coaching staff, b) being accepted by the top group of players (the stars) even though skill wise I was not at their level, c) and that the main focus for everyone there was that I was a comedian. During one meeting while we were waiting for a coach who was late to arrive from Toronto, the guys had me go up to do some comedy for twenty minutes until he arrived.

Around seven months later, now 16, I got the best piece of advice from an older adult. But I never followed it. At that time I was in my first year in junior hockey, and often went to watch other league games when I had a free evening. One night while watching a game at the Nepean Sportsplex, I met up with the parents in the first period intermission (as I had played with many of their sons on all star teams in previous years, so knew them all). In the course of the conversation I began telling jokes. Finally one of the fathers got a serious look on his face and spoke to me, *"What the hell are you doing here? I mean in Ottawa. You should be in Hollywood. Forget hockey and just go to California, like tomorrow. That's where you belong."*

Years later I realized, he was probably correct. Granted the more I came to know of the entertainment industry, perhaps I am happy my comedy career never took off at such a young age. But then again, it is an unanswered question for me. It took me another 7-8 years to finally move into a professional comedy life. But it was a switch I should have made at 15 when I made my return back to Ottawa.

My dating life also changed. I wound up dating some girls within a month of being back home. One of those dates actually healed, or better say, completed an earlier life script. In my next book I am going to discuss life scripts, and I will tell you about the odd TV show I got on in 1993, as well as the odd story of how I chose my university. I didn't start to really get comfortable until I met had some experiences that I discuss in the Little Red Riding Hood additional material. But I never dated a woman who fit the model very long. The few times one showed up the universe seemed to find ways to ensure we never dated.

That my three day experience did not end after I returned home to Ottawa, but continued for a year or two, also indicates that ancient ceremonial processes was not just giving the adolescent boy or girl teachings in the moment, it was opening doorways that were meant for the universe itself to step in with, so that the process could continue individually for the young man or woman.

But my father managed to put a block on all of that momentum at the age of 21. That is when he stole all of my money and I had to drop out of university for a year. The impact of that trauma put my consciousness in a type of holding pattern, not advancing in maturity as was the healthy expectation. But I did not go backwards either. In some ways I stalled at age 21. It has only been in the last eight years that I have seen through all of that, regained what I learned in 1985, and begun to re-apply it to my life. Thus even though my age when writing this is 56, in my eyes, I am 29.

I would like to add one final story that sums up the change that happened for me from this whole experience. As you read in the previous chapter in my story about Jennifer, I was far from perfect. But still I had taken steps to enter another stage of maturity. One of the most special gestures that I received happened near the end of my final grade 13 year. I liked to talk to everyone at my high school, that included the janitors. Of course none of the other students talked to the janitors. Most tended to not want to talk with anyone and just do their work, so I learned to leave them alone. There was another member of the staff however, Eric. He was in his early 60s, and you could tell he had a bit of a challenging life, was but a really kind man.

Many times I would be late at school for some reason, so sometimes I would walk with Eric as he did his sweeping rounds, just talking about hockey or politics or whatever he felt like was on his mind. He liked that there was one student at the school who acknowledged and talked with him.

In my final week I was completing getting signatures from everyone in my yearbook. I saw Eric at end of the hall and asked if he would sign it. He looked shocked and asked, *"You want me to sign your yearbook?"*

"Of course, we spent a lot of time walking around this school and talking together."

"Honestly, I don't know what to say," he said somewhat choked up. *"No one has ever asked me to sign a yearbook in the twenty years I have been working here."*

"Well, I want you to."

He took my yearbook, quickly wrote something, closed it and handed it back to me. I said thanks, and he walked off continuing his rounds.

I opened the yearbook to read what he wrote, and it is still a very special moment for me.

“To Howdie Mickoski, One hell of a man. Eric Greenwood.”

And I could say the same to you my friend.

CHAPTER 7

GIRLS' COMING-OF-AGE CEREMONIES

*"I wonder how different our communities might look if we honoured all young girls for their sacredness and potential."*¹¹¹ Kim Anderson

I had suggested to a few of my female friends that they watch some videos¹¹² of the four-day Apache Sunrise coming-of-age ceremony for young women. All of my friends were visibly moved saying such things as: *"I wish I had something like that growing up,"* or *"That would have changed my life."* These next two chapters are not easy for me to write. That is because what is occurring with these ceremonies is the creation of an experience. These ceremonies are emotional events that are hard to even attempt to describe on paper. I cannot truly share what occurred in my fall in the Canyon, attending a Sweat Lodge, or even my own coming-of-age experience from the previous chapter. But I will try my best to impart a feeling for you, the reader, to get a sense of what this is all about. Perhaps watch a video at the footnote before reading the rest of this chapter. It might be helpful in

¹¹¹ Anderson pg 173

¹¹² I suggested they watch first this ten minute overview at Vice Life https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r1Cx_9YDQEc&t=48s , then longer videos if they wanted to see more such as:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Iez3tTGmH7U>,
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7tosl4O6zM4>

understanding the underlying emotional element of what I will be presenting.

Prior to modern civilization taking over the Earth, every culture had ceremonies and teachings for their adolescent girls and boys to transform into adults. The ceremonial process is like a catalyst for the next stage to come to life. These ceremonies get seeds to germinate. When we are harvesting a carrot or cabbage, we forgets the seed that started it all. Sometimes the seed, for unknown circumstances, germinates on its own. Perhaps it is trauma in a young person's world that forces them to "grow up" fast to survive. In others, like me, events just seemed to place me in a situation for the seed to get the correct conditions. That does not mean that if the situation is provided, or a ceremony attended, that the adult process will occur. The young person has to want the change to occur. Thus it requires both a willingness from the young person within, and an external condition to act like a starter for its germination.

*

I begin with the girls' ceremonies, because they are the ones (at least in North American Indigenous communities) that have been making a comeback in the last 25 years. There are now several tribes holding them again, and several books have been written recently on the subject.¹¹³ There are some reasons why the girls' ceremonies have returned. Foremost is the tribal communities themselves feel the need to overcome the stark abuse that young girls on the reservations often face.

113 Some books on the subject of girl's puberty rites in Native American traditions include: Carol A. Markstrom *Empowerment of North American Indian Girls: Ritual Expressions at Puberty*, Susan Secakuku *Meet Mindy: A Native girl from the Southwest*, Cutcha Risling Baldy *We Are Dancing for You*, Cindy Gaudet *Moon Time Prayer*. A documentary called "Long Line of Ladies" relates to the current ceremonies of the Karuk community of California.

Reservation life is difficult, these places are rife with poverty and addiction. This is not the fault of the Native Peoples. They had their way of life taken from them, were forced onto reservations (which are nothing more than segregation areas), and then presented every possible way to fail. Actually it is only from the amazing courage of thousands of men and women over the last century that any of their traditions and ceremonies have survived.¹¹⁴ Granted Native Peoples made the European conquest easier by not being able to become unified, as a lot of their time was spent fighting each other as much as the colonialists. But they are still here. Given what they were facing, that is an accomplishment.

Indigenous ceremonies were literally beaten out of the Native Communities as Cutcha Risling Baldy expressed, *“The boarding schools and other government programs and agents specifically tried to teach us that this (Flower puberty) dance was bad, that it was part of our primitive ways, that it was tied to savagery and oppression of women. A celebration of menstruation just proved that we were dirty, stupid, primitive people. Why would you celebrate menstruation? Why would you ever celebrate young women like that?”*¹¹⁵ After 1900, after nearly wiping out the entire Native American population, both the Canadian and American governments set up programs to confiscate the Indian youth and force them to go to boarding schools where they were badly beaten when they spoke their mother tongue or prayed to their holy people, and were raped whenever the priests and teachers felt like it. This is much of what these renewal of ceremonies were attempting to overcome, not just the state of life of Native communities currently, but the history of centuries of abuse since the colonial conquest of the continent.

It is important to remember that the ceremonies that I am pointing towards in this book occurred in a non-

114 This message is very clear in books such as Mary Brave Bird's *Lakota Woman*, and Cutcha Risling Baldy *We are Dancing For You*, and the video “Lakota in America,”

115 Baldy. “Reviving Hupa”

industrial, non-civilized world. They were in a world where humans interacted with nature as partners, not as something to own and exploit. This was a time when children, especially girls, were not abused. Children were the lifeblood of the tribe, and to eventually make a healthy adult, one first needed a healthy childhood. That is not the case today. The percentage of girls that have been sexually abused before they reach 16 is staggering, and how many boys and girls are the victims of physical and emotional abuse as well? In one sense we have to overcome not just individual traumas, but those of an entire society as well.

In ancient times (and continuing today) the marker for girls to begin this ceremony was their first menstruation. I will repeat this many times in this chapter, that even though the body marker was being ready for sex and having babies, this was but a small portion of what this teaching process was focused on. Ancient cultures did not see women they way the Western religions do, as the cause of original sin due to their sensuality, or that women's only purpose was to be a baby factory. They understood the importance of the Divine Feminine, and how that principle was needed for a stable and balanced world. The girl in a sense was getting the teaching of how to function as a mirror of, or conduit of, that integral power; as boys were to be taught to mirror the Divine Masculine. Agricultural societies needed more children for farm work and soldiers (exploitable numbers), while tribal worlds needed a stable and healthy community.

To the Native Peoples, a woman's period was not something frightening or to be hidden from. They understood that this moon time was a crack in the world for a woman, thus a time of power. It was her time to go within and obtain understandings about herself and reality. Men had to go on external Vision Quests, (fasts in nature) periodically, while women got a period of power every 28 days. That was a reason the women would go to a special hut or tipi on the

edge of the village, staying with any other women also going through their moon time. They were not there because the village was afraid of them, but rather because they needed to have the space to access their power away from the day-to-day infringements of tribal life. The rest of the women of the village would pick up their chores for those days, as the women currently away would pick up the chores of the other women later.

Imagine if the modern world understood and celebrated this time for a female to be alone, not to have to go to work, not to have to interact with others, so that she could simply have the stillness to go within. A girl's first menstruation was considered the most powerful of her life, a time when the focus for the rest of her life could be seen, and during that first period she was considered linked to healing energy.¹¹⁶

Carol Markstrom commented that many modern feminists do not like these puberty ceremonies because of how much what could be called “traditional feminine roles” are part of the teaching. To many feminist eyes these ceremonies only, “reinforce expected roles for women, thereby keeping them marginalized in society with restricted opportunities.”¹¹⁷ But that is not what is going on, nor how the women who have been involved in these ceremonies see it. Femininity is being embraced in these ceremonies, something sadly that has been forgotten in the modern world, or distorted to being focused on hair styles, make up and Instagram posts. Tribal culture is built on balance, and both the feminine and the masculine are appreciated, accepted, and allowed to become rooted in their power.

Bringing back these ceremonies is powerful, because it is an indication that HG tribal life was not a world of savages or primitives, but something linked to what being human

116 Baldy *We Are Dancing* chapter 4, Markstrom pg 72-75

117 Markstrom pg 107

really means. Indigenous ceremonies have their power because the people presiding over them understand the reasons for them, and the people participating understand how it is meant to shape someone for the rest of their life. The more these ceremonies are allowed to return, and be actively sought out by young people of all cultures and heritages, perhaps the complete robotization of humans might be halted. Likely not, but we can try at least.

While puberty rites still exist in some parts of the world, they tend to be controversial and very confusing because most of the people involved (including the young girl) usually have no idea what is going on, or why. There are no elders there to explain the symbolic nature of why any of what is going on is important for their life. Just being old does not make you wise, as Bruce Starlight once told me, “*I know a lot of old people who have the understanding of a child, while I know several people in their twenties who wise enough for me to refer to them as an elder.*” What makes one an elder is having wisdom to share, finding those who wish to hear it, then sharing it with them.

*

Native American Ceremonies

This chapter is not a detailed presentation of the specifics of each tribe's unique ceremony. There are some good books out there for that, such as Carol Markstom's *Empowerment of North American Indian Girls*. This chapter is meant to simplify a detailed amount of data into separate segments of information. Each small section begins with a dedicated point, and then gives examples to explain its meaning. The Native ceremonies I chose to focus on include two of the longest active in the American Southwest, the Navajo Kinaalda and Apache Sunrise Ceremony. I also

examined the Northeast (Ojibwa and Mikmaw) process called the Berry Fast, and the Lakota Isnati Ceremony.

I am not writing this chapter to claim that the way North American Indigenous Peoples do these ceremonies is the best or correct way. Nor am I looking to get readers to partake in any specific ceremony, but rather to give some current examples that can act as pointers of power to see what can be taken from them and perhaps imparted into one's own life, or one's children.

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Point: The girl is usually joined by the community.

Most of the various tribes' ceremonies are individual, for one girl only, and take place within a month or two of her first menstruation. In ancient times the ceremony would have begun immediately. In many communities now, due to the demands of the modern world, only one ceremony is held each year where all of the girls share the process together as one group. There were a few tribes in the past who had the girl go through the ceremony with only a grandmother in the woods, but the majority had a large community involvement, that might include several hundred people joining in the dancing and eating segments to show their support for wishing the girl well in her life.

In the Apache Sunrise, the girl has a Co-sponsor, an elder woman (but not the mother) who is deemed to be an excellent mentor. She is sometimes given the title *Ideal Woman*. Today it is interesting that many of the Co-sponsors did not go through a Sunrise Dance themselves, and thus they sort of receive their own initiation by being the helper of a young girl, thus they in a sense share the ceremony.¹¹⁸ In

118 Markstrom pg 282

this Apache Ceremony the initiate girl will have a peer (or partner). This is often a girl who has recently gone through her own ceremony, and thus can pass on her own experiences and suggestions. She is there to support the girl, and fill in during dances if the initiate girl needs to take a break.

The majority of these ceremonies tend to last four to ten days, while the Tingle used to have the girl be up to two years in seclusion.¹¹⁹ What I noticed is that the tribes that tended to have a longer period for the ceremony were more often stationary as a village, and more agriculture-based.

*

Point: Sacred space gets created

While the men might build the larger part of the campground, only the girl (and female helpers) built the structure that she will stay in for the duration of the event. Mircea Eliade mentioned that in some tribes the girl's hut was a symbolic of being in darkness for the ceremony, and that in many cultures the girl is not supposed to look at the sun (only the moon) during the length of the puberty process.¹²⁰

In the Southwest tradition, when the four day process is complete, the girl and her partner have to tear down the entire hut that she used by themselves, which can take quite a while as they are very strongly built.¹²¹ This has the symbolism of discarding and letting go of her old life as a child that the hut symbolized, and walking into her new life as a woman with a new name and new hairstyle.

Unlike some of the boys' ceremonies I examined, where the location the initiation rituals take place were made to be a mirror of the Origin Time, I did not see such things for the girls'. That does not mean that the layout of the

119 Markstrom pg 145

120 Eliade pg 42

121 "Toriblu's Apache Sunrise Dance"

campground, such as the placement of and type of poles used, or the direction of the entrance, does not have symbolic meaning. It does. I mention only that the boys' ceremonies seem to indicate the need to create a mirror of the First Time Origin myth of that tribe while the girls' do not.

*

Point: The girl becomes a goddess in the ceremony

This to me is one of the most important elements of the ceremony. That the girl is not just connecting with a goddess, she is BECOMING the goddess. For the Navajo and Apache the girl becomes Changing Woman (also called White Painted Woman). For the Lakota she becomes White Buffalo Calf Woman, and in other areas she is associated with a Corn Maiden or Earth Maiden. In the Apache Sunrise, the girl is dressed by her Co-sponsor on the first morning, and each item of clothing has a symbolic meaning that links her to White Painted Woman. Thomas Mails presented that in the Apache tradition, the girl wears an abalone shell on her forehead, which, on the first morning a shaft of sunlight strikes and creates a "light effect." This signifies that the power of Changing Woman (through the sun beam) would enter her and remain within her for the ceremony, and act like a seed that will flower during the rest of her life.¹²²

*

Point: Learning about menstrual power

The woman is taught that during her period time, she is in a space of great power. In many Native cultures, the women, when they have their period, cannot come into

122 Mails chapter 11, Markstrom pg 73, 222

contact with the food that others eat, or be in contact with men (either to be around their ceremonies, or men's objects such as shields, weapons, or ritual bundles). Many early researchers thought this represented that the girl was thought of as "impure" or "dirty." This is not the ancient understanding, "*women during their menstrual period were considered so powerful and dangerous that they posed a threat to others and themselves if they did not take the proper precautions. They were a threat to a warrior and his war implements, both of whose efficacy might be impaired by contact with the woman.*" As well, "*It was believed that menstruation was at great enmity with (men's) medicine and if a woman deliberately stayed near the medicine, she could create an obstacle, and render the medicine impotent so that it could not reach the sickness.*" ¹²³

This women's power was not compatible with the man's energy. I get the sense they would think of it as the female power at this time was so strong it would cancel out any of the power of the men around them at that time. Thus the woman was segregated partially so that she could go deeper into her own power safely, and so that any men's medicine or healing being done could continue without concern. I am not agreeing or disagreeing on this, merely sharing the old tribal outlook on this subject.

In many tribes' puberty ceremonies, the girl is considered to have a healing or blessing power during it. A touch from a girl at her ceremony was thought to heal people who were sick. In the Apache Ceremony, candy is poured over the girl, which the young people scramble to get and eat because the candy is now considered lucky. In earlier times it was corn seeds that were sprinkled over the girl, with the idea that the corn would now become lucky and grow well. ¹²⁴

123 Other sources about female menstruation power: Markstrom, Lame Deer, Mails, Patricia Albers, Beatrice Medicine "The Hidden Half: Studies of Plains Indian Women," LaPier, "How a Native American"

124 Markstrom pg 236

Such a ceremony will create a memorable positive experience around this monthly time of her life (given that she will have thirteen of them every year for much of her life). You might say that there is the possibility that in the young woman's mind as she continues in life, at each future period she might remember something of this first ceremonial experience, and allow that energy and power to be more easily accessed again in her life.

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Point: The girl has restrictions or things that must be given up for a period of time.

With most tribes, the girls were expected to reject various food items or actions, while also having to perform new or challenging tasks. Some of these included the girl being given a drinking tube to use (so as not drink water directly and get wrinkles), or use a scratching stick (so she does not scratch herself with her nails to wind up with bad skin). My sense here is that this is less about not getting wrinkles when one is fifty, but more like a mental focusing action for the mind to push itself out of normal comforts. Doing so allows the mind to recognize that something very different is occurring than what has been normal day to day life to this point.

In many traditions, such as in the California Hupa, the girl will wear a type of face covering during the ceremony. The Ojibwa girls wear a cone shaped birch hat, while Athabasca girls would wear a hood that restricted their vision so that they only saw in front of them. This was claimed to protect others from seeing her face or eyes directly because of how much power the girl had, or so that the girl could not see the sun or men. Some Northern tribes covered the girl's face in charcoal, as a warning to others that she was

in her moon time and that one's should not gaze towards her eyes because of the girl's power.¹²⁵

Such a covering is going to change the girl's normal perception of the outer world, and make it more likely for her to go within. This makes me wonder about the origin of the Muslim burka, which is similar to what some of the girls were wearing in these ceremonies. Was the burka originally a coming-of-age tool that, over time, stopped being used only for ceremonies and became an everyday item of clothing? When the Native ceremonies ended, the veils or face coverings were removed and never worn again, as this was another element that was meant to be symbolic of leaving adolescence behind and stepping into a new state.

Another restriction which takes place in tribes of the North and East (such as the Ojibwa and Mikmaw) is the Berry or Strawberry Fast.¹²⁶ This process begins with an isolation of a week or ten days where a type of introspection begins of "going into the darkness of the womb." For the rest of the year, the young girl will not eat any berries (or strawberries, depending on the tribe). During this year, various elder women will teach the girl about being a woman, sexuality, skills and crafts, and some of the myths of their tribe. When the year is complete, a feast occurs, gifts are given, and the girl can resume the eating of berries.

I know you are likely wondering, why is it the girl cannot eat berries for a year? To my eyes this could be that in the Northern areas berries would be the main fruit source to last throughout the winter season. Thus in ancient times one is fasting from the only available fruit, which would be a sacrifice. Some have suggested that the girls needed to do this fast, or else there would be a poor berry crop the following

125 Baldy pg 135, Markstrom pg 149, 329, Anderson, Rooth pg 4

126 Examples of this ceremony can be found at Kerr "Rites of Passage," and Kwek Society "Our Stories"

summer.¹²⁷ However the opposite idea is true for the Lakota ceremony, where the girl will spend time during her ceremony gathering medicinal herbs and berries so that traditional foods (such as wasna) can be made.

Some restrictions can be challenging. In one, the girl is lashed with stinging nettle, in another they may be given a drug to take. In some Southwest traditions both the girls and boys get whipped. In more simple challenges girls have to sit in warm pits, while others spend the morning doing chores such as gathering water or food.¹²⁸ Of course these things are again put create a change the awareness, but I am not sure if whipping children as an initiation is helpful. Nor do I agree with the use of drugs. Even though they do alter consciousnesses, they come with potential serious side effects. Drugs give something, but demand something in return. The elders who taught me said similar things as Lame Deer did, “*I mistrust visions come by in the easy way, by swallowing something. The real insight, the ecstasy does not come from this.*”¹²⁹ I think the point is to have the experience come from within, thus be owned as something the person themselves created, and thus could create again at any time in the future.

This was reiterated in one sweat lodge with Bruce when he discussed the use of power tools, such as: drums, wands, feathers and the like. He said they were useful for a while. It makes the person you are helping feel calm, like there is some greater force in operation. It helps the new medicine person for a while, because it gives them something to focus their attention on. However, he said that one will never have real power until they let go of all the tools and trust only in themselves. That it has only always been their

127 Anderson. When it comes to strawberries, some tribes call then a heart berry due to their shape, and the vines of the plant symbolize the connection between the mother and her children. Thus they see strawberry as a “woman’s medicine.”

128 Markstrom pg. 137, 163

129 Lame Deer pg. 217

own power creating any healing or transformation, and the tools were just helpers, not a necessity. The tools could still be there, for the patient, but they act more like calming tools for the patient, not an outside of oneself requirement of the one doing the healing.

Again, the restrictions or challenges are there to create a state of mind, or we could say, to help force a change in the standard awareness that has been present all through childhood in order to be ready to take a step up to a new awareness.

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Point: The girl is learning to make everyday objects that the family and community will be in need of. They learn the resources of the natural world around them, including food and medicinal plants.

Many tribes still have as part of the ceremony the girl learning a specific traditional skill. While things such as making a fire, sewing, or weaving a basket are not as important as they would have been 300 years ago, the principle of the ability to perform practical skills is. Many tribes' ceremonies have the girls go into the forest to learn about various edible and medicinal plants that grow in the wild, as the use of herbal medicines tended to be a female role. Some may think that only hunting requires great skill, but so too does gathering. Because real gathering is not taking place in a small garden outside of one's front door. The tribe is constantly moving, changing locations every week or two, which means new areas and plants have to constantly be identified, and seen what is useful at each stop. Thus hundreds, even thousands of plants, have to be stored in the mind so as to not make an error with something poisonous

that looks like another, and to know what you need and where you can find it quickly.

In the Southwest the girls grind corn and bake a large cake called an alkaan. Interestingly, when these cakes are served at the final feast, the girl is not allowed to eat them. She is supposed to have become the cake (similar to the idea of the wafer in Catholicism), and thus she gives the cake to others as a demonstration of how good of a provider she will be. One component, rarely mentioned, is that the cake is made of yellow corn (considered feminine), and covered with white corn (considered masculine). This combination is an aspect of fertility ritual, perhaps both for plants and people.¹³⁰

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Point: Gaining health and stamina.

The Navajo and Apache ceremonies have the girl complete a series of runs, in some cases a long distance. This is supposed to impress upon her the need to keep herself fit and healthy. In some tribe's ceremonies she would run four times to represent the four stages of one's life or the powers of the four directions. Children often chase her, supposedly symbolizing that she will be a good leader that children will follow.¹³¹ Yet I found other information that makes more sense as to the origin of the running. In the California Hupa tribe, the young girl also goes on some long runs near a river (that includes many stops where she is to bathe). Young children run after her, and while they are not allowed to overtake the runner, they should shout at her and attempt to make her stop and turn around to look at them. The children represent childhood, and the girl has to continue to run forward and not be symbolically turning back to her past.¹³²

130 Markstrom pg. 305-310

131 Mails

132 Baldy pg. 136

Thus the run is not about what sort of mother one will become, but is again a test of awareness, under the physical strain of a long run, to keep the girl focused on heading into adulthood. Thus I mention that much of the original symbolism might be lost to many of the tribes today, even though the various events are still occurring.

Almost every tribe's ceremonies include many dances, not only by the girl but by those who come to visit. In the Southwest ceremonies the girl might dance almost continually all day and night, to various songs that present tribal mythology. Thus she is also learning the myths by dancing to them. The dancing is very taxing for the girl, and is meant to show when the four days have ended, that she was able (from her own inner power) to overcome the challenge of exhaustion to keep dancing. This is supposed to be remembered and when other challenges come in her life, that she can handle these as she did during her ceremony.¹³³ Dancing is another consciousness-changing action, and when added to drumming and singing, sets up the condition for trance states to form. Some mothers I know today who looked over early stages of this manuscript remarked sadly how few girls today would be physically ready to handle the type of continuous dancing that the ceremony requires. This is not like spending a few hours in a nightclub, this can be almost continuous for several days, but those who can withstand it later reveal a pride for their own physical conditioning as well as mental fortitude.

In the Apache tradition, the final day includes dances from a group of men-spirits known as Crown Mountain Spirit (Ga'an) Dancers. Their arrival is likely the most memorable part of the entire four days for the spectators. The Ga'an are depicting the gods of the mountain or of inside the Earth. There are five dancers, four with black hoods who represent the four directions, and one with a

133 Markstrom pg. 264

white hood who is the sacred clown, the unique one of the five. They each wear an elaborate crown on their heads that can be up to three feet tall. These crowns are personally made by the dancers prior to each event, and then afterwards are buried because the “*crown absorb all the illness and bad spirits, and this is why they can only be used once,*” while “*They dance to bless the maiden, to bless the fire, and to keep bad spirits away.*”¹³⁴

It is hard to know for sure exactly what the Crown Dancers represent, as different sources give somewhat different origins. One story is that they were the first spirits to come into the material realm to help humans and free various animal spirits that had been locked in a cave, who could then roam free and provide food for the Apache. Another myth has that an Apache boy that fell into a cave where the Ga'an spirits resided. When the boy died, he became one of them. When tribe members came looking for the boy, they brought his dog who recognized him, and the boy led the other spirits to his village to began a tradition of dancing to bless, heal, and protect the people.¹³⁵

I see similarities with these Apache dancers to the Kachina of the Hopi, and in my opinion both of their origins represent the archons (demonic beings of the outer realms). When archons lived on Earth, they were claimed to live in mountains or in the Earth's interior. The Crown Dancers' presence at a ceremony may be designed to trick the real archons into thinking that they are already present so they leave the ceremony alone. The ceremonial dancers trick the original tricksters.

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Point: There used to be a focus on sexuality and marriage.

134 Mails pg 155, Benanav “An Apache”

135 Second Face “The Apache Ga'an,” and Markstrom pg. 240-242

The Sunrise Ceremony today no longer focuses on the girl being seen as ready for marriage. One reason the Apache give for this change in focus is that for marriage the girl should be at least 17, and that is the age when menstruation first began in ancient time. Today menstruation is happening earlier for girls, and thus the “ready for marriage” element is no longer included.¹³⁶ Actually I don’t agree with that belief. I don’t think the age of the first menstruation has changed that much, what has changed is the quickness a young person matures. Modern civilization slows down the child to adolescent process, and the ceremony had to altered to fit the modern environment.

This is a similar complaint of the current Tamil Hindu ceremonies in South India, where the girl is presented as a type of child bride, to appear as though she is having an early version of her wedding. A few Indian friends of mine who had such a ceremony in their life suggested that they did not understand any of the symbolism, nor did most of the spectators (including their own parents).¹³⁷ The ceremonies in North America have the girl, the participants, and the majority of the spectators, understand the symbolic detail of most what is going on. I am sure there are many times when this symbolic knowledge is understood in India as well, but there (as the articles at the footnote suggest) there is much discussion today over the ceremony’s continuation.

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Point: Ritual Bathing.

Most ceremonies include ritual bathing. In some the girl is washed in water poured over her head, while the Hupa girls bathed in a stream. In the 1925 Lakota ceremony Ms.

¹³⁶ Markstrom pg 283

¹³⁷ Presented in conversation to me from two Indian friends, as well as sources Pranavarooban, Rajkumar, Chocken, Personal conversations with two female Tamil friends.

Nellie Zelda Star Boy Menard had sage water poured over her. Oddly in the Apache Ceremony, the girl is not to bathe or touch water for the four days.¹³⁸ Yet this restriction of water is very rare. In the additional material I discuss my views of water and baptism for the female.

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Point: The girl should have a sense that something within her has transformed or shifted.

In the Navajo and Apache Ceremonies there is a remoulding. This is where an elder female squeezes and moulds the girl's body to be more like the goddess Changing Woman. This practice is meant to make energetic changes in four areas: spiritual, emotional, intellectual, and physical. It is believed that the girl can be moulded because once the power of Changing Woman enters the girl it makes her body pliable. After the moulding has been completed the girl has been claimed to be more radiant or beautiful.¹³⁹

Also in the Apache Ceremony, one of the key tools is a Sunrise Cane. The cane is supposed to be the very one that the young girl will one day use when she is an old woman, thus already setting up the conditions for her to have a long life. At times she will dance with this very elaborate cane, which is also a protection tool against what was described as "power-caused illness." At other times the cane will be used as part of the girl's running tests.¹⁴⁰

Another experience in the Southwest is the painting of the girl white, either using a white clay or a liquid pollen mixture. This turns her into the goddess White Painted Woman, and also gives the appearance of an old woman (to suggest that she will live to be old enough to again have white

138 Markstrom pg 222, Bol, and Menard, "I Saw All That"

139 The specifics of what is happening at each part of the moulding can be found at Markstrom pg 218, 307 and Mails pg 154

140 Markstrom pg 1, Mails pg 147

hair). This is presented that she needs the paint as a type of power to handle the battles she will have to face as a young woman, just as male warriors needed to paint their faces before going to war or hunting.¹⁴¹

In the Lakota tradition, red paint might be applied to the girl's head to signify dedication to truth or the "red road." In some tribes, three marks are painted or tattooed onto the girl's chin to indicate she was now a woman.¹⁴² I looked for explanations as to why three marks needed to be added to the chin. Most presentations claim it was a rite of passage, but it seems no one knows why. Some try to claim it means the three stages of a woman's life, but again I have found no specific older verification on this. It is another area where the underlying meaning seems to have been lost over time.

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Point: Instruction.

One part of the ceremony is an older women giving information to the soon-to-be young woman. One woman's grandmother taught her about the relationship between humans and all other creatures, and the four great virtues: generosity, bravery, fortitude and moral integrity. Thomas Mails presented that the grandmother in the ceremony he witnessed told the girl how to, "*deal with hardships, depression and to be happy, and how the ceremony would give her guidance for the rest of her life.*"¹⁴³

141 Markstrom pg 245, 263, 308

142 Markstrom pg 137, 324

143 Markstrom pg 322-23, Mails pg 144

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Point: Ends with a feast and celebration on the return to the community as a new member.

On the last night a Blessing Ceremony occurs, that includes prayers from medicine men and women.¹⁴⁴ Often prior to this final feast the girl in many traditions takes one last ritual bath, and her hair re-braided in a more “mature” style. She may also get new clothes and a new name signifying that she is now a young woman and no longer a child. It ends with a feast where all of the food that has been made over the course of the ceremony is eaten. For the Apache, the girl is considered holy for four days after the ceremony has ended, and there are certain activities and restrictions she still has to continue with. Interestingly in Ojibwa tradition, during the year that the girl is in a type of seclusion, the men are expected to attend and look after her.¹⁴⁵

Navajos called Kinaalda, “*The most important personality shaping event in a woman’s life, and it is believed to set her life course,*” while one woman said of her ceremony, “*I felt different afterwards, like I was a woman and had to take more responsibility for myself and my family.*”¹⁴⁶ One could say that the ceremony itself was a doorway, of which the young woman now had to continue to deepen the elements that were revealed over those four days for the rest of her life.

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Analysis.

The purpose of such ceremonies was to allow the passage of a young girl to become a young woman. That

144 Benanav “An Apache”

145 Markstrom pg 332-334, Mails pg 171

146 Markstrom pg 306, Benanav “An Apache”

meant for her to become a conduit and mirror of the Divine Feminine. This included learning to connect with the natural world, how to handle relationships, and how to nurture a family and the tribe. How much of these aspects of the teaching still exists in the modern versions is hard to know without private conversations with those who have gone through them.

I have come to see that it is not the ceremony itself, nor any specific element within it, which is doing the transformation. One does not require a scratching stick, to be painted with white pollen, or not to eat berries for a year to make an adult transition. What is happening is that the ceremony as a whole is acting like an open door to something that is within the girl. Each adolescent has within them a switch, that is meant to begin the transformation of the young person to the adult stage. These ceremonies are acting like a beacon, that if the young person so desires, can cause that switch to turn on and begin their process. If an adolescent does not want to leave the adolescent state, no ceremony is going to change anything.

The process is so natural it does not require a ceremony. Yet even in my case, it took a very unique set of external circumstances to cause my inner switch to agree to turn. But it is setting up conditions to see if the young person wants to go forward or not. If the young girl is not sure about moving from adolescent to adult when the ceremony begins, the experience and power it generates, might cause her to change her mind and say “yes I am ready.” A ceremony gives us the marker to be willing to let that occur. The inner acknowledgment of “yes I am ready” is all that it really takes. But speaking from personal experience, it can be hard to decide to leave adolescence and go into what is a rather challenging life of adulthood. There has to be willingness to make that step, because without it, it will be easier to stay in

the symbolic womb and just wait it all out. Sadly that is what most of our modern world has been doing.

Thus the female should have a desire to embrace femininity, in all that it entails. That means to have to let go of all the definitions from popular women on social media, and instead go looking for the core of what this Divine Principle really is. The more you locate what femininity is, you might be surprised that it is very different that what the majority are “claiming” it to be. Clear mirrors of the Divine Feminine are needed in this modern reality. But allow yourself to explore and find this for yourself, see through the various distortions, then walk into the valuable original core.

No ceremony is required for any of this, but if one happens to be lucky enough to have had clear-seeing parents who helped to create something valuable, then the transition can happen in a more smooth way. Even if you do not have any children yourself, you can still be a good role model for the children of family members or friends. That is something we can all aspire to be, a good role model for someone. Perhaps this book is my small contribution to the overall process.

CHAPTER 8

BOYS' COMING-OF-AGE CEREMONIES

*“Waste no more time arguing what a good man should be. Be one.”*¹⁴⁷ Marcus Aurelius

It is no surprise that as our modern world has become more feminized, girls' tribal ceremonies have made a comeback. It is also no surprise that the boys have been forgotten. For the last fifty years men have been shamed and told they are not needed, except to open a pickle jar. When masculinity does appear, it is labelled “toxic.” Of course there is also “toxic” femininity, but only men it seems are blamed. Of course, the only reason natural principles can become “toxic” is because they mirror a toxic society. A toxic system can only create toxic people. Remove the system, and the people would likely change.

Within this lack of acknowledgment for young men comes the sad fact that often the only type of coming-of-age ritual that has been experienced during the previous hundred years has been going off to war. All at a cost for the survivors who often return psychologically broken from the experience. It is not just the loss of the ceremonies themselves, but that a detailed process of community teaching with role models has been replaced by simple “bonding activities” such as playing

¹⁴⁷ Texts on Aurelius at Gutenberg

<https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/59784>

catch or watching TV with dad, or attending Boy Scouts. Bonding moments are nice breaks for a family in a chaotic world, but they are not coming-of-age teachings.

A percentage of men today are potentially dangerous. This underlying principle of aggression, when understood and used properly, was the reason a village was protected and they had meat to eat. But it needed to be used only when it was required. When a society no longer has a place for males to be of value, where a few have exorbitant wealth and the majority has little, along with inner stress or frustration based on a lack of societal opportunities, one's inherent traits can get confused and manifested poorly. With men this can come out as control and aggression. With women this confusion can come out as manipulation.

But just as the majority of women do not want to be emotionally manipulative, neither do the majority of men want to be violent and aggressive. You can not judge the majority from the minority. Most men and women want to be good people, and a friend to others in society. And while women do have to carefully question men they may spend time with, the majority of young men today are decent, but born in an indecent time. If they could ever get direct guidance, like these coming-of-age ceremonies were meant to do, the confusion would change to clear direction rather quickly. With that a whole host of issues among people would begin to get resolved. But modern civilization wants problems.

One of the common issues plaguing modern men is called *Peter Pan Syndrome*.¹⁴⁸ This is a state where the young male stays in child-dependent mode and never moves to a state of adult responsibility. He has few boundaries, keeps looking for a woman to replace his mother, while living in a mental fantasy world, but never doing anything practical to

148 First presented in a 1983 book of the same name by Dr. Dan Kiley

make any of these fantasies come true. We are suffering the loss to men from both sides of the pendulum, those overly aggressive and domineering, and those under motivated. Any society without a proper natural balance of femininity and masculinity is going to eventually topple over on itself. We are toppling fast.

Boys today are sadly missing older male role models. Many do not have a father at home, while many of those that do are being abused or ignoring (almost as much as daughters). If a boy turns to television for help, the most famous fathers of the last thirty years are all presented as idiots. When boys see commercials, the father never knows what cereal to eat, or where to get his car fixed. His wife always has to tell him. Even fifty years ago most grandparents had a role in the raising of children, now they are pushed away to Florida, Arizona or a nursing home. Even teachers and sports coaches no longer offer much in the way of masculine role modeling. Where is a boy to learn the energy of the healthy masculine?

In ancient tribal culture, role models were around constantly. The men of the tribe had become *natural adults* themselves, thus the boy all through his childhood would have been picking up cues of how the adult men behaved. But once the coming-of-age ceremony began, there would be direct and personal instruction about how he himself should address these energies within. Part of this was to teach the boy the various tribal myths, and of the sacred landscape that surrounds them. They would be taught what sort of responsibilities they would now have as an adult, as well as dances and some magical rituals. Many tribes also would teach the young man a second language, one that is either used only by the men, or perhaps only during hunting or sacred rituals.¹⁴⁹

149 Eliade chapter 2

In the 1970s it was understood, on one level, that this type of teaching for boys was missing. However, what was created to help the situation did not really do what it intended. A new direction calling itself The Men's Movement (in opposition to the Feminist Movement) began. This built itself around the standard Self-Help ideas of the period. Two popular books were *King, Warrior, Magician and Lover* by Moore and Gillette, and *Iron John* by Robert Bly. Bly's book was a presentation of how the Grimm's Fairy Tale of the same name (Iron Hans) was a 10,000 year old teaching tool for the initiation of boys. But I feel the books of this period missed a great deal of what initiation and adult really means.

The Men's Movement has mostly dissolved, but something else has taken its place. This is an ideology called Men Going Their Own Way (MGTOW), a label for those who choose not to be in relationships with women at all, and focus all of their energy on improving themselves. This has gained an appeal with younger men in their 20s (who feel they have no chance in a dating market that is rigged against them), and also with divorced men in their 50s and 60s (who feel that marriage gave them nothing but headaches and a loss of half of their wealth). This is not the book to go into these specifics, but the impact of what MGTOW will likely mean in the next two decades should be acknowledged. Just as originally feminism was a logical approach for the experiences of women in the 1950s, so too is MGTOW for men of the 2020s. The question will be, will these movements be able to generate the transformations they claim to seek, or only create more problems?

Feminism in the 1950s and 60s placed the blame for the conditions of the world on men, and so went on the offensive to get rid of masculinity. Well not exactly. The feminists wanted to redefine masculinity to mean "what is beneficial for women." thus be able to claim the masculine for themselves (thinking that if they had this principle, they

would rise to the top of all the power dynamics). But if you read fairy tales, stealing a magic potion for yourself tends not to bring great results. The idea was that if women were in control of everything in the world, all would be fine. Women have risen to the top in most areas, but is the world currently fine? Many women are now realizing that this approach was not the way to create a balanced and healthy world. It requires a dynamic where the dance of the masculine and feminine can play out so that both regain their co-operative power. You can't try to force a Divine Principle to be what you want it to be, but accept it as it is and allow it be, then interact intelligently with it.

With nowhere else to turn, and without real adult role models, by the time boys reach twenty some will join the New Age Movement, become a vegetarian, and look for the government, Buddha, Jesus, or mommy to save them. Others will go the other way and ignore the world's problems while watching football, drinking beer, and staring at a screen. Others will decide that the world is a crappy place, so they are going to steal everything they can from it, and treat others the same crappy way they have been treated. Few decide to figure out what it means to be masculine, and live that, no matter the personal cost for doing so. Yes a real Men's and Women's Movement is needed, but so far few seem to understand what is really required. Perhaps this book can be the beginning of seeing things from a much larger scope.

The ancient ideas I have been presenting are a contrast for today to show what could be possible. However, the boys' ceremonies were not fun, in many cases they were horrific. And that has to be examined. Tribal cultures themselves might have become distorted in these practices themselves. Throwing virgins into a volcano used to be thought of as a good idea. Everything always needs to be examined with fresh clear eyes, to determine its long-term value. I will write this chapter as I did with the girls' ceremonies, providing

foundation points, followed by an explanation. While the girls chapter used Native American ceremonies as the main focus, this chapter will use many various world locations and tribal ideas as examples.

A boy did not have a physical marker like a girl, thus boys around the possible ceremony age were watched for various signs that indicated that they were “ready” to move from child to adult. But this usually was not individual, the tribe waited until 3 or 4 boys were ready, and one large ceremony was made for all of them together.

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Point: Sacred Ground.

The place where the boys would go through their ceremony was often constructed to mirror the conditions at the Origin of Creation. This is most clearly represented in the Aboriginal *Bora*, where the sacred ground is made to mirror Baiamai’s (Creator god’s) first camp. Much of the ceremony will include gestures and actions that are supposed to be the ones made by Baiamai at the Creation.¹⁵⁰ From this experience, the boys become personally immersed in the myth. Without a sacred space, the event is just another experience happening in the wilderness. And that is really important to understand. This was not a simple ceremony like a birthday party, this was meant to be a revelation of sacred energies and open doorways to deep personal insights.

150 Eliade pg 5-6

Point: Separation from the mother.

*“The intention of all that is done at this ceremony is to make a momentous change in the boy’s life; the past is to be cut off from him by a gulf which he can never re-pass. His connection with his mother as her child is broken off, and he becomes henceforth attached to the men. All the sports and games of his boyhood are to be abandoned with the severance of the old domestic ties between himself and his mother and sisters. He is now to be a man.”*¹⁵¹ A. K Howitt

One of the most important steps in becoming an adult is to break the worldview of the parents. This is most important for a boy, who has to make a clear break from the world of his mother, or he will never stop being her “little boy.” It is one of the reasons that the ceremony took place in an area far from camp, thus away from mommy’s watchful eyes.

Some tribes would do this separation simply, with the mother handing over the boy to the initiating men when the time came. In other tribes there was a dramatic ritual where masked men would come and steal the boys, while the mothers try to stop the invaders. Of course the women were acting, but the point being was that the boy needed to feel the actual fear of “death to his old world,” or he wouldn’t let go of it. In some tribes the mother and close family members would go through a mourning process when the boy left just as if the boy had actually died. The idea was to make clear to everyone that the boy they had known was dead, and someone new would later be returning as an adult.¹⁵²

151 Van Gennep pg 75 presenting Howitt’s views of the male rites of the Kurnai tribe

152 Eliade pg 7

This time with male role models would allow the boy to learn about the specifics of hunting, the sacredness of nature, and how and why one must honour everything that one kills and eats. When completed the now young man will no longer feel dependent on his mother (or on anyone else) to feed him. He will have moved to a place where he feels he can look after himself.¹⁵³

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Point: Learning teamwork.

One of the major differences from girls' ceremonies was that boys went through the process as a group, while the girl had an individual ceremony.¹⁵⁴ The boys needed to learn how to function in strong and cohesive groups. This can be seen with a male sports team. The coach must determine who is best for what role. Most men will accept that they don't have to be the scoring star, because the team may need something else from them. Thus one has to learn how to be selfish and humble, to accept a role and do that well for the success of the team. Because men are the ones given the tasks of hunting and war, there is no room for being concerned about inclusiveness or how people feel. A mistake can mean several people dead. Group dynamics function for the survival of the whole. And boys had to learn all of this.

Due to my hockey days, much about working in units was revealed. Hockey in the 1980s was a war-like environment. I had to trust that my team-mates would have my back in a problem, as they knew I would have theirs. I did not need to like my team-mates, or even socialize with them

153 Eliade chapter 2

154 Granted there are records from a few tribes, the Yamana and Halakwulup for example, where the girls and boys are both initiated together, although each sex also receives separate teaching from either older men or women. Eliade chapter 2

after the games, but when the puck dropped I had to see every one of them as a close family member. You learned to play with the pain, do your job, and achieve your personal and team goals. These ideas of teamwork are forged in the way these ceremonies are set up.

Tribal societies also depended upon strong connective elements of male and female connectiveness in key areas. For example, in many Native tribes of the American East, while it was the men to hold the role of chief, it was the women who were the only ones to vote. It would be the women's intuition and feeling that decided which of the men would be the most trusting to be sure the entire community's needs were well looked after. Should the women no longer feel their selection was fulfilling his role, they could change him at any time.¹⁵⁵ This is an amazing understanding of the interaction of the masculine and feminine, and maximizing each gender's natural inherent strengths.

But the rest of this examination is about how the boy learns to connect with, and join, the world of the men.

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Point: Tasks.

Within the ceremonial time is often a personal or sacred task that the boy is expected to do. It is often something that on the surface seems mundane, but needs to not just be completed or handled, but completed and handled well.

This happened with me at Sweat Lodges with Bruce, where after a few months he gave me tasks. They might be to start and look after the fire, or bring the hot stones into the lodge. Yet almost always he was scolding me. I wasn't paying

¹⁵⁵ League of Women Voters "How Native"

attention, there were too many ashes on the rocks, or the wood wasn't piled properly for the fire. He was not doing this to be mean, but to remind me I was not just being given a task, but a sacred task. Thus they require a certain amount of attention. I was not giving that, and only when I took the role 100% seriously did he lay off of his attacks at my laziness. I don't doubt that such things would have been part of the long initiatory boy to adult process, where he would be scolded often for his lack of attention to the sacred rites and ceremonies. That is because the young man is going to need clear and deep attention to fulfill the key roles that will be handed to him, as I will soon discuss.

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Point: Vision and Purpose.

The Native American tradition did things differently than in the rest of the world. And while there were various painful challenges such as being dumped repeatedly in ice waters or getting cuts to the arm from a knife, for most tribes the main pathway was via a Vision Quest (called a fast in Native tradition). This is something that most boys would go through at their coming-of-age, and then for those who become medicine men, it was a practice they would continue throughout their life.¹⁵⁶

156 And yes there other elements for some North American tribes beyond the Vision Quest, a more famous example being the Mandan Plains Tribe. Their Okipa ceremony is well known (even being featured in a few movies), even though they are a tribe almost no one knows anything about. But this was not a coming-of-age ceremony specifically, just one that occurred several times a year participated only by men. There are many similarities in it to some of the Australian and African boys' ceremonies, especially the linking to the origin of the world, and the first conflicts that needed to be solved so that people and the animals could life in a type of harmony. This ceremony is so odd on many levels, and I intend to do a more complete analysis of it in the near future.

When the boy was considered of age, he would go and spend a few days with a medicine man to prepare. After getting instructions, making the ritual objects (such as tobacco ties), and having a purification sweat lodge, the boy was sent to an isolated place in nature. There he would set up a ritual enclosure. Often he was given a pipe to pray with and prayer flags to place to define the area. This is where the boy would spend four days without food or water, never leaving his enclosed space. Solitude was a key part of this process.¹⁵⁷

Sadly most modern researchers do not really understand the core of this ceremony. Many suggest that a Vision Quest was about the boy praying so that he could find a power animal. No, this was not a type of mystical experience. It was to have a vision, which would indicate his personal purpose that would guide him for the rest of his life. If a man does not have a purpose (a clear direction of where one is going and why), then his actions will be scattered and it will be like he is walking in circles, using up energy but getting nowhere.¹⁵⁸

On the boy's return from his Vision Quest, he will share his experience with the medicine man, and it will be examined as to its symbolic meaning. The boy will generally be given a new name, as I was given a Native name at age 37. I never use this name in the normal world, even my wife does not know what it is. I only use it privately when in a ceremony. The boy may also have found a personal song that will be his protector through life. I found such a song when I was 31 years old, and again it is something private that I use only while in ceremonies.

157 See Mails *Secret Native Pathways*, Nicholas Black Elk *Black Elk Speaks* and Wallace Black Elk *Black Elk: Sacred Ways of a Lakota* for more information on the Vision Quest.

158 Purpose in the life of men and women will be discussed in the next book, because purpose acts differently in both of their lives.

Point: Silence and Introspection.

*“The wicasa wakan wants to be by himself. He wants to be away from the crowd, from everyday matters. He likes to meditate, leaning against a tree or a rock, feeling the earth move beneath him, feeling the weight of that big flaming sky upon him. That way he can figure things out. Closing his eyes, he sees many things clearly. What you see with your eyes shut is what counts.”*¹⁵⁹
John Lane Deer

I present one element from the tale of Iron John. Early in the story, when the boy was in the wilderness with the Wild Man, a task was given. That was for the boy to watch the sacred pond and not let anything fall into it. For three consecutive days (the alchemic process) a part of the boy wound up getting into the pond, and when it did, each part would turn golden. On finding this the first two days the Wild Man forgave him. On the third day it was the boy's hair that fell into the pond to turn golden. At this point Iron John kicks the boy away from his camp to now be on his own. But the boy is not being reprimanded, there is something much greater being revealed in these metaphors.

The hair falling into the pond occurred after the boy was looking at his reflection in the water, and stared into his own eyes. This connects to the tale of Narcissus, who also stares at his own reflection in the water. However, Narcissus fell in love with his own image and in a sense “merges with his image in the water.” I have shown in *Empty the Cave* how that myth is a symbol for how the Divine Spark got tricked into entering the water realm of the Matrix.

¹⁵⁹ Lane Deer pg 155

But the Iron John tale is presenting something else. Here the boy was staring into his own eyes, not in order to love himself, but to Know Himself. He is doing the inner work of introspection through the concept of Who Am I? He saw not only what was negative about himself and needed to be transformed and healed (his finger), and he found what was powerful about himself (symbolized by his hair). This staring into the image on the pond is similar to the Vision Quest. That is what is going on here, the boy is getting his vision, as well as a better inventory of his physical world self.

For this introspection to occur, men need to be alone for periods of time, away from women and children. If they stay too long within the women's world (the material) their links to the spirit realm get weaker.¹⁶⁰ The more the women in a man's life can understand this, and encourage these periods alone, the more it will help him strengthen the link to his purpose. This gets personified in the many Vision Quests that the medicine man will continue to partake in during his life, or the long solitary Walkabouts that Aborigines will take through sacred sites of Australia.

The Wild Man sending the boy away from the pond on his own is not a punishment. There comes a time when everyone has to learn how to figure things out on their own. Mr. Park used to tell us that we could never stay with him forever. At some point we have to leave and go follow our own life, and if by a certain time we had not left on our own, he would kick us out. That is what is going on here. He learned what he needed to learn at the pond, so it was time to go into the world and further his understanding from his own inner knowledge and less from an outside teacher anymore.

As much as men work within units of men, solitude is something that every man needs to retain his inner core. Too much time within the world of the village, can mean that he gets dragged too often in the material, and loses touch with

¹⁶⁰ Lawlor chapter 12

the level of his purpose, or with his connection to realms beyond the physical. Thus men need periods alone. Some in fact are more like lone wolves, and they thrive alone and rarely spend time with groups. That is also a valid way of living a male's life.

Unlike the girls, sexual matters for the boys was only a small part of the coming-of-age period. There were two reasons for this. Firstly, because the shift from boy to man was so great, the energy had to be placed on the trials that were going to be upcoming. Secondly, many tribes thought that boys of 15 or 16 were not mature enough to be in a physical relationship with girls, and required up to another ten years (as well as instruction by an older female), before a young man was thought to be “ready” to have a wife. I discuss some of my personal experiences around this subject in the Red Riding Hood additional material.¹⁶¹

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Point: Challenges, Wounds, Ritual Death.

I come to the most detailed section of this chapter, the subject of the many tests and challenges that were put upon the boys. The girls also went through challenges, from running, to dancing continuously, to not eating berries. But the boys' challenges were on a completely different intensity level. In many cases they were brutal. The claim was they needed to test their courage and the ability to withstand pain, so as to enter into trance-like states. Part of this was the need for the boys to learn not to complain or shut down at a key moment in hunting or defense due to some pain and suffering. Real-world actions were going to be demanding, but to give into the pain and not continue the hunt for example,

¹⁶¹ The book *African Figurines* presents various figurines used as teaching tools during the boy's ceremonial process. Many of these appear to me to be various sexual positions, almost like figure elements from the famous Asian book *The Kama Sutra*.

might lead to someone's death, as well as a lack of food for the tribe.

On one level, a boy needs to be tested, and wants to be tested, to see for himself what he is capable of achieving. It is why young men want to compete against each other. It is not so much about seeing if you are "the best" (the way self-importance tries to make competition), but about finding out what your own personal best currently is, and by seeing someone else, what could be possible.

Some of the more "simple" challenges could include being forced to stay up all night, long periods of fasting, or continuous plunges into ice waters. Some tribes have the boys kept in continual darkness as a symbol of being immersed in the Other World (Void).¹⁶²

Tsonga boys of South Africa go through hell. They are severely beaten, subject to cold, must eat horrible food that makes them sick, nearly get their fingers broken, and then are circumcised and told they will die if they do not heal properly. The Zuni ritual of Southwest US culture includes the boy being hit many times with sticks by men in masks representing evil spirits. Then the evil spirits take off their masks to reveal that they are really men of the tribe. This is similar for Hopi boys, who get a whipping, and then are introduced to the secrets of the Kachina ceremonies. In the Yamana tribe of South America the boy's initiation, "*includes the boys segregated in a cabin, and an evil spirit, the Earth Spirit Yetaita, is presented as a being who eats people. During the ceremony Yetaita is represented by one of the instructors, painted red and white. Springing from behind the curtain, he attacks the novices, throws them up into the air.*"¹⁶³

162 Eliade pg 19, Markstrom pg 181

163 Eliade pg 78-82, Markstrom pg 163 and Henri Junod *Life of a South African Tribe*

Other challenges can symbolize that the boy is swallowed by a type of monster (like Jonah in the *Old Testament*). Often the cabin or hut they are taken to in the wilderness is made to represent a water monster, crocodile or serpent. While inside the hut they are symbolically imprisoned in the beast, and when the ordeal is over, they will be reborn. But this is not the womb of their mother, as many researchers claim, but a greater cosmic womb, so that they can be reborn now not from the material realm, but the spirit.

Cory Hans describes how in one tribe the boy is given a second birth experience, but this time symbolically happening out of the men instead of a mother. The boys had to first run (get ready for birth), then painfully crawl through a tunnel (trauma of birth), then get pulled out of the end of the tunnel by men (symbolizing delivery). The boy is then laid on his back and gets covered with red earth and the intestines of a chicken (symbolizing afterbirth). He is then carried away on the backs of the men and is not allowed to speak (as newborn babies cannot speak), before getting cuts to his arms (to become one of the men of the tribe).¹⁶⁴

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On examining these varied difficult tests the boys are put through, many of them remind me of the rituals I have read about from the lower grades of modern secret societies. University and sports hazings are an offshoot of these. The difference is that in the tribal world, youths did not initiate other youths (it was the elder men) and for a grander purpose. The actions by fraternities or sports teams over the last hundred years have been where someone older will brutalize someone younger to make themselves feel superior. This achieves nothing for anyone involved. However, the deeper

164 Hans pg 26-27

question to ask is, did the tribal rituals described in the paragraph above really achieve anything either?

Take for example the ritual mentioned of the tribal men beating youngsters while wearing demon masks, then revealing after that it was the men doing the beating. Perhaps at its core this was supposed to help the boys tell the difference between when they were under attack from a regular man or from an actual demonic being. But that seems like a poor teaching tool. Preparing the boy to face the demons makes far more sense, and that would include not just tests but also calculated instruction. I presented my first encounter with one of these beings in *Falling For Truth*. It was an intense experience, but I did not need any sort of “sacred wounds” or “attacks by elders in masks.” By being face-to-face with this “thing” in a normal everyday shopping mall was enough to give me the verification I needed about what resides in the worlds beyond this one.

One of the common challenges was the receiving of a sacred wound. This would become a visible scar for the rest of one’s life and functioned as a linking point to this experience. This is not something small and symbolic (like getting a tattoo), but an intense experience. Tribes such as the Wiradjuri knock out a tooth of the boy to make the new young man like their chief god Daramulun, who lost a tooth at the First Time. In other tribes, cuts might be given with a knife to the arms, chest, head or even genitals. In some tribes the older men also cut themselves, then place that blood on the boy to give him a new birth via “male blood,” as they had originally been smeared with female blood when born as an infant.¹⁶⁵

One of the more famous of the wounding rituals is circumcision, the cutting off of the foreskin from the penis. It is hard to discover the origin, but my sense is that it was something introduced in the Middle East during the change

165 Eliade chapter 1, Lawlor pg 186

to agriculture 12,000 years ago.¹⁶⁶ In Africa, the men performing the ritual are often presented to be related to animals, usually cats like lions and leopards. The men who perform it wear an animal skin to make it seem to the boy like it is a spirit animal performing the act. After the ordeal, the boys get dressed in the animal skins to indicate that they have now gained access to the spirit of the animal that has been invoked. Eliade related that in the Australian version of circumcision, the boys were presented with the belief that it was being performed by divine or even demonic beings. Again why would you want the young boys to think a demonic being has circumcised them? How would that get them ready for a future life protecting the village from these so-called beings?¹⁶⁷

There have been many attempts to explain why circumcision rituals exists. Henri Junod suggested that it was to teach endurance, balance and manliness. Another theory is that by giving such a painful experience, it forced the new initiate to learn how to alter his consciousness to move away from reality, thus stepping away from the pain. Again it seems like an overly cruel thing to endure when there must be alternative ways to achieve this. Nor is the end result creating any better health in the boy than not having this process.

One suggested reason for these wounds was given by Robert Lawlor, *"The inflating nature of the male's psyche is balanced by the self-wounding, which deflates a man's concerns with the physical world, so that there can be a return to his inner core. After getting the 'wound,' they would need to recover from it, in isolation, silence, and inactivity during which they practiced symbolic methods of expression, such as bark painting. Periods of deflation are helpful, if these down*

166 Researchers such as Graebner, Schmidt and Speiser also thought it was recent (post agriculture).

167 Various versions of this ritual can be found in Eliade pg 21-23, Bullroarers (simple wooden instrument to create a vibrational sound) used during the ceremony are meant to produce the sound of the spirit that is invoked at that time.

periods are used correctly, instead of the way of modern man who continues on and only faces exhaustion and failure."¹⁶⁸ Said more simply, the male psyche has more of a trend towards self-importance than the standard female psyche. Thus the sooner this idea of being special and entitled can be burned out of the male mind, the sooner it can acquire a clear state. It is interesting that in the last forty years, as women have taken on a more masculine mindset, their self-importance and entitlement has also risen (often focused towards gaining attention on Social Media) to match men, who continue their self-importance attempts on achieving titles or roles.

These various pain inducing elements have caused me to really wonder if the ceremonies had been infiltrated by archons over the course of history. Meaning that what has been passed down for the last several centuries may not have been the original ceremonies. I cannot verify that, but it seems like a logical assumption. The archons were the ones who added the intense pain and suffering (so they could get a loosh harvest off every boy) and also created a traumatic wound (thus an open gateway in their energy field) that the beings could use to stay hooked into the boy through the rest of his life, while providing enough actual steps up the spiritual ladder to make it seem as though the entire process had completed itself.

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Point: Protecting the world.

I have not presented these sections on ancient coming-of-age ceremonies to promote them as things anyone should be replicating today. It is to show that there was an understanding that the transition to adulthood was important (not just for the individual young person, but for the entire

¹⁶⁸ Lawlor pg 198

community) and that they devised a structure to help with that process.

One key element for the boys was the need to experience a ritual death. By this I do not mean something symbolic like laying in a coffin for an hour and imagining yourself dead. Martin Prechtel discussed in his book *Long Life: Honey in the Heart*, that the boys' rituals were difficult to endure because they were designed to send them to the Underworld to confront death, "*not as some sort of ritual or symbolic event, but for real. Some died in this process.*"¹⁶⁹ The underworld in mythology was an initiatory ideal; to descend alive into Hell and confront its monsters, find the inner power of their own Divine Spark, and return back to the material realm a Hero, meaning one who now has found the power of the Self.

The underworld of mythology is the astral realm. This dimension is not a symbolic part of the psyche that has to be overcome in therapy. It is a real place of demons and entities that want to infringe on people and the world. Young men have to learn the potential horrors of that place, to find the courage for the rest of their life to hold these forces at bay so that the entire village and the rest of nature can live relatively peacefully. This insane world will never be fully sane (as these beings are the creators of this reality thus reality is insane at its core), but humans have the power to block some of this force and bring more sanity to the material realm.

To do that, masculine and feminine have to work co-operatively together in a type of dance. Today however, women are twerking alone on one side of the room filming themselves, while men sit in chairs alone on the other side of the room staring at screens of the twerking women or playing

169 Prechtel pg 359, I agree with much of his final chapter on this subject, yet I also see some concepts that if followed would lead to not Exiting the Cave.

video games. And I have nothing against women looking nice, or taking photos of themselves for someone special in their lives. Nor do I have anything against men playing a video game, if it is kept to a reasonable amount of time as a short mental break from the challenges of material reality. But if either becomes a core life choice, then it becomes another energetic trap.

The men in HG life had to have direct interactions with death, and their competency with it would determine how well they could fulfill their tribal roles. Women set the direction of what went on in most areas of the material world, except hunting and war. That is because those two activities had death as their foundation, thus these areas became the domain of the men. Those who understand what death is, do not like killing, either of persons or animals. Yet they know they must sometimes kill (food for the village) or other beings (if they infringe on the village's security). But this is something they do not take lightly, it is a symbolic and ritual activity. The only way to know death is to experience it personally. Mircea Eliade provides one such death ceremony example of the Pangwe of Western Africa,

“On the day of the festival they are given a nauseating potion to drink, and any novice who vomits it up is chased through the village with cries of “You must die!” The novices are then taken to a house full of ants’ nests, and are made to remain inside it for some time, during which they are badly bitten; meanwhile their guardians cry, “You will be killed, now you must die!” The tutors then lead the novices to “death” in a cabin in the jungle, where, for a whole month, they will live completely naked and in absolute solitude...At the end of the month they are painted white and are allowed to return to the village to take part in the dances, but they must sleep in the cabin in the bush. They are forbidden

*to let women see them eat because, of course the dead do not eat.”*¹⁷⁰

During the coming ceremony, the boys are considered dead and are treated as such. The men may take the boys back to the village for a day where mothers and other relatives treat them as if they do not know who they are. In some tribes the boys are painted white to appear as ghosts. Another interesting concept is that in many African tribes, after going through the ritual death, the young men seem to forget everything of the past prior to when the initiation started, *“They recognize neither their families nor their friends, they do not even remember their own names, and they behave as if they had forgotten how to perform even the most elementary acts—washing themselves, for example...Forgetting is a symbol of death, but it can also be interpreted as betokening earliest infancy.”*¹⁷¹ The question is, is the forgetting a response to a spiritual death and rebirth, or the boxing off of memories by the mind as a result of severe trauma?

Without a direct interaction with death, the egoic identity would not give up its ownership of the body. In my River Canyon Experience, my egoic self, mind and thoughts were still active until I was 100% in agreement that I was going to die. Only when I accepted that death would be the result, did the “me” finally dissolve, and *What I Am* could be revealed. One cannot be reborn into something new, until the old thing has first been annihilated. In the final chapter I suggest more as to one aspect of what these original ceremonies were targeting in the young boy or girl.

In most cases, I think that tribal societies were as confused about the after-death process as modern cultures. In time, tribal cultures began to get wrapped up in ideas of helpful dead ancestors, happy hunting grounds, or places where souls go to learn to become wise and godlike. The

170 Eliade chapter 2 for more examples

171 Eliade chapter 2

Heaven myth gets sold to every culture in one form or another. Some groups were tricked into the use of drugs, which is to rely on outside help for insights, as opposed to one's own power. 99.9% of all souls are going to get tricked by the archons on death: either by being overblown with love, or hit with a wave of guilt, temptation, or fear. The ceremonies core origin was to get tribe members to the *natural adult* stage so that they might later be able to go past that using their own power, no longer being wasted as excess loosh back to the Matrix.

If the astral realm is kept in balance, the material realm becomes much easier to manage. Mindfulness is not a meditation workshop to have less stress in one's life, it is to be one step ahead of everything that might go on in the environment (material or spiritual). Masculine men know reality is a dangerous place. That is why the 50+ years of the Men's Movement has created little transformation. The focus has been on healing traumas, fulfilling one's dreams, or fixing the government. Which is fine as a first step, but none of this was focusing on the real problem inherent in this reality, which are the systems of civilization that distort and manipulate reality. The entire current reality is the problem.

A male's role was to act on something BEFORE it had manifested into the material. This relates specifically to blocking the demonic tentacles before they can enter, but it also means to look at positive things that can be manifested and help them to. Today, the astral is normally thought of as a place of fun, where you fly over mountains and make all of your wishes come true. It is a very different place than that, a place where the AI archons reside and set up emotional traps to ensnare awareness. Only with clear logic can those emotional traps be seen and dismantled. If men do not understand their important role in the balancing of reality, they will easily be tricked to leave their Divine role and, "*tend to become drones, masochists, or warriors. Man has attempted to make the natural world (the domain of the feminine) into his own Kingdom,*

*but the metaphysical purpose of masculine energy is far different. The health and success of a society depends on men discovering in the spirit realms of death and the unborn, the true creative sources of the Universal Masculine.”*¹⁷²

Young children, especially boys, can sense this world's corruption. They know the evils of the world cannot be fixed by the normal ways of voting, protest marches and signing petitions. They sense that something “supernatural” is needed to overturn everything. It is why the comic book superhero has such an appeal. Superman, Batman and Spider-Man are not reading material for a seven-year-old boy, they are career options. Even the movie *V for Vendetta* needed a comic-book-like hero to save humanity. But the child finds no older role models who also see what he sees, or have tangible ideas of what to do about it. Of course the child does not realize that many of these older men saw something similar when they were seven, but that seeing got shaken out of them and forgotten in the same way that these older men were going to shake it out of this new boy. In case you are wondering, it never got shaken out of me, that seeing of the make up of reality (and the almost nightly dreams that came with it as a child) stayed mostly continuous for the last fifty years.

I don't want people to think that the only element of the original boys' ceremonies were spiritual or involving learning to navigate the astral. That was just the element of the masculine role that has tended to be the most lost today. Many in the world teachings were required from hunting, to tool making, to group dynamics, to creating lasting male friendships, to interacting with the feminine. But the main task of protecting, in all of the layers it was pointing towards, was as important an element as any other of the ceremonies. And it is something that the men expected to be appreciated for, as the female was expected to be appreciated for their

172 Lawlor pg 195

nurturing and playfulness for example. Almost no one appreciates anyone, or anything today.

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But I come back to the ceremonies. The question has to be: where did all the energy from the pain and suffering these young men are going through in these ceremonies wind up? The answer is likely the archons. The archons have tricked the men to dress up in demon costumes, then play out their wishes for pain energy within the ceremonies. The archons are having a feast on the trauma. One needs to learn about this archon force and how to face it with power, not give them energy from additional trauma (life itself sets up enough). One has to see the make up of reality, and look for ways to connect with it and protect it, not run or hide from it.

We use challenges to find inner power and shake the Divine Spark out of its coma. There are far better ways to do that than what I am seeing here. The boys' process has much value at its core, and there is even a need to find ways to interact directly with the process known as death. The question becomes how to create that without producing high amounts of loosh energy for the archons to feed on while in that process? One needs to see this underlying structure clearly, and also not impose an implanted false religious belief on top of it, which can keep one in the reincarnation cycle. While the participant has taken a step up to a more natural stage of adult from the ceremony as presented, they may also wind up chained to the stone of reality like Prometheus. One step up is not worth two steps down. Being able to Exit the Matrix is the ultimate goal. *Natural adulthood* should be part of the pathway, not become another trick away from it.

Given that it seems I have been quite negative about these ceremonies you may ask, what value can we take from

this chapter? First was to reveal how much the boys' process may have been hijacked and distorted from their origins. Thus to locate what were the core elements or intentions for it, and then see how they can be strengthened, in a way that allows eventual liberation from the archons and Matrix, not continued to be chained by them. To step into one's inner power, and not the belief structures of parents, society, or the archons.

Secondly I don't want readers to come from this chapter thinking that I am saying that men and women should be in romantic relationships together. Men don't really do well in spending a lot of time with women. Unless the woman is extremely feminine, then the masculine force will be attempted to be subdued rather than allowed to fully live. This is a very common occurrence today.

Men thrive by being with other men, either individually or in small groups. It is where men can test each other and demand a level of competency from each other, and joke with one another (even seemingly at times cruel). The jokes have a specific purpose, give a shot when someone's ego is getting a bit too big. If a group of guys do not do this with someone, it is often a sign that they really have no respect for them as a male and are not interested in having them around. It is not about being cruel but to know that others have your back, but they expect you to be part of the unit and thus show you will look after each other instead of yourself.

Similar to just about any other high level retired athlete, I don't miss the practices or even the games. I miss the camaraderie of the guys in the locker room. I miss seeing them as a family member, and knowing that if they needed me for something I was there for them, as they would be for me. The closer that connection usually the better the team would play. Talent and chemistry made winning teams, and in a sense, makes strong masculinity.

Base response guys, look for your masculinity as it was originally meant to be. Don't let gurus or experts tell you what that should be. Also do not define yourself by what women claim masculinity or male means. Neither from idiots or self-important men. You have to go looking for those who seem simple on the surface, but have depth within. Then use their suggestions as a focus point to within yourself. Don't focus only on a physical life, and give up your physical strength to be someone who can't use an axe or carry a heavy box up some stairs. It means to be balanced in both the physical and spiritual worlds.

You want to use a group of clear stable men as a guide, preferably one that shows signs of having *natural adults* within it. Everyone out there seems to want to attack masculinity today, so don't embody this to change the world, or to get back at the world. Do it for yourself, as a gift of possibility of keeping this Divine Principle active. Maybe only one other person can be helped by your embodiment of this trait, but if so, they will appreciate it.

CHAPTER 9

THE INTENTION

*“Our world no longer hears God because it is constantly speaking at a devastating speed and volume, in order to say nothing. Modern civilization does not know how to be quiet...Postmodern society rejects the past and looks at the present as a cheap consumer object; it pictures the future in terms of an almost obsessive progress. Its dream, which has become a sad reality, will have been to lock silence away in a damp, dark dungeon...The tragedy of our world is never better summed up than in the flurry of senseless noise that stubbornly hates silence.”*¹⁷³ Robert Cardinal Sarah

The point of this book is that, for a variety of reasons, a human¹⁷⁴ needs to make the transition from the child-adolescent state to the adult state. And that there tends to be a moment of time, which can be considered a doorway, that can initiate this transition. But that coming-of-age experience in itself does not complete the job, it starts it. A process is required from there. The coming-of-age movies from the last fifty years do a disservice to this, presenting that one life

¹⁷³ Sarah pg 56

¹⁷⁴ When I have used the word “human” in this book I mean it in how that word is thought of by the average man or woman, not how it is defined in various law dictionaries.

event (such as having sex, racing a car, or singing in a band) makes you an adult. They might be steps that open someone to a new way of seeing and thinking about themselves, but there are many more steps required, the most important of which are what could be called “changes to one’s character.” These films rarely depict the young man or woman gaining integrity, honesty with themselves, and acting with empathy and responsibility with the world around them. The films depict doorways. And doorways can look nice, but you can never see the inside of the house, church, or temple until you walk through.

When I was fifteen, the universe provided the conditions to create such a doorway for me. In those three days, all of the areas for my life transformation to an adult were laid out in a type of dream-like experience. But like all visions that arise, they have to be acknowledged, interpreted by an elder with more life experience, and then trusted and acted upon going forward. But since I didn’t know what had happened, I got to work on myself, very slowly.

Before getting into the details of what I want to present here, a reminder is required. I did not write this book to try to change or fix the world. That is not what my books are about. They may be a 180 degree shift from the typical reasons anyone writes a book such as this. I write about the process of going within, and seeing that the main thing required in an insane reality, is to find sanity within. From that point, should one choose to, they can walk into a discovery of their Totality and complete Self Definition to end the reincarnation cycle. But that end part is not really what the coming-of-age ceremonies were meant to do. They were meant to create the sanity part of the equation. Really this book may have less value right now, as opposed to a time in the future when modern civilization has burned to the ground, and the survivors can get back to living a more

natural human life. In some ways I wrote this as much for them, as for you.

I wrote that my coming-of-age experience was the reason why I could write this book. Actually that is only partially true. The main reason I can write this book is because of the eight years of intense inner work that began in 1997. That is what the coming-of-age was asking me to do. A big part of that was to examine the parasitic mind (as I will get to), and walk into the Underworld (see the depths of the Matrix and Self in new ways). That body of work reached a crescendo in 2005 with not only a dissolving of the parasitic mind, but also with a Realization of Emptiness. I sort of got the full meal deal while only ordering the soup of the day.

These coming-of-age ceremonies were meant to get the young person to take personal control of their life. To look at the life path one was meant to live (not what parents or others wanted) and then take the steps to root out all of the hooks, emotional patterns, and repetitive thoughts that link them to someone else's view of who and what they are. This takes as long as it takes, and will not be done in a weekend or even a month. It can be quite a process, depending how much of those "outside" ideas were taken in.

This is the work of small "s" self definition, to learn the make up of your mind intimately, how it operates, and most important what (if anything) to continue to listen to for advice. It requires a total evaluation of what you are. The trip to the Underworld is only partially about going into the astral realms to learn about the beings that reside there and how they impact our world. The work requires one to go into oneself, to locate what is residing inside of us. Hence the hero in these myths has to cross bridges that collapse once the hero walks on them, flaming arrows get shot while they navigate a passage, or they confront dangerous monsters. This symbolizes the various work of seeing required both within and without, the message being, it will not be easy.

These hero's journeys end well, but there is a lot to overcome to get there.

In my case *the inventory* was one of the most valuable things I have done, which I describe in *Falling For Truth*. One part of it was my *recapitulation* (life review) to get a clear view of what did, or did not happen in my life. But along with that was making an inventory of my mind. Over the course of ten days, I recorded what my thoughts were every three or four minutes. When those ten days were complete, I could generate a snapshot of what my mind was normally thinking. It was not a complete listing of every thought of course, but was enough to allow me to be able to see the general layout of thought patterns in my head more clearly. We think we know our mind, but until we get it written down on paper so that we can see it “from the outside,” we really have no idea. Next I would bunch thoughts together to see which were the most frequent. From that list I could determine what thoughts were of value or not, and in many cases find their origin (who gave me such an idea or belief to begin with). Knowing the source made it easier to let go of it.

But it is more than just thoughts themselves. Some were entire groupings placed together to create a series of hooks. Some were designed to hook my own personal attention, but others were designed to hook the attention of someone else. You can catch a version of this with someone who tells the same story again and again. That is an example of a thought loop, but designed to get attention from the world outside (sympathy for example). Most of our thought loops are designed to steal our energy from the attention within. It takes a while to get to see the differences between the two types of “attention grabbers.”

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The adult transition process is built into the human system. It is meant to happen naturally. So the obvious

conclusion would be, if in ancient times a ceremony was required, that meant the process was no longer functioning as originally intended. Either it was taking too long to begin, or it was not beginning at all. Something had gotten in the way. That something was the egoic parasite.

What we describe today as “my mind” is something that far back in human history (pre 12,000 years ago) did not exist. It is a recent phenomena from the standpoint of the human story. All humans have a natural mind, that is built into our being from birth. It is not the one the average person normally uses. The only way humans would go along with the switch to agriculture and civilization, was to be tricked. Part of that trick was for the forces beyond this realm (archons) to implant a new type of mind into humans as children, which then functions as a parasite. This new mind gets humans to put the focus of their energy towards their own personal importance, as opposed to a balanced world.

Already by the age of three or four, this new parasitic mind takes over control of a young person’s thought patterns, and begins to turn normal awareness of themselves and reality into a type of search tool to generate fear, anxiety, depression, and lack of worth. By the time someone is in their teens, this new mind will likely control 90% of what we call “thought.” The natural mind, which is a deeper voice of calmness, clarity and sharp intuitive knowing, may only appear 10% of the time. Even when the normal mind arises, most people tend to ignore it, settling only for the confused, circular thoughts of the parasitic ego. Calling it a parasite is important, because it lets the person examining this structure question if it has any value for them. Everyone looks for herbs to use if they find they have parasites in their digestive tract, few ever go to look if something similar has gotten into their mind and identity structures. Part of *Falling For Truth* discusses this mind, and includes the series of exercises that I used for over five years to track it and see it clearly.

Prior to civilization's appearance, coming-of-age ceremonies may not have been required. The transitional process from child to adult would have gone relatively smoothly, as it does for any other animal in nature. There would have been some instruction and assistance, but it would have been more informal, sort of how the new player on a sports team learns the team rules and expectations from the older players.

Civilization is the outer extension of this parasitic mind, or you could say that civilization is the outer system this archon-mind created in order to have a framework in which it could operate with impunity. Parasite and civilization go together. Tribal communities must have realized this problem early on from viewing the new agriculturalists, which is why they wanted to stay away from them if possible. But once this foreign mind began to be seen in their own children, these communities needed a system to remove it, as it was blocking the transition to *natural adulthood*. Since the tribal way is to create ceremonies for healing, this problem would have required the creation of a new ceremony.

This principle can best be examined via the boys' ceremonies, but it applies for the girls' as well, just in a different format. The clue for the boys is in the pain and suffering to push them towards a death experience. Originally there was a method to this seeming madness. However, as this information about the parasite became lost in our modern world, this ceremonial foundation seems to have gotten lost as well.

While there are elements that have been distorted in Native ceremonies over the centuries, the majority of them are filled with the original power they have always had. But it requires personal examination to see which still hold that original power, or which may have had distortion creep in.

The standard spiritual community can not even properly define ego, never mind provide dismantling options. The New Age Movement is all about finding ways to “use” this parasitic ego to get what you want, instead of dismantling it so that you can be the human you were naturally designed to be. All of this needs to be discussed to see what the coming-of-age ceremonies had as their original underlying intention, how much of that goal they managed to achieve, and how much they were infiltrated and distorted.

The egoic parasite is linked to the world of childhood because it gets installed early in life. I mentioned a story in *Falling For Truth* of seeing a young child of a friend getting her mindset “revised” by her parents. Thus part of this process is the inner the work of seeing the old parental mindset, which has been passed on from our own parents’ parasitic egos. That is why you can not make a break with this mind the way you leave an appointment early. It needs a strong push where something within is willing to step away from every safety net we have ever known, and start to begin to trust something deeper. That is the shift these ceremonies were looking to create, just over a shorter and more intense period of time than happens in normal life.

This transformation can not happen prior to puberty, as this process requires an age when the boy or girl can add the force of their own awakening sexual energy. It is not about sex as an action at this stage, just that the energy is available, so it can be channelled into pushing out the parasitic mind. I think that was the reasoning Martin Prechtel presented that the Mayans felt a young person was ready for their coming-of-age process only after they had developed an interest in the romantic and sensual side of life. It showed that a new layer of available was energy, and if harnessed and used effectively, could let the child state (and its mindset) dissolve and the *natural adult* mindset to come forth. It is why in my personal process when I was 15, to just have been

around NHL players would not have been enough. I needed the cheerleader to act like a magnet to my inner sensual energy. My work was then to move it towards transformation as opposed to personal gratification. At least in the short term.

My guess is that at the beginning, these ceremonies had a high success rate. But like anything in this reality, it does not take long for the archons to get involved energetically. Because civilization and the parasite are one, it knows how to infiltrate everything. I sense the archons managed to get specific parts of the ceremonies altered, to make it look like the parasite was being removed, when really they were often entrenching it. Let me explain.

By placing the boy in intense suffering, to the place of feeling that he may die in the forest during the ceremony, the ego can snap. Dissolve. That is what happened to me in the Canyon. At the exact moment when I knew for sure that I was going to die, my egoic identity was gone. Vanished, as if it had never been. Of course it had never been, but I only knew that once it was gone. It takes a powerful force to make that happen, the force of death. But there are many ways to use this force without actually having to get the body into a death position, just those other ways take years of effort. I can see many tribal cultures going for the direct route. The key was for the elders to learn how far they had to push someone towards death, without crossing over too far and losing young people during the ceremony, which would also create a society of no adults. They had to find a valid mid-point that balanced danger with reward.

But my Canyon experience was more than that, which makes it challenging for me to talk about this subject, because in my case two experiences happened at once. One part was that the parasitic ego was dissolved. Yet at the same time a realization of Emptiness occurred (which is something different). Dissolving ego is seeing that your regular mind is a

false implant and not there to help you, while a realization of Emptiness dissolves personal identity. It shows that the self one always believed oneself to be is fictional, as is the world itself. So it is difficult for me to differentiate between the two experiences for you, because both were happening simultaneously for me. The coming-of-age ceremonies were attempting to achieve the first experience (to dissolve the ego), but keep the identity. I don't want to go into more detail about these differences, as it is beyond the scope of this book. But I did want to mention it as I have seen a few internet articles that are confusing these two experiences.

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The desired result of the coming-of-age ceremonies was to bring forth the *natural adult state*. Just having the adolescent-parasitic ego dissolve does not immediately make you an adult, but the door is open if you want to go through.

I could have a lot of discussion here around identity crises such as anxiety or depression - areas that people in the modern world are dealing with often. But I will keep it brief. Sometimes these are symptoms of a mental distortion that requires the help of a health practitioner. Sometimes they are signs of a deep discontent from the buried adult self, who is seeing that the life being led by the body is a lie. Our adult self is in there, albeit covered over, and is trying to get our attention to hear, "hey, this life you're living, it's not the one we are supposed to be living." This discontent is the call for our authenticity, not only in what is true of perception in the moment, but moreso as to who and what you were born to be. The adult creation process asks us to listen to this inner voice and bring it forward. In such a case, these are not symptoms that you manage, they are pointers requiring you to

go within and root out all that is false that is drawing them up.

I think there was originally a limit to the pain and suffering created in the ceremonies. Enough to get the result required, but not enough to create traumas or derail the process. The young person is going to have to be pushed, and they are going to have to feel that death is close. That can not happen from a joyous experience. The parasitic ego has to get pushed to the wall. I think that is what the dancing and running for the girl was designed to do. She had to keep going to the point of complete exhaustion. At some point, her egoic structure would snap, stop functioning, and there would be the chance by her to see it as a false self. At that point the instruction of building a natural feminine adult core could commence, where a true deeper adult mind could rise up.

As I mentioned, somewhere in early human history, there was likely an infiltration by archons into the ceremonies. The ceremonies may have been working too well. So the archons managed to trick a few tribes around the world. Like the serpent in Eden, the archons began to speak to these people, tricking them into believing they were speaking to God, and telling them that the ceremonies did not really work. They needed to be more intense and more painful. As a result, the ceremonies began to change. While a majority of young participants would still be gaining the original purpose, a large number were getting their ego reinforced from traumatic experiences, all the while the tribe were believing that all the new initiates had moved into full adulthood.

Perhaps the leaders of these ceremonies at this time thought that a 70% success rate was worth it, so continued them. I am still working on that line of research. But my sense is that after several thousand years, the ceremonies became things that could just as well free a boy or girl from the parasite, or get them trapped even deeper within it.

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Seeing the Loss

“Every culture that maintains this (ancient) attitude about Mother Earth, also has restrictions against any individual owning land, or mining it or selling it. Such ideas were unthinkable to Native people until they met the invading Western cultures. Many authors, notably Carl Jung and Aldous Huxley, have stated that Western societies fear, hate, destroy, and also revere Indians, precisely because they express the parts of our personal and cultural psyches that we must suppress in order to function in the world as we do. How could present-day America possibly exist if great numbers of people believed that the trees and the rocks, the minerals in the ground, and the Earth itself were all alive? Not only alive, but our equals?...Therefore it is logical, normal, and self-protective for Americans to find the philosophical, political, and economic modes of Indian culture inappropriate and foolish.”¹⁷⁵ Jerry Mander

“Without access to land there can be no self sufficiency: land provides food, shelter, clothing. Without access to land people obviously have no place to stay. If you can force people to pay just so they can be alive on this Earth, nowadays these payments are usually called rent or mortgage, you’ve forced them into the wage economy. The same holds true for forcing them to pay for materials the Earth gives freely: the salmon, bison,

175 Mander *Absence* pg 214

buckleberries, willows, and so on that are central to the lives, cultures, and communities not only of Indigenous peoples but to all of us, even if we make believe this isn't the case...the need to separate the majority of people from their food supplies—thus separating them also from their freedom, was central to the design of civilization's early cities."¹⁷⁶ Derrick Jensen

The above quotations are a reminder of the reason for my writing this book. The loss of *natural adults* is part of a much greater loss, that of the reality and mindset that requires them. So much of this older natural reality has been stripped away that the majority of people can no longer even notice what this world may have been 12,000 years ago. Now a system of dependence has been created, and a system of “working” for one’s living is installed as logical.

All that is required to create this was one new distorted group of people with a bunch of new weapons, and a mindset to go and take over all the land currently used by others. These other societies then either had to match them (technologically) or die. Which means they had to become civilized just to stay alive. All you need is one to start the chain of mess to follow. None of the ideas of civilization are logical to a HG tribal community, where the entire landscape is their home, they care for it, and obtain everything they need for their sustenance (requiring only knowledge and some effort). Today very few have the possibility of living a self-sufficient life away from the entire systems of civilization. Ah, Brave New World.

The set up of HG communities had a foundation that was to keep the tribe, nature, and the spirit world in balance. Yet nowhere in any of this structure was the concept of a reincarnation trap, or the need to Exit an evil Matrix. And the

¹⁷⁶ Jensen *Endgame* pg 147

Matrix was likely happy with this set up. So you ask, why then did the archons create agriculture and civilization which changed the whole set up? Excellent question, and far too detailed for me to respond to here in this final chapter. But as a short answer, 12,000 years ago, the human system was changed. Simplified, the Matrix itself needed more energy (loosh) input from its human characters to keep the entire reality functioning, and also needed to block off an internal threat competing for control of that energy. Civilization was “implanted” and “infected” into this reality.

In response, tribal cultures looked to find ways to hold onto the old order, and thus had to find ways to weaken the parasite, and strengthen the resolve to reject agriculture and technology. Anything that was more than one step removed from nature was considered evil. A spoon carved out of a piece of a tree is a non-evil technology as it is a tool one step from nature. A toaster would be evil because of all the component parts of nature that had to be transformed and remade to become something other than what it was at its origin.

The problem we have today, is that civilization is now the norm for 99% of the world. Thus to find true liberation, it requires a different road map than the first responses of the HG communities 12,000 years ago. That, in my eyes, is to use 50% of their ideas, so as to live in balance with nature and others. The other half of work is seeing that this world is a reincarnation trap run by archonic beings for our energy, which was at the core origin of what became Buddhism, Advaita, Gnosticism, Sufism etc. Originally these ideas were not to create religions that could control the sheep and keep them in Matrix servitude (as they have become). They were the seedings of one individual who recognized that as civilization continued, and the day-to-day world for regular people got worse, as suffering increased and evil became more obvious to see, a few went looking for answers..

The suffering seen around them, forced these visionaries to look at reality much more closely than had been before the beginning of civilization. What they saw was surprising. Reality was not at all like they had been told. Neither were they themselves. From their personal realization, a few of them wanted to find and share their understanding with others, and devise Exit strategies, and “pass on” what they realized.

It is a very small group in history who attempted to devise true Exit strategies. Most of the so-called great thinkers of civilization are not on this list. Plato is not about Exit strategies. Nor is Dante, Shakespeare, and the majority of the New Age or modern religions. They have elegant writing, and at times give some insight into human psychology or the structure of reality, but lack the stark honesty of seeing the Matrix clearly and having a real strategy.

I don't want people to think that a tribal culture 15,000 years ago thought anything similar to what we call modern religions. They did not see the need to focus on their inner world in the way we do today. This became a response to the introduction of the parasite. If everything within you is wholly “your own,” you don't need to examine to find the “origin” of what goes on within. It has to be you. Thus their main focus was on the outer world of nature, and by fully and sensually connecting with nature, they would come to understand their own state of Totality through this.

One of the most important concepts for them was the idea of place, meaning the very spot they were standing on. They did not think of the “present moment” and how one needs to have their mind in some sort of conceptualized now, they were focused on being in the present space. They needed to know everything about it, its history, the plants and rocks

that were there, and the energies that it encompassed. Each spot was a focus of specific things, you do one type of activity on one spot, and another somewhere else. Thus you had to read the spot. If possible, food should be eaten at the spot it was obtained, because the energy of the food has a direct relation to the location. To take it away, means the connection to the place of its living is disconnected. One does not live on the same spot on Earth for too long, or the sustaining energies of that spot will get used up, and living will become difficult. It is another reason for the choice of being in constant movement, thus never being at one specific place too long to drain it of its “life supporting” powers.

It is why Native tribal cultures in North America were so devastated by their removal from their place of origin, being forced into reservations. The very power that could sustain their life was built into the very location that they lived. They were an extension of it, and not in any way separate from it. They would know the hills, forests, and rock outcrops as well as they knew their hand or nose. These spaces of nature were a part of their own personal being. To take them from the land was not only to deprive the Native Peoples from the power they needed for daily life, but it deprived that space of the Earth of having a set of devoted and thankful people to cycle energy back towards it.¹⁷⁷

Remember that in the pre-civilization world, the spiritual and the material were not really thought of as separate, but as a yin-yang type of idea where one was constantly influencing the other. We have lost these ideas today, as a focus is on the individual; “what do I want, what is best for me?” as opposed to “what is best for everyone, including nature?” The loss of that mindset has led to the gigantic mess that the world is currently in. One has been taught to be focused mainly on the needs of this “personal

177 If you want to read more on this idea please see chapter 12 of Robert Lawlor's *Voices of the First Day*.

me” and infrequently on the greater world of others. For the ancient cultures that created these coming-of-age ceremonies, the well-being of others was equal to the well-being of “me.” In fact, they could see little difference.

*

Conclusion

Perhaps now you understand why this coming-of-age process gets harder the older one is when it begins. At age sixteen, the parasite has perhaps had twelve years and is still relatively weak in its control. By the age of forty, it’s like an army that has fully dug in and is defensively prepared. It is going to take a lot to blow up those bunkers. Hence best to start this before any of the heavy fortifications are built. The other side of that trip is worth it, even though the longer it takes in terms of age to start, the more difficult it could be. But you don’t “wish” for it, you manifest the process from within.

I can’t do a standard internet list of do’s and don’ts for being an adult because it is a very detailed and personal process. Some elements are universal for everyone, while the majority of each person’s transformation will be unique. However, I have placed many subtle pointers throughout this book, that on reading might generate a feeling within that indicates what you need to work on. It does not matter what someone else’s steps are, only that you come to know what yours are. I wanted to be careful to not turn any of this information into what tends to become guru-organizations, where a hierarchy forms, there are followers, rules and feeling important. All of these things are the opposite of what these ancient ceremonies were leading towards, which was personal transformation, one person at a time

Thus I leave this examination with a call back to my 2019 book *Falling For Truth*, which discusses my personal examination of the egoic parasitic mind. Read through it and apply what parts of it are pertinent to your personal life journey. The first spiritual step is to have the intention to become a *natural adult*, thus leave the child and adolescent states behind. I hope no one else has to fall in a canyon, or go through ten years of hell, like I did. *Natural adulthood* does not happen by wishing for it, it requires an actual intention, and then action within the material world to make the intention manifest.

The idea of *natural adulthood* was embedded in these old tribal communities, and thus they are an outstanding foundation to allow a clear directed next stage of work. Becoming a decent person in this world is challenging enough. But some will be compelled to go and complete the final stage of the work, to fully define oneself and the Matrix. A *natural adult* mindset will minimize the hooks of the current reality, and lessen the loosh extraction, so that time and energy will be available should you want to go on to complete Self Definition, then through that power, *Exit the Matrix*..

It is a journey within, a journey in which silence must become a constant companion. As the first quote in this chapter from Robert Sarah so wonderfully points to, wisdom and silence go together. Wisdom is found in silence, then expressed in, and as, silence. We can share our journey with spiritual companions, but at the end, all revelation has silence as its core.

I am continuing my journey of writing. I have four more books planned to help better understand the great loss pointed to in this book, and how it occurred. I think this book can offer parents something to think about from the standpoint of how they can help an adolescent make this

transition. And for those who intent to go all the way to what *Exit the Cave* and *Empty the Cave* are pointing towards, then becoming a *natural adult* for yourself becomes one of the best friends you could ever possibly take along on such a journey.

Wishing you all well on your journey of recovery and remembering.

*“There is no new age, or even old age. There is only madness, and waking up from madness.”*¹⁷⁸ Richard Rose

¹⁷⁸ Found in John Kent’s thesis *Path to Reality Through the Self*.

Additional Material 1

What Is School ?

*“It was at home I learned the little I know. Schools always appeared to me like a prison, and never could I make up my mind to stay there, not even for four hours a day, when the sunshine was inviting, the sea smooth, and when it was joy to run about the cliffs in the free air, or to paddle in the water.”*¹⁷⁹ Claude Monet

A question has to be asked, what does a child really need to become quality adult? And I stress the words quality and adult. Readin’ Rightin’ and R’ithmetic are but three minor qualities needed. No one today is trained for the real world they have to encounter: spouses, children, balancing budgets, loans, solving problems with neighbors, and to critically think. Ask a 25-year old if they can remember details of what they were taught in grade seven or grade ten, and they will likely have a hard time even remembering the names of their teachers, never mind what they were taught.

“Ask any schoolchild why they don’t like school and they’ll tell you. School is prison. The only difference I can think of is that to get into prison you have to commit a crime, but they put you in school just because of your age. You are told exactly what you must do,

179 Gray “Why Students”

*and you are punished for failing to comply.”*¹⁸⁰ Peter Gray

No one in or just out of school thinks there was much value to it. It acts as a semi-prison you are forced to be in five days a week for almost fifteen years. Some elements can be nice, such as being with friends, but still there are a lot of other ways to obtain community and learn life lessons and not stuck in a prison-like environment having to ask for permission just to use a bathroom. The whole idea of these giant industrial schools is insane. Yet parents are demanding more of them.

Most, when asked, will tend to say that the modern school system is failing. I would say the opposite, the school system is doing exactly what it was designed to do. That is to have a semi-intelligent population that can not critically think, or really know much about anything. Such a population would be less likely to rebel. If you want a slave population you don't want thinking, intelligent, organizing, communicating people. You want people distracted by football, celebrity gossip, and free porn, while navigating a world of crime, poor water, air and food, while getting fatter, addicted, and lonely. As one of the 20th century's greatest philosophers (and comedians) George Carlin claimed, *“You know what they (government) want? They want obedient workers. People who are just smart enough to run the machines and do the paperwork, and just dumb enough to passively accept all these increasingly shittier jobs with the lower pay, the longer hours, the reduced benefits, the end of overtime and the vanishing pension that disappears the minute you go to collect it.”*¹⁸¹

And if you want a good look at what the school system has created in the US, just watch the various Youtube videos of someone asking university students basic questions such as: what is 9+9+9, how long is a quarter of an hour, name any three countries, or who fought in the US Civil War?

180 Gray “Transforming Education”

181 George Carlin “It’s Bad for Ya” (March 1, 2008)

Then see the blank stares and ludicrous answers. These are not just young people off the street being interviewed, but students in university. That is the output of the venerated school system.

True success does not come from school anyway. Most people who have “succeeded” are from elite families and secret societies, which are the main reasons for their “success,” not any innate intelligence or knowledge gained from so called school. Granted a few very intelligent people manage to navigate the system and wind up doing all right for themselves, but that tends to be rare. “*It’s a big club, and you’re not in it,*” reminds Carlin.

I think a short history of how our modern school system came about is required. John Gatto, in his books *Weapons of Mass Instruction* and *The Underground History of American Education*, as well as Peter Gray’s *Free To Learn* gives a summary of just who the “creators” of the school system were, and what they want from it.

Modern Western schools originate in the feudal system from thousands of years ago, where kings parceled off land to a lord, who parceled it off to serfs (slaves) who worked for that lord. In this system the prime component was obedience, either to the king, lord, father, or God. This need for obedience got compounded in Protestantism, the revolt of Martin Luther in the 16th century. Their focus was work, responsibility of one’s own success in life (or the afterlife), all based on if worked hard enough. It was the Protestants who were the founders of what we think of as modern school, and specifically in the German state of Prussia in the late 1700s. The Prussian elite wanted obedient children who would read the Bible and not question authority, so created “*an educational system designed to produce mediocre intellects, to hamstring the inner life, to deny students the appreciable leadership*

*skills, and to ensure docile and incomplete citizens, all to render the population manageable.”*¹⁸²

At least that is the theory laid out by people like Gatto and Gray, that the Prussian school system was built on the demands of militarism and obedience. There are other theories. Prussia, while eventually a military power in Central Europe, was also a center of art, music, philosophy, science, and the bettering of the middle class. Yet Prussia was founded by Teutonic Knights, who were part of the “layers of control” of the Medieval world. I point all this out to see that there is, with all historical examination, the need to see things through two eyes at once.

Much of modern school structure was formed by its founder August Hermann Francke, a Lutheran clergyman in early 1700s who set up the ideas of standard curriculum, class divisions, time schedules, and discipline because, “*it is necessary to break the natural willfulness of the child...making the will obedient.*” To do this required children to always supervised (watched), a Big Brother type presence to root out sinful behavior “to save them” from hell. Punishment was a core tool, beat children into obedience. Gray also remarked that a key element of the Prussian set up was “*to suppress children’s spontaneous ways of learning...It was believed at that time that children were born sinful, and that things that they did themselves would be sinful and harmful, and that the primary thing that children needed to learn is to is to be obedient to authority.*”¹⁸³

Once industrialism began, and the manufacture of goods required additional labour, a new workforce was needed, children. Children in Europe became the equivalent of slaves, often starting to work by the ages of six or seven, and who worked until 8PM six days a week. This was well into the end of the 1800s. But don’t think that school was “saving” children from the factory life. Gatto presented that

182 Gatto *Weapons* pg xvii

183 Gray *Free* 87-88, 96-98, Gray “Transforming”

given the choice in England, almost all children would choose the back-breaking factory life over school.¹⁸⁴

Originally schools were church controlled, but this began to be shifted to governments around 1800. Governments saw new ways to use school for the shaping of the population. Gray points out clearly that the majority of people in the 1800s, believe it or not, could read. Almost the entire population was literate thus, “*The primary educational concern of leaders in government and industry was not to make people literate, but to gain control over what people read, what they thought, and how they behaved. Secular leaders in education promoted the idea that if the state controlled the schools, and if children were required by law to attend those schools, then the state could shape each new generation of citizens into ideal patriots and workers.*”¹⁸⁵

Helping to create this change in thinking was to have children divided by age (thus have no chance to learn from older children), to have intense tests and grading (to create anxiety of failure), thus not allow the masses to ever come together as one (as they spent most of their childhood divided).¹⁸⁶ Recall that in the ancient world, all the children of a tribe played together, no matter the age, unlike today where everything (even sports) is all cordoned off by age. A seven-year old only gets to know one group of children for most of their life until the age of 18.

Prior to 1900, students often only went to school from age eight until they were 12 or 13, ready to work on the farm or somewhere else. Yet these young people were much more advanced than 18-year olds today. They could read, and the tests of the 1880s were far more difficult than tests several grades higher today. By 1900, the school day got longer, but homework was infrequent. With no longer being forced to be working in factories, free play began to re appear in the life of

184 Gatto *Weapons* , Gray pg 87-88

185 Gray *Free* pg 99-101

186 Gatto *Weapons* pg xviii and Gray *Free* pg 101

the child. By the 1980s more and more of this supposed free time was being taken over by homework, sports teams, clubs and parental demands.

*“The school became, in some ways, a polygamous version of the hierarchical early twentieth-century family, with the man in a position of authority (principle), the women working directly with children (teachers), and the children at the bottom. The task of the student, was to be punctual and obedient, to pay attention, to complete assignments on schedule, and to memorize and feed back to the teacher the lessons taught, without questioning either their content or the prescribed methods for learning them.”*¹⁸⁷ Peter Gray

The original system went through a change after 1900 in the United States, as rich industrialists such as Carnegie and Rockefeller decided a new type of schooling was needed. Not just one to teach obedience and lack of critical thinking, it also needed to promote consumerism. Gatto claims, *“Under the new system, the goals of good moral values, citizenship skills, and personal development were exchanged for a novel fourth purpose - becoming a human resource to be spent by businessmen and politicians.”* E. P. Cubberly, a key originator of early US school textbooks in the 1920s wrote, *“our schools are factories in which raw products (children) are to be shaped and fashioned.”* School is learning to wait your turn, accept the judgment of strangers, a need to be ranked on a scale of winners and losers...and to accept your place in the social class system.¹⁸⁸ Modern schools are the training ground of *Brave New World*, only on a more subtle scale.

Added to all this, in the 20th century schools began to be built similar to prisons. Take a photo down the hallway of a school, and the hallway of a prison ward, and it is hard to differentiate one from the other. Of course, a person goes to

¹⁸⁷ Gray *Free*

¹⁸⁸ Gatto *Weapons* pg 23, 53, 63

prison because they got convicted from a crime in a court, children go to school because they have reached a certain age. Are thus ages five to eighteen a crime?

Children want freedom to explore and live and play, in a safe environment where they know loved family members are close by. But in school, they are ripped away from their family and support system, told to do what the teacher tells them, believe anything they are told, with creativity or free thinking generally reprimanded. This is the exact opposite to how tribal children learn. For them school was in session all the time, every day, but not in some building far away from home. School was the natural world where they lived, the interactions with tribal elders, including their parents and siblings. They would learn by seeing, by doing, by testing, and by asking.¹⁸⁹

What a modern school should be doing, is by the age of 16 or 17 help each child find what they are really good at. And this had nothing to do with tests or lessons. This has to do with getting to know them as an individual, and seeing where their skills and passions lie. Then find ways to make recommendations so they can move in that direction. Not that anyone has to follow or do their “best skill,” but they know what they can fall back on. That is how things worked in a HG society. The one who had the best skills of making birch bark canoes, made the canoes. And not because his father was the canoe maker before (standard feudalism), but because they had the skills and interest.¹⁹⁰

For example, I would have liked to have found out at the age of 16 that I have a very unique skill. Efficiency. I can take any given task, and then after a day of doing it, begin to dissect it. How it being done, how can I get the same result

189 Lancy *pg 1*

190 John Gatto provided this encouragement for many of his students, and that is what makes his book an amazing read. Imagine having groups of teachers all thinking about children’s future the way he did?

with half the effort and time. My wife says I have this skill because I am naturally lazy, but the point being, at just about any job I had in about a week or two a manager would come by and ask, “how I was getting this done in half the time compared to everyone else.” Many thought it must be because I was some sort of genius. But no, it was just because I have the ability to see a whole in the parts, and see what parts can be moved around or preferably eliminated, and not in any way hurt the quality of the end result.

Additional Material 2

Red Riding Distortion

How many times has someone tried to snap you out of possibly making a poor life decision by saying, “you have to get these fairy tale ideas out of your head?” And that statement is built on some truth. Fairy tales originally had the purpose of keeping an older natural wisdom alive, but in time they got transferred into hope machines, that no matter what you do, you will marry a prince or princess and live “happily ever after.” But a false hope is not a good recipe for a healthy life.

You may ask, why I am going to spend so much time looking at one fairy tale? That is because some specific tales after 1700 have become a main foundational element for children, especially girls, as to how they should think about relationships and how to judge themselves for the rest of their lives. Fairy tales, as we have come to know them, can be said to be the main brainwashing and manipulation tool of the masses prior to television and movies. In the 1960s, Roman and Greek mythology was still taught in schools, while every home into the 1980s likely had various books of fairy tales. By 2000 that ended, and instead of distorted ideas directing young people’s lives came from song lyrics. You would be amazed how much a Billy Joel or Phil Collins song might have actually shaped your life.

Fairy tales have many layers built within them. The first layer was as series of stories for the use as core teaching tools of “living as an adult.” At some point prior to the

1700s, the tales were taken over by Alchemists, who needed to find hidden ways to pass on their teaching of the awakening process, and so they added various symbolic elements to the old tales. There is a reason why everything happens in threes (the three stages of alchemy: Nigredo, Albedo, Rubedo) or why when colours are presented, such as in the horsemen of Vasilisa, they are black, white and red (the three alchemic colours).¹⁹¹ My book *Power of Then* had a chapter discussing alchemy within fairy tales.

A third layer got added to the tales starting around 1700. From that period onward books of fairy tales began to be compiled such as by Charles Perrault in France or the Brothers Grimm in Germany. A main reason for their compilations was not to preserve these tales as claimed, but to create new versions that fit the wants of the European aristocracy. Revolution was in the air. France and the United States each had revolted between 1776-1793. Other European nations were concerned that the peasant population might rise against them as well. They looked for ways to quell the masses, and rewriting popular folk tales was one of those methods.

Two of the most famous tales today are Cinderella and Little Red Riding Hood. Each have versions that have been passed on for 300 years that are not anywhere close to the original versions. So we have to unpack the original useful information, only then can it be compared that to the 1700 and 1800s brain washing.

Since the 1970s fairy tales have been researched from just about every angle imaginable. A few books even looked at them through masculine, feminine and coming-of-age lenses, such as the *The Women Who Run With Wolves* and *Iron John*. But the majority of this research tends to be a

191 Sometimes a fourth state and colour was included (Citrinius, yellow or gold).

psychological evaluation of the tales, which tries to turn them into another aspect of the Self-Help marketplace.

As tools for helping present coming-of-age information, sex and relationships were one of the key elements within the core of these tales. A sexual life is not better or worse than a celibate life. Each choice has pluses and minuses to it. But to me, one really can not make such a choice until one has learned from experience each of those types of life, and determine which is best suited for the individual person. Mr. Park (the Korean monk I spent much time with) wanted us not to have sex, but to step back for a while and examine the subject. He didn't call for a life time of celibacy, but a period of time where we could examine what sex was. so we make better choices going forward. I might say that such an idea is being hinted at in the original tales.

Sadly, I also have to put a disclaimer on this entire chapter for our modern world. It is best to think of the main character in any of the tales, when they relate to sexual exploration, to be 18 in our modern world thinking. These tales were written to fit into the particular period of history that these tales were created in, and without understanding that context, they can easily be twisted in our perverse reality and used to justify even more abuse on young people. By placing the girl (or boy) in any fairy tale at the age of 18, when they now can make their own decisions and have gained more capacity to relate to the world around them, then the information in the tales can still be transferred to modern young people. The non-sexual information in these tales are of value to everyone.

As fairy tales go, Cinderella may be the most well known, and is also the one that has created the most distortion in feminine masculine interactions. I will get to that tale in my book about the feminine and masculine. But here I want to look at Little Red Riding Hood, the tale most

examined by researchers. A few have done excellent work, and it through their insights that I have been able to piece together the deeper elements of the coming-of-age process for girls to young woman.

*

The Grandmother

We need to begin with the version that is considered the oldest, titled “The Grandmother’s Story.” It was first published by the poet Achille Millien in 1885 after collecting tales from the Central French area of Nièvre. However, most researchers including Jack Zipes, Yvonne Verdier and Catherine Orenstein all describe it as the oldest of versions linked to at least the 15th century.¹⁹² It can be found, along with several other versions at the footnote.¹⁹³

I will present the tale first as an overview, then provide analysis. The title gives us an interesting pointer, that the story is really about the grandmother, not the girl or the wolf.

This version begins with a girl of unknown age, but always thought of as being sometime after her menstruation (so anywhere from 13 to 17 in Medieval Times). This tale makes no mention of any specific traits or characteristics for the girl, nor that she wears any special clothing. She is just a girl with a mother and a grandmother, which means that she can be easily identified with every girl reading or hearing the tale.

192 The earliest this premise can be identified is in Belgium 1,000 years ago when Egbert, a priest in Liege wrote a poem “Concerning the Girl Saved from the Wolf Cubs.” The girl wore a tunic woven from red wool that she was still wearing from her baptism.
<https://www.medievalists.net/2023/05/medieval-red-riding-hood/>

193 <https://sites.pitt.edu/~dash/type0333.html>

The unnamed girl is asked by her mother to bring bread and milk to her Grandmother. There is no mention of the grandmother being ill as appear in later versions, or any other specific reason for this visit. In this tale the girl does not meet a wolf on the pathway, but a bzou (werewolf, half man half wolf). This is important. Why is the challenger in the early tales a werewolf and not a wolf? We will come to that.

The werewolf questions where the girl is going, and after finding out it is to her grandmother's house, suggests a race. He asks the girl to choose a path of pins or needles. This specific question is an important part of the original tale that is lost in the later rewrites. The girl chooses needles, and the werewolf chooses pins and runs off on the other path. Unlike later versions he does not need to ask the girl where the older woman lives, he knows.

The werewolf arrives at the house, and kills the grandmother. He then puts a some of her flesh in the pantry (cupboard) and some of her blood into a bottle. Why not eat the old woman as in the later tales? The werewolf now pretends to be the grandmother when the girl arrives. There comes an odd sentence usually ignored after the girl arrived and knocked at the door, "Push on the door, It is blocked with a pail of water, said the bzou." The pail of water is a clue.

On entering, the werewolf suggests that the girl eat and drink what is waiting for her in the kitchen, and she does this, which in effect eating her grandmother's flesh and drinking her blood. This would seem like the girl is becoming a cannibal or vampire, but that is not the case. Every part of this tale is symbolic not literal. Next the werewolf asks the girl to get undressed and come to bed with him. With each item of clothes she takes off, the werewolf commands that she "throw them into the fire because she will not be needing them anymore."

The naked girl now gets into bed and starts to notice that the grandmother is not normal. She notices how hairy “she” is, or how big the shoulders or ears are. With each answer from the werewolf she gets a bit more information, becomes more skeptical, and can see that she is being tricked. The girl now changes her tune and claims she has to go to the bathroom. The wolf demands she just do it in the bed (ie not leave his seduction) but she claims that she must go outside. The werewolf agrees, but demands she not take too long, so he ties a thread to her ankle (as a control mechanism). But once outside the girl unties the thread (or cuts it with scissors) and ties it to the plum tree. By time the werewolf had gone outside to check on her, he finds that he has been tricked. He chases after the girl but can not overtake her, and the girl makes it safely home.

*

Analysis of The Grandmother

The girl has no name and no characteristics. In later versions she would be called a fair girl or pretty girl. Most importantly she has no head covering, and no association with the colour red. All of those ideas of Little Red Riding Hood come from Charles Perrault in the 1690s. The girl has been asked by her mother to take a gift to the grandmother. Now the grandmother here can be thought of as not just her own family, but perhaps a wise elder who will be teaching her. In Native American tradition one’s teacher will be called grandmother or grandfather, even if there is no paternal family link. The girl is to bring food and drink, with the bottle of white milk representing the girl’s virginity or purity. But there is another angle to the gifts, for as was the case with all the elder medicine people I met, I would always be expected to bring them some sort of gift on my first meeting when

asking either for healing or teaching. Usually this would be traditional tobacco, but did not have to be.

Next we come to the werewolf. In almost all of the other tales of this genre, the girl will meet a wolf. Given the recent versions where Riding Hood does not come out the winner of the exchange, most would claim that the wolf character is representing male predators trying to attack or seduce young girls. And sadly, given the insane civilized world we have lived in for several thousands of years, that is a valid presentation. But this story links much further back in time. Something else is being presented.

That the grandmother is living in a hut in the forest, symbolizes that she is one who lives with nature. Older women used to be thought of as wise ones, who knew what plants were edible and medicinal. Around this time this tale was being presented, witch trials were happening around Europe. And granted there are some men and women who do use the dark side of magic, trying to gain something personally by creating chaos and havoc to those around them. But most of the so-called witch trials were against women who were the herbal healers of the villages, or seemed that they had intellectual power that might be dangerous for the religious and aristocracy systems. Of course many of those accused of being witches were young girls who had been raped by prominent men in the community, who used the witch charge to have their victim killed so as to no longer have a possible accusation later against them.¹⁹⁴ One of the many charges against Joan of Arc was that she was practicing witchcraft.

These trials were also happening for men as well, as many were being charged with being werewolves (shape shifting while killing and eating children). This charge was

¹⁹⁴ <https://guides.loc.gov/feminism-french-women-history/witch-trials-witchcraft>

similar in tone for women, in this case to go after the natural male shamans as well as any masculinity that could be a political or revolutionary threat to the aristocracy and church. These trials of “werewolves” were more common than you might think in 14 and 15th century Europe. There were possibly hundreds of thousands of cases during a 300 year period. One of these was held in Touraine France in 1598 where Jacques Raollet was tried and executed. Interestingly, this is the same town that writer Perrault’s mother came from. Marianne Rumpf’s research suggests that the main areas where the Riding Hood tale originated, were regions that were high in werewolf trials.¹⁹⁵

This wolf character in this tale is misunderstood. I found it odd that Clarissa Estes in her fairy tale exploration book about the feminine, *Women Who Run With The Wolves* claimed that, “*A healthy woman is much like a wolf: robust, chock-full, strong life force, life-giving, territoriality aware, inventive, loyal, and roving.*”¹⁹⁶ Yet when I read that book, I did not find her provide a detailed discussion of Riding Hood, the most famous wolf - girl tale in existence. I found that a very odd omission. Why in a book glorifying the wolf symbol in fairy tales was Red Riding Hood ignored?

The werewolf in the tale represents many different elements at the same time, and thus the tale is telling several different stories at once. On one hand he represents the natural masculine member of the community that is being eliminated. He represents the oppression of wisdom in the countryside, and the forced adherence to the authority of the religious and political elite. He also represents the sexual urge and the need to learn and express it in healthy ways. He also represents a dangerous predator who wants to attack young

195 Reid, “From Cap to Cloak,” McNeill “Little Red Riding Hood,” Girl Museum “Little Red”

196 <https://www.goodreads.com/quotes/8987980-a-healthy-woman-is-much-like-a-wolf-robust-chock-full>

girls and boys, thus the need for girls to strengthen their inner intuitive power. From an alchemic perspective the wolf represents the parasitic mind that must be tamed to allow the deeper mind to reveal itself. All of these symbols are interwoven with the tale simultaneously.

There is no question that we are dealing with a sexual tale, as an old French phrase for the loss of a girl's virginity was "*elle avoit vu le loup*," or "she has seen the wolf."¹⁹⁷ Thus the werewolf is representing the girl's sexual transformation into a young woman. In modern eyes sex has a negative or sinful edge to it, but to tribal cultures this is another part of learning a full human experience.

By the 1800s, this tale became focused only on the predator aspect of the wolf, and much of what this story is really about was lost. The entire Western religious world for 2000 years has been about subjugating and controlling women, and halting their sexuality. But those inner energies do not just disappear because they are forced to be repressed. Like anything repressed, it could explode with the correct situation. A good example was when girls began screaming for Elvis in 1950s. That was because these feelings had been building, and with no outlet for what was going on within, Elvis became the outward figure for these girls to project towards him all of what going on inside of themselves. If you watch closely to some of his early 1956 performances, some of the girls were actually in a trance watching him on stage. So in some ways Elvis represented the wolf creature from these tales in the eyes of many adults. No wonder so many parents of the 1950s were trying to get him locked up and thrown in jail.

The core of this tale comes from the one question that the werewolf asks of girl, "Do you want to follow the path of pins or needles?" As was understood by many of the

¹⁹⁷ Temple "The Disturbing"

excellent recent researchers,¹⁹⁸ the question really is, are you ready to follow a sexual path or not?

Pins and needles are a sewing reference. To use a pin on something is the easy way to mend a garment. But a needle is used is either to create an entirely new garment, or make a more complete mend. Either way the needle requires more time and skill than the pin, thus is used in more mature (adult) way. Yvonne Verdier presented that in French villages during the Middle Ages girls at the age of 15 or 16 would be sent for the winter to learn from an older seamstress. They were learning sewing, but at the same time the young woman's was to learn about dating, and it seems this older seamstress might have helped in this understanding. After the winter was complete, a ceremony would be held in honour of St. Catherine to signify the girl now had the status of a young woman. It was only after this ceremony could the girl begin to date boys, and could wish for a boyfriend by throwing pins in a fountain.¹⁹⁹

Pins became a sign of courtship, and young men who sought a girl would offer them pins. This idea continued through the 1960s in North Americas when a boy who wanted to start dating a girl in high school would offer her his school pin. But with a needle there is a different symbol, threading it. To put the thread (penis) into the eye (vagina) of the needle.²⁰⁰ The girl in this tale chooses needles, thus choosing to go to the seamstress, to learn the important womanly skill of clothes making, and to also learn to learn the way of adult sexual relations, and not just childhood

198 Those who examined this context include Yvonne Verdier in the French *Le Petite Chaperon Rouge*, Windling "The Path," and Kourteva "What Little Red Riding Hood Knows."

199 Windling "The Path", Verdier, and Kourteva "What Little Red"

200 Windling, "The Path" and Kespohl "The Evolution," As well there are references that some European prostitutes placed needles on their sleeves as an indication of their profession.

dating (pins). In some later versions when this question is presented, the girl chooses pins because it is “easier and you can dress up fancy.” In these stories where she chooses pins, she either winds up eaten or needs help from men to save her. Only in the tales where she chooses needles, does her safety come from her own intuition, and sometimes with help from older women.

The werewolf chooses pins and runs to the house of the grandmother while the girl collects needles (perhaps wild thorns). This action is what was changed to her collecting flowers in other versions. The sex theme is further hinted at as when she arrives at the cottage, the werewolf tells her to push open the door hard as there is pail of water blocking it. The pail of water refers to the nursery rhyme of Jack and Jill, who went “up a hill to fetch a pail of water.” This is a reference to having sex. So by the girl, pushing open the door and the pail of water, is making clear her indication of what she is there for.

Once in the hut, the werewolf recommends that the girl have some of the food and drink in the kitchen, which turns out to be an eating of her grandmothers flesh and blood. What this is referring to is that she is taking in the totality of her grandmother’s wisdom. That she is in effect becoming the wisdom of the elder.²⁰¹ This will be the understanding of sex, but of also of herbs, sewing, cooking, and most importantly the power of feminine intuition. This will play out as the tale continues.

At this point the girl is still looking to learn the ways of sexuality, and goes through a type of striptease with the werewolf, where she takes off each garment one at a time, and when asked what to do with them, each time she is told “throw them on the fire, you won’t be needing them anymore.” The clothes of the child are no longer to be the

201 Catherine Orenstein suggested that this is a kind of initiation rite

clothes of the adult. You might say she is moving into the sexual world herself, at a slow pace, and is more in control of the situation than it may seem.

She then gets into bed with the werewolf, who is pretending to be the grandmother. This part of the story is brushed over. Given that the tale is named after the grandmother, has the werewolf been brought to the hut as a test for the girl? For this seeming, at least in the girl's eye, that the werewolf is associated with the grandmother is important.

It is at this point that intuition begins to take a prominent role in the story. The girl begins to ask a series of questions, while on the path it was the werewolf who asked the questions. Now on equal terms she mentions oddities in the appearance of her Granny. Each time the werewolf gives a plausible answer. But there is far more going on in this exchange it seems. Based on ideas in Native Indian Ceremonies, the responses of the werewolf are mirroring elements of the puberty teaching process. When she mentions the long nails, he replies "The better to scratch myself with." The need to use a scratching stick was a part of several tribe's ceremonies. About his shoulder he replied, "The better to carry firewood with, my child," thus to do the chores needed of the village. For the ears, "The better to hear with, my child!" thus to be wise and hear your questions to give a valid answer. For a question about the big nose, "To better take my tobacco with, my child," relating to the sacred herb that the student has likely brought to the teacher. It is only on the final question about the size of the mouth that the wolf finally presents his intention to eat her. This is where the story changes, and now she thinks quickly on her feet. At this point we now have a different story than the one that came before.

Now the girl claims the need to relieve herself, and even though the werewolf suggests just to do it in the bed,

she insists that she must go outside. So a thread or piece of wool is tied around the leg of the girl so that she can not “stray away.” Once outside, she takes out a pair of scissors (another tool of the female seamstress), cuts the thread and ties it to a plum tree. A plum tree in Asian traditions represents perseverance, beauty, hope, and luck. So she is not wanting to be tied to anything, but the ideals of the plum tree. Free, she is able to run to her home, and even though the werewolf eventually gives chase, he is unable to overtake her. She has handled her challenge.

There is one other version that has a similar story, but a slightly different ending. It was presented in 1885 by M. Légot in *Revue de l'Avranchin*,²⁰² and the tale is claimed to have come from Touraine, again the town of the mother of Charles Perrault.

This tale is unique. First off the girl gets a name, Jeannette. We will come back that. She is off to see her ill grandmother, but she seems to be doing this on her own. No mother is present, nor is she taking any food or drinks with her. In this story she does not meet a wolf, but instead a “very ugly man” who was walking with a sow. A sow is a pig who has had one series of babies. The wolf motif itself is completely gone and we are left with an ugly man. Is he ugly because of his looks, or ugly because of his temper and morality? Does he have a female pig, or an ugly female human wife?

The girl asks the man for directions to her grandmother's, to which she is told to go left, which turned out to be the long route. The ugly man took the “right” road and arrived quickly. So we lose the pins and needles question. There the ugly man killed the grandmother and put her blood

202 Found at https://bibliotheques.hautes-alpes.fr/images/articles/espace_pro/Images/Petit_chaperon_rouge.pdf

(flesh) in the cupboard. When Jeannette comes she is instructed to cook and eat, however the girl never eats the meat, and simply gets into bed with the ugly man. She again goes through the question and answer, about big arms and legs and eyes, but none of these answers are symbolic. Next, the girl after being frightened about how the teeth were to eat children, again asks to go outside to relieve herself and gets a strand of wool tied around her leg. Though here it is just said she unties it.

When the ugly man realized the girl was not on the end of the wool anymore the tale claims, "*This wicked devil got up in a rage and climbed onto his big son, which he had put on the roof, and he ran after the girl to catch her; he came to a river where some washerwomen were washing the mists.*" At the river he asks the women washing clothes there an odd question, "Did you see the little girl go by, With a little dog, Barbette, That was following her?"

What dog? Where did the dog come from? It was not mentioned in the tale to this point? A barrette in Medieval times was a piece of linen, a type of female beard. It seems that in France this symbolized an unmarried woman.

The washerwoman claimed they had helped the girl across the river by spreading a sheet for her to cross. The ugly man asks for the same help, to which when he and his sow were in the middle of the river, the women pulled out the sheet causing them both to sink and drown.

For analysis we start with the ending. Here the girl also escapes, as she does in all the earlier versions. This time though she gets help from older wise women. By the time of Grimms, it becomes a male hunter who does the saving, no longer elder women. Washing is a symbol in alchemy of Albedo, the whitening and purifying of the mind. So is that the nature of this tale, she is purifying her mind?. Or is she

just purifying her mind of sexual thoughts related to men who are deemed “ugly?”

That she has the name Jeanette is also unique. That is because there are references to what became known as the Priory of Sion from Rennes Le Chateau fame. It is claimed to be an organization going back 500 plus years, all who had at the head a famous figure of European intellectualism, of which included some women. Not that I think this particular organization actually existed, but like everything in that mystery, it is linking to something deeper. A point made was that every head of the organization took the name John if they were male (Jean in French), and Joan or Jeannette if female. So is the name of the girl in this story really that of a high level initiate of a secret society related to the mysteries of Rennes Le Chateau? Recall that Berenger Sauniere became priest of the local church in 1885 (the same year this story was published) and the story links well back to the 1600s and the time of Poussin and the Society St. Sacrament in Paris. I just wanted to mention the multiple layers involved in an examination of what seems to be just a simple set of fairy tales.²⁰³

Sadly, these old tales were providing too much understanding of how to function as a natural human in the world. The ruling aristocracy were concerned of what could happen in the population got focused on change, so new versions of these classic tales had to be created.

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Perrault the Distorter

203 There is another tale from this 1880 period called Little Golden Hood. At first I thought there might something here with the change to a golden hood, but the story is quite odd, the girl escapes, but winds up scolded and patronized by both the mother and grandmother.

*“This nice Mr. Perrault is supposed to have collected those fairy tales to amuse his own children, and eventually to save those stories from oblivion...Almost all of those tales have been modified by Perrault to fit the audience he was aiming at: the aristocracy. To think that Perrault was interested in popular culture would be a mistake.”*²⁰⁴ Lydie Jean

Charles Perrault is the one who turns a tale of knowledge into one of brain washing. Perrault was from a wealthy Paris family, and became known in government circles as part of the founding of several of the first French Academies. In 1663 became the aide to the Finance Minister of Louis XIV. Perrault's brother Claude became a part of the council who designed the new section of the Louvre, while Charles was the one who convinced the King to install 39 fountains in the garden at Versailles to represent the fables of Aesop. Lydie Jean wrote *“Being elected to the French Academy in 1671, he participated actively in the creation of the Dictionnaire. The purpose of this dictionary was to complete the ruin of regional languages, and to impose an example (what was vulgar or good taste): another way to control the writers.”*²⁰⁵ Perrault's interest in writing fairy tales was claimed to have been influenced after he had been relieved of his post in government in 1695, and so turned his attention to his children, and thus published his book of Fairy Tales and morals. It is this book which our modern ideas of Cinderella, Little Red Riding Hood and Sleeping Beauty are drawn from. But these tales were not just compiled, they were rewritten.

This happened during the time of the Paris salons of the 17th century. These were not places where people overpaid to have their hair cut, but they were social groups

204 Jean “Charles Perrault”

205 Jean “Charles Perrault”, Wikipedia entries on Charles Perrault

that came together to discuss philosophical and intellectual ideas. While in most of French society women were excluded, in the salons not only was there equality, but many women were the ones who put on the meetings. Some of the most influential at the time were the called fairy tale salons, which were generally run by women, often holding the meetings in their bedroom while they laid relaxing in bed.²⁰⁶

In the 1600s new ideas of what could only be thought of in our terms as Feminism, were gaining into the salons, where the women were discussing legal reforms to give women the right to marry or to remain single, to refuse the demand to have children, to enjoy a sexual life, and to have property rights.” One of the ways to express this message was to take the folk tales of the countryside, and produce powerful female heroines in the tales.²⁰⁷ Women were the original collectors of these tales, and wanted to change the entire idea of women in France, and idea which concerned the aristocrats. So it seems that Perrault (who was a frequent member at these salons) was the choice to collect and then rewrite the tales in such a way that the end result of them became an obedience to the religious and government aristocracy. This meant women needed to portrayed as weak, and to be judged only on their physical attractiveness.

Claudia Barnett and Lubomira Kouteva gives even more valuable detail into understanding the context of France at the time of Perrault. Both presented that in the Middle

206 Some have even claimed that Perrault’s version of the tale had nothing to do with warning girls about naughty men, but was a warning to the women of the salons, not to mix with men of high Parisian society who might ruin their reputations, who also laid in bed all day holding the sessions, mirroring the wolf in the bed. Perhaps the most famous of these female writers was Madeleine de Scudery. She is interesting for having in one her books a map for Arcadia “Carte de Tendre” in the 1650s, the time Nicolas Poussin was ending his painting career, he of Et In Arcadia Ego and Rennes Le Chateau fame. Reid “From Cap to Cloak”

207 Wegman “Tracing Desire”

Ages aristocratic families used arranged marriages to obtain social connections. Barnett claimed that, “*a 1629 ordinance declared that paternal consent was legally required for all French marriages, regardless of the offspring’s age. Failure to comply was punishable by death. The bride’s virginity ensured that any child born after the union was a legitimate heir to their combined fortunes. To help ensure their purity until they came of age, aristocratic daughters were usually cloistered within a convent from as young as four years of age until they were married.*”²⁰⁸ While Kouteva remarked, “*virginity in young bride was absolutely insisted upon, because marriage was a business arrangement contracted between two families, and the girl’s market value decreased sharply if her virginity was compromised...fathers had almost ownership over their daughters.*”²⁰⁹ Perrault’s own young 19 year old wife had been one of these many young women sent to a convent to insure their virginity upon birth. As mentioned in the childhood chapter, children not having a majority of time with their mother will create various traumas going forward in life.

It is Perrault who created a new character named Little Red Riding Hood, and focuses the tale only on the wolf as a dangerous man in the world. That danger can be activated by a woman’s own lust, which threaten their virginity and purity that the aristocracy expected in their marriage partners (even though they came no where close to holding themselves to similar standards). Perrault’s tales went through obvious rewrites, to turn the tales into moral presentations for the behavior of women. This brain washing was made worse when the Disney movies appeared in the 20th century, using the inverted versions. Jack Zipes stated that, “*Perrault ‘contaminated’ a 17th-century oral tale and in doing so, he converted an innocent, plucky folklore heroine into an objectified sexual being.*”²¹⁰

208 Barnett “Little Red Rising Hood,” Gibson pg 63

209 Kouteva “What Little Red”

210 Barnett “Little Red Riding Hood”

Red Riding Hood

In Perrault's tale²¹¹, the girl gets two key new elements. Firstly a description of "the prettiest creature who was ever seen," (which puts us immediately in the realm of the girl only being judged based on how she looks as in Cinderella). Secondly she is now given a red cloak, one that "her grandmother made for her." Her mother asks the girl to take some cakes and butter to her ill grandmother (in most other tales there is some form of liquid, either wine or milk but here is only food).

While going through the woods she meets a wolf, who decides to eat the girl and the grandmother, and proposes a race to the house. He knows the two paths and HE makes the choice and chooses the shorter one. The girl never agrees to this race. The wolf starts running immediately without any input from the girl.²¹² The wolf gets to the house first and eats the grandmother, while Riding Hood spends time picking flowers (see my alchemic translation).

When Riding Hood finally arrives, the wolf pretends to be the grandmother in the bed. He tells the girl to put the food on a stool and come to bed. The girl undresses quickly and joins the wolf. Once again we miss the symbolic eating of knowledge, the striptease and burning of the clothes. Here the wolf is simply making demands (the basic principle that Perrault is telling girls to do what a man tells you to).

A simplified question and answer occurs, after which the wolf eats the girl. The End!

211 Four good articles researching the problems inherent in this are Slatter, "Little Red Riding," Kourteva "What Little Red," Temple, "The Disturbing," Kespohl "The Evolution"

212 Wegman "Tracing Desire"

That is how the Perrault version ends. In most EVERY other version of this tale, the girl survives and either kills the wolf or escapes home. But Perrault destroys all semblance of the initiatory or learning process as there is no return to society. She is just dead.

Even odder than was the addition of a moral at the end of his tale. In this case it reads, “*Children, especially attractive, well bred young ladies, should never talk to strangers, for if they should do so, they may well provide dinner for a wolf. I say “wolf,” but there are various kinds of wolves. There are also those who are charming, quiet, polite, unassuming, complacent, and sweet, who pursue young women at home and in the streets. And unfortunately, it is these gentle wolves who are the most dangerous ones of all.*”

It is the moral at end which caused the change in opinion on what had taken place in the tale. Strangers here thus refer to potential rapists in waiting (especially for attractive girls) so you better find an elite man of power to protect you by living in a safe castle. And granted in the world of the Middle Ages, as today, there was definitely a need for girls to be on guard from men around them. But Perrault is making a much deeper message than that Angela Slatter pointed out, “*Perrault’s tales became moralizing stories, warning women and children that if they did not conform (do what they were told) there would be consequences.*”²¹³ They are no longer tales of wisdom, they are tales of controlling the population.

Why did Perrault give the girl a red hood to wear? Normal speculation claims that the colour red represents sin, sensuality, the root chakra, or danger. Red has come to represent intense sexuality, from red light districts to the Woman in Red in the *Matrix* movie. It was Wendy Gibson, in her book *Women in 17th Century France* that presented that there was a tradition during the 1600s in where in some

213 Slatter “Little Red Riding”

specific Central French locations, on one's wedding day, "*the peasant bride of Touraine favoured colour and sparkle with her scarlet robe and head-dress embroidered with imitation jewelry.*"²¹⁴ Another reference to the town that Perrault's mother was from. Thus the red hood was a wedding garment worn in this region. So this symbolic addition to the story, which would have been well understood by the readers of the day, was that the girl was just married or about to be married. This provides more clues as to what is going on.

By placing the girl in a red hood, and mentioning no other clothing, Perrault is claiming that the girl in the story is a new bride. Thus the wolf is someone other than the girl's husband. By going to bed with the wolf she is discarding her wedding vows, of either virginity prior, or faithfulness after.²¹⁵ I will discuss how modern researchers analyze this tale, but first I need to share the second most famous version, that of Red Cap.

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Brothers Grimm, Red Cap

In the 19th century, someone from almost every country collected the folk tales of their regions such as: The Brothers Grimm in Germany, Hans Christian Anderson in Denmark, and Peter Christen Asbjørnsen and Jørgen Moe in Norway. These tales were often rewritten.²¹⁶ The Brothers Grimm in Germany put out their series of tales in 1812,

214 Gibson pg 63, Barnett "Little Red Riding Hood"

215 A majority of the variants follow the similar story of the girl ending up dead such as "The Girl and the Wolf," shared by an elderly woman *Nanette Lévesque* of the French countryside (Loire) in 1874

216 Interestingly almost all of Perrault's tales are found in Grimms, even Sleeping Beauty, which as I write in *Exit The Cave*, it is a tale of the Divine Spark, and I find it hard to understand how that made it into Perrault at all (someone at one of the Salons must have suggested it to him).

though they kept putting out revisions until the 1850s. In each revision the tales became more “sanitized,” not only removing elements that seem naughty or scary, but that which reveal too much of their origin. Either by design or simply the choice of where they got their tales, the Grimms versions are laced with alchemical references.

The tales they presented were similar to Perrault because the sources were mainly women with a French background (Huguenot French Protestants who had to flee France in the 1700s). “*The sisters Marie, Amalie and Johanna Hassenpflug as well as Dorothea Wild (later the wife of Wilhelm Grimm) and their family contributed some of the most popular fairy tales,*” including Little Red Cap. The women met in a fairy tale discussion circle in Hesse, near where the Brothers Grimm lived.²¹⁷

In the Grimm’s version the girl becomes a “sweet little girl.” She is no longer known as Riding Hood, but Little Red Cap. The red colour is still there, and the idea of a head covering, but not as specific as the French wedding hood. In the Grimms’ tale all of the sexual references are gone. She is given cakes and wine by her mother, and is told “not to leave the path or she may fall and break the glass.” That element is discussing the vessel that holds the Aqua Vita (water of life), presenting that this mostly an alchemic tale.

One must keep in mind that the Grimm’s are writing for a Prussian-Germanic audience, thus obedience to authority for children (to mirror the school system) had to be put in place. Here the mother tells Red Cap what to do and

217 Information on the tellers of the tales to the Grimms can be found at, Valerie Paradiz *Clever Maids: The Secret History of the Grimm Fairy Tales*, and <https://vasilisathewise.com/2020/04/29/the-secret-history-of-the-grimm-fairy-tales/>, <https://www.grimmwelt.de/en/journal/who-told-the-fairy-tales>, Barnett “Little Red Riding Hood”

what not do when going to the grandmother's house. The mother in Perrault gives no instructions other than to bring the gifts. One could say that the reason the child got into trouble was for not listening to authority.

Red Cap never even gets into bed with the wolf in this story, but like the grandmother, gets eaten. However they both stay in the wolf's stomach for quite some time, which has a similarity to Jonah being swallowed by the whale (going into the underworld). She does get saved by her own wits or the help of female washing women here. Red Cap needs a huntsman (male saviour), who walks by and sees the sleeping wolf with a big belly. The huntsman realizes the grandmother and the girl are inside (how exactly is not explained), so he takes a pair of scissors and cuts open the belly to free the girl and the grandmother. In earlier tales it was the girl who used the scissors to cut the wolf's thread placed on her leg. Once free, the girl gets several stones, and fills up the wolf's belly, causing the wolf to fall down dead when he tried to chase her.

The story ends with the huntsman getting the wolf pelt, the grandmother eating the food and Red Cap left with a moral, "*As long as I live, I will never leave the path and run off into the woods by myself if mother tells me not to.*" So the base of the tale is that girls should listen to their parents and do everything they say, and by transference, teachers in school or any administrative figure. Even though the girl did not die in the tale, a damage has been done, as Angela Slatter remarked that the "*brave, resourceful little girl, is no longer able to get herself out of trouble; the only virtues allowed her are passivity and dependency, and the hope that a male will always be around to rescue her.*"²¹⁸

Researchers over the last one hundred years tend to present that the Red Riding Hood tale is only one about rape and killing, often that the girl is at fault (wearing the wrong

218 Slatter "Little Red Riding"

clothing in the wrong part of town idea). Claudia Bennett wrote, “*In scholarship attached to her story, Little Red Riding Hood has been called stupid, a fallen woman, a femme fatale, and other derogatory terms. Some argue that she is complicit in her own rape and demise, and responsible for her grandmother’s death.*”²¹⁹ One of the most influential of these researchers was Bruno Bettelheim²²⁰, whose 1976 fairy tale book is more odd in my opinion than valuable. Bettelheim, “*also identifies the Grimms’ heroine, as a pubescent girl with a ‘pleasure-seeking id’ whose premature, ‘budding’ sexuality is a danger to herself and others...battles her unacknowledged Oedipal desire to seduce her father, symbolically represented by both the wolf and huntsman...and arranges ‘things so that the wolf can do away with the mother figure’, i.e. Grandmother: her aging rival for the wolf’s attention...The character’s name is linked to the colour red, ‘which she openly wears, a colour that signifies ‘violent, sexual emotions.’*”²²¹ Sadly these ideas is where much of our current interpretation of Red Riding Hood from. I am sure they are all thinking that she is somehow wearing the red apple that she will trick Adam into eating. That is why I needed to spend so many pages looking at just one tale, due to all the damage to male-female interactions it has caused, and the wisdom lost from the tales origin being distorted

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Learning

In the tribal world, sexual knowledge was considered an important teaching process on the way to becoming a

219 Barnett “Little Red Riding Hood”

220 The psychologist Bettelheim, wrote an odd book *Symbolic Wounds* on initiatory puberty rites in the 1950s, claiming these were created from the mind of primitive people who were similar to schizophrenic children that he was studying. Really. Even though I read the book as part of the research for this book, I chose not to reference any of the ideas it contains.

221 Barnett “Little Red Riding Hood”

healthy young adult. Our modern world hides the truth of sex from children with stories of storks, birds, and bees. That is how frightened we have been conditioned (we could say brain washed) on the subject. You have to learn sex directly. You can not read it in a book, or have some one talk to you about it. Granted if the information is honest, such conversation can give helpful pointers and directions, but you need, “hands on experience.” There is such a suggestion in the original variants of this tale.

Up to the age of 19, I had few sexual experiences, and I never learned much from them. I never had a long-term girlfriend, so I had no “experimenting” stage in high school. My real sexual understanding did not happen until I was in first year university. At 19 I met an older women of 32, and over the course of a month she became what I could only call “my sexual teacher.” Granted we only got together a few times, and she really did not “teach” in how that word is thought of. She wanted me to be free to explore and enjoy the experience. That was one important understanding that came from her, to not think the experience but feel the experience. In other moments, she indicated that my instincts were good, so I should follow them. She showed me what was possible in sexual encounters, thus I was able to gain confidence. Things were very different when I began dating someone my own age soon after, I was able to let go of anxiety or inner pressure, and just allow myself to be in the moment, which allowed her to be in the moment.

I have to present this ancient understanding quite cautiously in the our modern world. It is firstly to indicate that there are two experiential ways to learn about sex. One is to date another young person around your own age, and then be open to experiment and learn from each other over time. That is the normal way. But should someone gain the opportunity to have an older teacher, and I stress teacher not seducer, then this can also be of value, and this did occur in

many tribal societies. Sadly suggesting such an idea today can easily become misinterpreted for predatory means, and I think is what the danger element of the original Riding Hood tale is pointing to.

By choosing needles she was ready to move to testing out a sexual path. But just because that is chosen, does not mean that the next person that shows up in front of you is the best choice. One needs to gain intuition and find clues as to who is helpful or not helpful in this area. In my case with the 32-year old women, we met the year before and had several friend-based interactions for a year. That year created a safety level between us before any further steps occurred. To rush into something only puts one in danger of the wolf. As such, women especially, should be using their intuitive power (another thing this tale is pointing towards) long before they make it to grandma's house.

Sadly in our world, too many too modern girls choose as their early dating and sexual experiences "bad boy" types, which often lead to various psychological hurts that can stunt their future dating life. Remember 90 % of young men are actually quite decent, albeit lacking confidence and dating knowledge. This is why the shift to adult thinking is important. Adults have a more long term thought process, while the adolescent is short term. And when it comes to sex, a long term view is important, which I believe is another element that the original grandmother tale is pointing towards.

Too many young people today have not had a slow learning time into sex, but worse, an abuse-led journey into it. And it can take years or decades to overcome the abuse and be back to a clear state to move forward. Trauma healing, no matter the trauma, is an important part of the overall work of getting one's *house in order*. And that can take time, but there

are plenty of stories of transformation to suggest this is very possible.

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Another aspect the fairy tale distortion for modern relationships comes from an element called the “damsel in distress syndrome.” This is where a young woman is presented as vulnerable and in danger, and a male proves his worth as her protector by riding in on a white horse and saving the woman. This plays out in more novels and movies than you may first think. Think of thirty movies where there is a male and female character who come together by the end. How many of those have the “damsel in distress” and being saved theme? You might be surprised to find out that it is almost all of them.

On one level there is some, let's call it, a genetic truth to some of this. When I asked some feminine female friends about what sort of traits they look for in a male partner, at the top of the list was that he could protect them. They addressed that word in a variety of ways (not just by working and earning money). And there is some truth to that, as hard coded into standard masculinity is the need to be a protective element to women and children in their community. That is not to say women need to be saved because they are weak, but because there is a hard wiring code that if a woman feels safe around a man, she knows that her children would also be safe. The more safe a woman feels, the more likely the feminine can appear.

I can say that in my university days, I consciously chose to be someone that girls felt safe around. I took this on mostly because I saw so many times girls were being pressured. Many times I had to act as the “pretend boyfriend” to get a drunk idiot moving on his way and leaving a girl alone. I used to walk any girl home whenever she asked, which probably happened once every couple of weeks. The

girl asking often felt awkward to ask, but my response was always “yes, of course.” Even though at this stage I had not had a woman in my life murdered (as would happen later on) perhaps I had some sort of conscious link to the future, and it impacted my choices back then. And before anyone wonders, I used to just walk them home.

I think this concept of getting a girl home safely was in my psyche early on, and strengthened after my coming-of-age experience. It got tested in my final year of high school. There had been a girl one year younger than me that I had been interested in for a year or so. She was not someone I would normally be attracted to, she could be called “a bit wild.” One night at the local bar we had been talking, then she asked if I could drive her home. I rarely had a car, but that night I did, so I said sure, as I was ready to leave and get home having a hockey game the next night.

When I got to her house she smiled and leaned towards me. I thought it was to give me a thank you good night kiss on the cheek. But she was reaching over to undo my belt. I asked what she was doing. She just smiled and said that she wanted to thank me. It was obvious what she meant. I just stopped her and pushed her hands back and told her she didn’t have to be doing that.

She sort of that there for a few moments just processing the last twenty seconds and spoke really slowly to me, “*You mean you really just drove me home to get me home? Not to get something for it?*”

“*Yes, I just wanted to get you home safe.*”

She shuffled in the seat, a bit nervous and a processing some more. Then she got the most warming smile on her face. Sadly I realized that I might have been the first guy in her life that was not using every interaction with her to get

something sexually. She slowly stroked my shoulder as she said, “*You’re a pretty amazing guy. Don’t let anyone tell you otherwise.*”

And with that she got out of the car. I watched her walk to her door, and when she opened it, she turned and waved at me, and then she entered her house. She pretty much disappeared from my life at that point. Even though I saw her in the halls many times the rest of the year, I don’t recall us ever speaking again. I guess kindness was not really what her psyche was looking for in life. But I never forgot that moment. And somehow her kindness and smile at that door was something more enjoyable than a flash in the pan sexual experience in a car. Without her knowing it, she walked me down another pathway that I followed.

Of course just being a good person, sadly, is not good enough in our modern dating climate, as I will discuss when I get to the tale Cinderella in a future book. I was reminded of that some fifteen years later as an almost year-long relationship was ending. Half way through I had really begun to think (for the first time in my life) that I might marry this woman. But it continued to spiral down to the point where she was breaking up with me (and in certain cases rightfully so). In the course of her discussion of why she needed to end our relationship she said, “*you are a wonderful, guy who has been really good to me, but I need more than that.*” That was a real kicker moment. Being kind was not of use if you don’t own a nice house, car, and can shell out for expensive travel. Actually the message was clear, those are the things that she was declaring was important, not how you actually treat a woman.

I don’t want to seem like I am coming down hard on her, because on one level she was correct. I was far away at that stage of my life of having my *house in order*. I was still renting a room in someone’s house, and was earning just enough money to just be able to pay my bills each month. And if I was living a life that was only about me, then a house

not fully in order is fine. But if I was moving to a stage where a long term partnership was something I was thinking about, then she was correct, being kind was not going to be enough for most women. I had to step back for many years at that point, and not date.

Just a few years later came the fall in the Canyon, the long illness, and the writing of *Falling For Truth*. It took several more years of hard work to get my *house in order* enough be able to actively partake in some type of real partnership. I mention this to show that there are many levels involved in this process. Since the “being stable” financially is an important one for men if they are looking for long-term relationships, I should mention a key one for women as well that tends to be forgotten. That is being being pleasant and enjoyable to be around. Really. That is something very important for a guy in a partner. And from the standpoint of *house in order* for a woman has this as part of the understanding. Because you have to honestly ask yourself, if I am not fun to be with, why exactly would a man want to spend his life with me? There are more levels to this *house in order* thing than anyone first believes.

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Dreams

I want to add a non-sexual inference, that can come from the wolf and bed symbology. This concept may not have been part of the original design, but it can be helpful in one’s navigation of the insane reality we inhabit. The wolf can symbolize archons (demonic entities) that reside in the astral realm. A main influence point on humans, is while we sleep. They infiltrate our dreams, mostly by posing as people we know (family members, previous dating partners, best friends) all so that our awareness in the dream drops its guard, and moves into “its so good to see you mode.” Awareness now fails to be aware if a trick is being attempted on during

the scene. At times, I think archons might concoct the entire dream scenario entirely to attempt to trick and influence us.

There have been many times I have woken up in the morning, and noticed that I was very tired, or was having very odd thoughts. And if I didn't closely look into this, and just began a morning routine, this lack of energy and strange thoughts would continue into my day. But as soon as I wondered, what were my dreams last night, to see if there was a connection, right away I could see that there was an event in the dreams. A good old friend appeared, but the entire interaction was bizarre. And that is when I could see, oh it was one of "them." Only after clearing out the dream, and any energy or ideas that were in effect directed towards me would my energy and mental clarity return.

Thus we look into our previous night's dreaming, not to see what great wisdom was there or if we had a fun flying in the astral world, nor to write down all the details to find what our subconscious was trying to say to us (the standard way of looking at one's dreams). We look for outside energies attempting to influence or manipulate us while in the dream state. In most tribal societies there tended to be long conversations in the morning between family members about the previous night's dreams. And yes, there can be messages there for us in this state, especially if one has blocked out intrusive outside energies so the experience more comes from within. But this examination as to the ownership of the dream itself, was likely a key part of the discussion. And if this was occurring by several people, each morning, it would become easier to catch the manipulation before it could affect someone, or the community as a whole.

Thus from this angle, the wolf can be an archon entity looking to implant an idea into our mind during sleep. This is more common than people believe, and the more protection and preparation one can take before going to sleep, and then do a short overview of the dream in the morning, can catch

much of this early on. In time one can learn to take this awareness into the dream itself, and reject the entire scenario. So I can take the girl's seeing of the wolf's motive in the bed, and her actions to reject what was going on and return home (back to normal consciousness) can also include the idea I have described above.

There are so many possible examination of the tale of Little Red Hood, and why I feel it is important. I want this tale to be seen in the light it was originally created. That it can become a pointer for people to go within and ask some deep questions of themselves, and their life pathway on becoming a young man or woman. How has one's transformation been, in all areas of what it means to be a healthy valuable adult?

Additional Material 3

Water Baptism

I would like to provide one example of how these various distortions exist in our world. I will use the subject of religions water baptisms, what I believe they really are, and why they rejected by the Cathars. When you look closely at female coming-of-age ceremonies around the world, ritual bathing is usually part of the process. Granted, in some later adult male ceremonies you will also find a ritual cleansing with water, but it does not happen in the boys' coming-of-age process, only for girls.

First is to define the origin of the word baptism. It has its origin in Greek and Latin, which link to a few definitions. One is ritual washing, but others are immersion, going under, dying as in drowning, or being overwhelmed. So you can see that there is many ideas within the word that is beyond a simple "cleansing" idea.

I had the baptism concept incorrect in my last book *Empty the Cave*. I originally thought that water baptism was somehow locking people into the water-symbolic Matrix, and this was the reason the Cathars rejected this rite. I now understand that water baptism is a feminine action. By that I do not mean it is only for women, but like I mentioned with language, words reveal what type of energy is required. It is a feminine washing of the material realm so as to see it new with clear eyes. In the puberty rite for the girl it also symbolized washing away the childlike ideas, so that the young woman could be left shining into an adult feminine view. This ritual for the girl was performed by an elder female.

And that was the clue. Water baptism, as it is a feminine principle, has to be presided and administered by a female.

To have water baptism performed by a male may create an inverted energy, and thus the one going through it may not see the natural world as something to keep balanced and healthy (feminine). It will be seen as something to control (masculine). This in my opinion is why Cathars rejected the water baptism of the Church of Rome and John the Baptist as a teacher. It was not because they believed John was in some way evil (as I suggested in my previous books). I think they were rejecting the idea that a man could perform this ceremony. The ceremony could happen as long as it was performed by a woman, a Joan the Baptist. When you look at Renaissance depictions of John, “he” often appears in feminine form with long hair. Joan of Arc might well be John in her “actual” form, and thus her story is somehow the story of the baptismal process. This could be the reason for the story about John needing to be beheaded, for the head had to be chopped off and hidden in order to hide who the water baptizer really was.

Thus there is power in a feminine water ceremony that a feminine “Joan” presides over, similar to the masculine ceremony of fire baptism performed by a masculine Jesus. Perhaps the figure of John could be a Baptist, but not of water as presented, nor fire which is of Jesus. Perhaps he is the wild man giving a baptism of Earth (of Spirit coming into matter). I believe that in the ancient world people would receive baptisms through life, perhaps all four directions (water, fire, earth and air). The final baptism could be classified as one of Emptiness or the Void. The direction, that at the same time is not a direction, is inward.

Additional Material 4

Ancient Confusions

I want to discuss how fast civilization infected these HG tribal communities. I give the example of the Native tribes of Eastern North America in the 1700s. This was just 200 years after the “first contact,” and most of the tribal interactions were with missionaries or fur traders. Even with that small contact, the tribal villages had changed. On the small scale they traded for various items such as steel knives, metal pots, and alcohol. But there were much bigger changes that happened to the very fabric of their society.

The Natives were strongly pressured to adapt to the missionary ideas of Christianity. Many Natives decided that the best way to stay alive was to integrate with the colonists, the idea being that if you became more like them, they would less want to kill you. So they merged many Christian ideas with their own religion and myths. This was later claimed to be fine because they presented that the two religions were the same, but that is not really the case. This also happened with the Plains Peyote Church in the 1900s, where a combination of Christianity and peyote drug was fused into a new religion. The problem is that each element in the combination was not an original part of Plains tribal mythology prior. All this did was to distort the original ideas of the peoples.²²²

The changes were drastic. For example, the Northern Algonquin set up a new system known as the Grand Medicine Lodge (Midewiwin). It is set up in structure very similar to

²²² Eastman pg 53-55, Black Elk

English Freemasonry, including having initiatory degrees. The idea of specific levels as this was not a part of the old HG systems. It has been suggested that this Native organization goes back to ancient times, and that is likely true. This group keeps key mythological information, and was supposed to “*teach the meaning of life and death, their place in the universe, and the origins of the Ojibwa people.*” But that this Lodge so mirrors Freemasonry, suggests that at some point after the colonial contact the Freemasons began to merge with this Native group. Recall that Masonic meeting halls are known as a Lodge is not a co-incidence. Just like the Natives did with merging Christian ideas with their own to try and pacify the colonialists, they may have done the same (merging) with colonial secret society traditions as well.²²³

Also to keep in mind is that the core structure of the American governmental system was really the structure of the Iroquois Six Nations Confederacy. The American founding fathers were almost all Freemasons. Is this why they so appreciated the Native system of government, because they had already immersed themselves in it? And given that the name of the Native system of tribal government was “Confederacy,” one should also ask questions as to who the US Civil War was really fought against?

Charles Eastman (a former Lakota who later entered colonial society and became one of the first Native doctors)²²⁴ claimed that originally the Plains Sun Dance was a personal ceremony, done by an individual when he had prayed to the Spirit to save his life from some close to moment death possibility. By having his life continue, the person would then

223 Eastman pg 64-73, Angel pg 48

224 Interesting is that Charles is the grandson of US army Lt. Col, Sam Eastman, who was a famous painter and artist of the Plains Indian tribes of the 1850s and 60s. He was married to a Lakota woman, but then ended his marriage when he was re-posted. So obvious it was this family connection that allowed Charles his entrance into the world of colonial society.

hold a Sun Dance, in which he offered his suffering back to the main deity (symbolized as the Sun) as a thanks for his continued life. The author claimed that,

*“In recent times, this rite was exaggerated and distorted into a mere ghastly display of physical strength and endurance under torture, almost on a level with the Caucasian institution of the bull-fight, or the yet more modern prize-ring. Moreover, instead of an atonement or thank-offering, it became the accompaniment of a prayer for success in war, or in a raid upon the horses of the enemy. The number of dancers was increased, and they were made to hang suspended from the pole by their own flesh, which they must break loose before being released. I well remember the comments in our own home upon the passing of this simple but impressive ceremony, and its loss of all meaning and propriety under the demoralizing additions which were some of the fruits of early contact with the white man.”*²²⁵

I find it very interesting that he (originally born a Lakota) felt that the Sun Dance has been known for the last few hundred years, is not how it had originally been set up before the colonial arrival. Is this true? Eastman later became not only a Western doctor, but co-founded the Boy Scouts and wrote books on Freemasonry. So was his view honest representations of pre-colonial Plains life, or was it the view that the colonial ruling class wanted to present? I can not answer such a question, but all of this has to be kept in mind for examination.

The point of all this being made is that after the colonial arrival, many Native ceremonies began to get distorted. That is why I did not want to claim in this book that any coming-of-age ceremony discussed is something that should be claimed as “original,” or anything you the reader

225 Eastman pg 56-63

should do yourself. I have shared them as starters of thought regarding the loss of the process of creating *natural adults*, and to allow you to contemplate possible tools and ideas that could have useful value for you and your family.

One last mention is an article Michael Howard²²⁶ that claimed that much of Eastern Native Tribes (Algonquin and Iroquois) had religious ideas that were very similar to original Gnostic thought, thus presenting that such ideas were universal and not something only found in the Middle East or Asia. Howard used the writings of Henry Schoolcraft, who lived with many tribes in the early 1800s to present similar philosophy. This included ideas of a Vital Spark, “*The soul of man is seen, in these curious legends, to be thought immortal and undying, the vital spark passing from one object to another. This object of the new life in general is not man, but some species of the animated creation ; or even, it may be, for a time, an inanimate object. The circumstances which determine this change, do not appear.*”²²⁷

Howard presented that Schoolcraft’s work suggested these tribes had a dual-natured reality (good vs evil), and a material realm that has more suffering to it than peace, “*With benevolence and pity as prime attributes, the Great Transcendental Spirit of the Indian does not take upon himself a righteous administration of the world’s affairs, but, on the contrary, leaves it to be filled, and its affairs, in reality, governed, by demons and fiends in human form...and how striking a coincidence its leading dogma of the two opposing principles of Good and Evil affords, with the Oriental doctrines to which we have referred.*”²²⁸

This subject, and the works of Schoolcraft and others of his period will be a focus of one of my upcoming works. I wanted to present a mention of this here as a corollary to the ideas that came from Eastman’s writings.

226 Howard

227 Schoolcraft pg 33

228 Schoolcraft pg 35

Additional Material 5

The Gateless Gate

*“When you pass the gateless gate, you walk the universe alone.”*²²⁹ Mumokan

I think there have been some confusion in language in some of my previous books. It might seem like I am suggesting that we have to “return” to the Pleroma, or “merge” with Source. But that is not what I am saying at all. You don’t need to return or merge, because What You Are has never left. All that has happened is a trick has been played on that Awareness to think you have left, to think you are separated from Totality. You don’t merge, you remove that which has fooled Awareness. When the trick is gone, what more is there to do? You never really left Home, so why do you have to go back Home? I likely made the idea a bit over-complicated in *Exit and Empty the Cave*. So I wanted to add this reminder here.

When you remove everything that is false, all that remains is what is True. It is why “Truth will set you free,” not because “you” are trapped, only because we have come to falsely believe we are, but as long as the belief is holding, then we are. And you can’t think your past the false, feel your way past, or wish your way past. You have to Realize your way past it all. It is the gateless gate. As you work hard to get to the gate, you feel like it is a great barrier that you have to get beyond. And it is the work of a lifetime to do it.

229 From the famous Chinese text of Zen koans in the 13th century by Mumon Ekai

But when you pass the gateless gate, you find there never was a gate there, so there was nothing you had to get beyond or past. It only seemed like you did. If you understand that metaphor, then what I have said in my books will be more easy to contemplate.

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Exit the Cave: Ending the reincarnation trap 2022

Exposing the Expositions 2019

Falling For Truth: A spiritual death and awakening 2018

The Power of Then: Revealing Egypt's lost wisdom 2010

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